

Govt renames Shahjahanabad Redevelopment Corporation to IVPN

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Aiming to restore the historic, cultural and architectural heritage of Old Delhi including Chandni Chowk to its original glory, the Rekha Gupta Government has renamed the Shahjahanabad Redevelopment Corporation, which was established for the conservation and redevelopment of Old Delhi, as Indraprastha Virasat Punarvikas Nigam (IVPN).

Old Delhi covers approximately 7.12 square kilometres. The historic city, which is more than 350 years old, is home to one World Heritage Site, 10 nationally protected monuments, 10 state-protected monuments and more than 700 locally protected

heritage sites.

Chairing the annual general meeting of the IVPN on Thursday, she directed officials to expedite the redevelopment of Chandni Chowk, improve parking facilities and build public toilets to enhance public convenience.

"Development of Old Delhi should not remain confined to physical infrastructure alone. Instead, heritage conservation, tourism promotion, economic activity, civic amenities, and environmental balance should all be pursued through an integrated approach," Rekha Gupta said. With this objective, the IVPN will undertake heritage conservation alongside modern urban development, she said.

"The initiative will include

conservation of historic buildings, modernisation of infrastructure, solid waste management, traffic management, expansion of tourism facilities and other related aspects," she said.

The chief minister directed officials to ensure that the market's design reflects its historical identity, traditional character, and cultural significance.

"Keeping in view the movement of lakhs of people through the area every day, modern and functional public toilet blocks should be developed, and civic amenities should be further strengthened," she added.

Reviewing the redevelopment of the Town Hall in the area, the chief minister directed that an additional entry



and exit from the Chandni Chowk side be created to help the building emerge as a major heritage and tourist attraction.

Further, the IVPN has also been tasked with preparing a detailed blueprint for the

comprehensive development of the Hanuman Temple at Yamuna Bazaar and the area behind it as part of the larger redevelopment project.

She also directed the preparation of a comprehensive redevelopment and beauti-

fication plan for the Jama Masjid area and Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Marg in front of the Old Delhi Railway Station.

The Chief Minister said that through the corporation, a comprehensive and serious initiative has begun to preserve Old Delhi's historical identity while equipping it with modern civic amenities.

The annual general meeting of Indraprastha Virasat Punarvikas Nigam, attended by Urban Development Minister and Vice Chairman of the corporation Ashish Sood, Managing Director Sandeep Kumar and senior officials from the concerned departments,

Several key decisions were taken on the holistic redevelopment of Old Delhi, heritage conservation, expan-

sion of civic infrastructure and promotion of tourism. It was decided that the redevelopment of the historic Chandni Chowk would be accorded the highest priority.

The Chief Minister said the Chandni Chowk market had evolved alongside the area's development and that restoring its past glory would require keeping the interests of its markets, traders and shopkeepers at the forefront.

Keeping the convenience of visitors in mind, the Chief Minister also directed that a dedicated control room be established in the market to provide information, guidance and prompt assistance to tourists arriving from across India and abroad.

The Chief Minister instructed officials to prepare a

detailed blueprint for the integrated development of the Hanuman Temple at Yamuna Bazaar and the area behind it as part of the larger redevelopment project.

Ashish Sood said that the redevelopment of Chandni Chowk and its surrounding historic areas would go beyond physical infrastructure and would be undertaken with full sensitivity towards preserving their historical, cultural and architectural heritage.

"To achieve this, it was decided that historians, heritage conservation experts, architectural specialists and other domain experts would be involved in the planning and implementation of the redevelopment projects," he added.

MHA transfers 21 IAS and 40 IPS officers of AGMUT cadre in major administrative reshuffle

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In a major administrative reshuffle, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) on Thursday transferred 21 IAS and 40 IPS officers of the AGMUT cadre across Union Territories and northeastern states, with immediate effect.

Among the prominent changes, 2009-batch IAS officer Shahid Iqbal Choudhary has been transferred from Jammu and Kashmir to Arunachal Pradesh. In contrast, 2017-batch IPS officer Tanushree has been shifted from J&K to Delhi, both within the AGMUT cadre.

The transfer order, issued with the approval of the competent authority, also posted IAS officer Saugat Biswas (2006 batch) from Arunachal Pradesh to J&K, while IAS Swati Sheemar (2023 batch) was transferred from J&K to Delhi.



IAS officer Mamta Yadav (2021 batch) has been moved from Delhi to J&K, all within the AGMUT cadre.

Among IPS officers, Deepika (2018 batch) has been transferred from J&K to Puducherry, Gaurav Sikanwar (2019 batch) from J&K to Goa, Vishnu Kumar (2019 batch) from Delhi to J&K, KM Priyanka (2021 batch) from Chandigarh to J&K, Anand Kumar Mishra from Delhi to J&K, and Satish Kumar from Delhi to J&K, all within the AGMUT cadre.

The reshuffle also brought

a significant number of AGMUT (Arunachal Pradesh-Goa-Mizoram and Union Territories) cadre officers to the national capital, within the same cadre.

Among the IAS officers posted to Delhi are Vivek Pandey (2003) from Arunachal Pradesh, Garima Gupta (2004) from Mizoram, Pawan Kumar Sain (2005) from Arunachal Pradesh, Amjad Tak (2005) from Arunachal Pradesh, Ajay Kumar Gupta (2010) from Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu (DNH&DD), Awanish Kumar (2014) from Lakshadweep and Shweta Nagarkoti (2020) from Arunachal Pradesh, all within the AGMUT cadre.

Among the IPS officers transferred to Delhi are Vivek Kishore (1999) from Arunachal Pradesh, Sindhu Pillai A (2001) from Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Chinmoy Biswal (2008) from Arunachal Pradesh, A Koan (2009) and

Jitendra Kumar Meena (2012) from Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Varsha Sharma (2010) from Goa, Anil Kumar Lal (2013) from Puducherry, Manjeet (2015) and Geetanjali Khandelwal (2015) from Chandigarh and Satyawan Gautam (2016) from Arunachal Pradesh, all within the AGMUT cadre.

The order has also posted IPS officers Pukhraj Kamal (2018) and Lokeshwaran R (2018) from Mizoram; Gaurav Tyagi (2019) from Mizoram; Angad Mehta (2020) from Arunachal Pradesh; Utkarsha (2021) from Lakshadweep; and R Subash from Puducherry to Delhi, within the AGMUT cadre.

The reshuffle also covered several other AGMUT cadre postings across Arunachal Pradesh, Mizoram, Goa, Puducherry, Chandigarh, Lakshadweep, Andaman and Nicobar Islands, and Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu.

Students from Government school in Shalimar Village selected for NASA space camp in USA

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Five students from a Government school in Shalimar Village have been selected for a Space Science Programme at the United States Space and Rocket Center in Alabama, USA.

The students are selected based on their performance in a newly inaugurated STEM Innovation Lab, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta presenting air tickets to the selected students on Thursday at the Government Girls Senior Secondary School during the launch of a series of modern facilities under the Saksham programme implemented by the Ladli Foundation with CSR support from Honeywell Technology.

The facilities inaugurated at the school include an AI-integrated Smart School Toilet, a STEM Innovation Lab, a modern computer lab, and smart digital classrooms, alongside a comprehensive



health programme for nearly 3,000 girl students enrolled at the school.

The Chief Minister said Delhi's daughters are now ready to showcase their talent in science and technology on the global stage and expressed confidence that the five selected students' achievements would inspire thousands of other girls to pursue science and research.

The STEM Innovation Lab will provide students with practical learning in robotics, artificial intelligence, coding, Internet of Things, space

science, electronics, design thinking, and innovation. It also gives students access to digital content, smart boards, interactive learning material, computer-based training, and modern teaching methods.

The Chief Minister said girls' education and health are closely linked and that better sanitation facilities directly affect regular school attendance. The health programme launched for the school's approximately 3,000 girl students includes medical check-ups, eye screening, free spectacles where

required, a deworming campaign, and menstrual hygiene awareness sessions.

On the power infrastructure front, the Chief Minister launched a Tata Power-DDL project in the Shalimar Bagh Assembly constituency to replace overhead electricity lines with insulated aerial bundled cables and underground power lines.

The project involves the phased underground cabling of 33 KV and 11 KV overhead power lines. Work in the first phase will begin on Club Road, Bhagwan Mahavir Marg, Swami Shradhdhand Saraswati Marg, Shaheed Udham Singh Marg, KL Bagga Marg, and Maharishi Dayanand Marg, along with other key roads in the area.

The Chief Minister also flagged off 137 advanced electric primary waste collection tipper vehicles for the Municipal Corporation as part of the Government's push for cleaner and pollution-free urban management.

Baba Farid University of Health Sciences, Faridkot
Ph: 01639-256232, 256236

Adv. No. BFU-26/25

VACANCIES

Online applications are invited w.e.f 11-07-2026 to 31-07-2026 from eligible candidates through University website www.bfufs.ac.in for the recruitment to the posts of **Accountant -01, Cashier -02, Accounts Clerk -01 on regular basis** under Baba Farid University of Health Sciences, Faridkot.

For Application form, fee, Category wise distribution and other terms & conditions, visit University website: www.bfufs.ac.in

3108/12/2026-27/13105 Dated CHD :- 09/07/2026

Sd/-
REGISTRAR

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PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to general public that 17-07-2026 has been fixed as the Record Date to determine the name of members who are entitled to receive notice of 40th Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of the Company scheduled to be held on Friday, 21st August 2026 at 10.00 hours IST through video conferencing/other audio visual means.

The process of sending emails to the registered email id of members is expected to be completed by 24-07-2026. The said email will contain link(s) to the web-page where the soft copy of notice of the AGM, Annual Report and detailed instructions for e-voting and participating in the AGM will be available. E-voting will start at 09:00 hours on 17-08-2026 and end at 17:00 hours on 20-08-2026. Any member who does not receive the aforesaid email may download a soft copy of these documents from the Company's website www.jaschindustries.com/Investors/Annual Reports or from website of BSE www.bseindia.com. Members who have not provided/updated their email ids to/with their DP are requested to do so without any further delay.

For any queries, kindly visit "Investors" Section of our aforesaid website before writing to the Company or its Registrars & Share Transfer Agents, as this Section contains answers to various general queries.

for Jasch Industries Ltd
Sd/- (S.K. VERMA)
Company Secretary

Sonipat,
09-07-2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the public at large that my client I/CICI Bank is advancing a loan to Mr. Kapil Batra for purchasing the Freehold House No. R-2/9, Area Measuring 740.07 Sq Mtrs. situated at Raj Nagar, Ghaziabad from Mr. Prabhatir Singh Chawla and Mr. Manikant Singh Chawla.

Mr. Kapil Batra is purchasing the property from Mr. Prabhatir Singh Chawla and Mr. Manikant Singh Chawla, who is the owner of the property and acquired a complete and sole interest in the property by virtue of a Registered Will dated 07.10.2015 executed by Mr. Gurbux Singh Chawla (Deceased) & Mutation Letter dated 05.06.2025 issued by Ghaziabad Development Authority.

If anybody has any claim or objection upon the said property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession legal heirs, partners, encumbrance however or otherwise is required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 14 days from the date of publication of this notice with supporting documents. After the expiration of notice period, the claim, if any of such person shall be treated as null and void and be treated as waived.

TAPAN RAGHAV (Advocate) G-220, Karkardooma Court, Delhi- 110032. Ph. No. +91 88000 96522

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of SHRI VISHNU to inform to the public at large that SHRI VISHNU is purchasing the Plot no. WZ-575A Area Measuring 30 sq. yds Out of 225 sq. yds Out of Kharsa no. 177, Situated in the Area of Old Lal Dora of Village Palam, New Delhi 110045, from Shri Jatin Jain who became owner through GPA, ATS AND WILL dated 06/05/2023, duly attested with the Notary Public Delina Singh which was executed by Mohammad Farid same to be financed & mortgaged by Aditya Birla Housing Finance Ltd., So, to comply the requirements of BANK/NBFC, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest/creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within 15 days from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc. Lucern Legal LLP N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre New Delhi-110049 Contact # 011-40046316 & 41667327

PUBLIC NOTICE / CAUTION NOTICE

I, Anil Sharma, resident and owner/occupant of 3rd Floor, Property No. 2/61, Bhola Nath Nagar, Gali Vishwas Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi - 110032, hereby inform the general public that I have no concern, connection, association, interest, liability or responsibility with any company, firm, proprietorship concern, LLP, society, trust or business entity which may be registered, operating, conducting business or using the aforesaid address without my knowledge, consent or authorization. Any person, company, authority, bank, financial institution or government department dealing with any such entity at the above-mentioned address shall do so at their own risk, cost and consequences. I shall not be responsible for any act, omission, fraud, misrepresentation, financial transaction, loan, liability, statutory default or illegal activity committed by any person or entity using the said address without my express written permission. If any company, firm or business entity is found to be registered or operating from the aforesaid address without my authorization, the same shall be treated as unauthorized and appropriate legal action shall be initiated against the persons concerned. This notice is being published for the information of the general public and all concerned authorities.

Date: 07.07.2026

Sd/-
Anil Sharma
3rd Floor, Property No. 2/61, Bhim Gali, Vishwas Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032

भारतीय प्रबंधन संस्थान रांची
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT RANCHI
(विश्व विद्यालय, विश्व विद्यालय) (Ministry of Education, Government of India)

Special Recruitment Drive for SC/ST/NC-OBC/EWS/PPWD for Faculty Positions
(IIM Ranchi invites applications from SC/ST/NC-OBC/EWS/PPWD category candidates with exceptional academic backgrounds for faculty positions in the following areas:-)

- Information Systems & Business Analytics
- Finance & Accounting
- Legal Studies & Responsible Business (Business Law)

For further details regarding eligibility and application process please visit the website- <https://iimranchi.ac.in/careers/>
Last date to apply: July 29, 2026

www.iimranchi.ac.in

प्रोफेसर नगर, नगरपालिका, रांची-769002, झारखंड

HMR INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND MANAGEMENT
HAMIDPUR, DELHI-110036
(An ISO 9001: 2015 Certified, AICTE Approved & GGSIU Affiliated Institute)
Ph: 8130643674, 8130643678, 8130643690, 8130653751, 8287481931
Website: www.hmrinstitute.ac.in

Admission Notice:

Management Quota Academic Session: 2026-2027

Applications are invited for 10% seats under Management Quota for the given courses:

- **B.Tech:** Computer Science & Engineering, Computer Science & Engineering - (Artificial Intelligence), Computer Science & Engineering - (Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning), Information Technology, CSE (Cyber Security), Computer Science & Technology, CSE (Data Science), Electrical Engineering & Mechanical Engineering
- **LE B.Tech:** Computer Science and Engineering

- **Eligibility:** As per eligibility criteria given in the Admission Brochure of GGSIU University.
- **Application Forms:** The form can be obtained from the Institute Reception between 9:00am to 3:00pm on all working days or can be downloaded from the institute website or can be filled online at www.hmrinstitute.ac.in, as per schedule given below:

- 1. Starting date of management quota registration 10th July, 2026
- 2. Closing date of management quota registration 27th July, 2026
- 3. Display of merit list and Conduct of Counselling will be done upto 31st July 2026. The detailed schedule will be displayed on our website.

Reservation of seats as per Reservation Policy given in Admission Brochure of GGSIU.
Management Quota registration fees is Rs. 2500/- (non-refundable)

DIRECTOR

भारतीय प्रबंधन संस्थान रांची
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT RANCHI
(विश्व विद्यालय, विश्व विद्यालय) (Ministry of Education, Government of India)

Faculty Recruitment Drive
(IIM Ranchi invites applications from candidates with exceptional academic backgrounds for faculty positions in the following areas:-)

- Information Systems & Business Analytics
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Last date to apply: July 29, 2026

www.iimranchi.ac.in

प्रोफेसर नगर, नगरपालिका, रांची-769002, झारखंड

AXIS BANK

Branch Office - Axis Bank Limited, SBB Loan Center SCO-221, 2nd Floor, Paramjeet Tower, Sector-12, Karnal-132001 Corporate Office: 3rd Floor, Block-B, Bombay Dyeing Mills Compound, Pandurang Budhakar Temple, Law garden, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-380006

Publication of Notice regarding possession of property u/s 13(4) of SARFAESI Act 2002

Notice is hereby given under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with rule 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, a demand notice was issued on the dates mentioned against each account and stated hereinafter calling upon them to repay the amount within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice. The Borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of power conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 9 of the said Act on the dates mentioned against each account. The Borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Axis Bank Ltd for an amount and interest thereon. The borrowers attention is invited to provisions of Sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available to redeem the secured assets.

1. Name of Borrower/Guarantor/Address: 1. Mr. Lakanvir Singh S/o Mr. Gulab Singh VPO Jao, Phoolta Nala, Near Nala Par Kosi Kalan, Distt-mathura-281403 Uttar Pradesh 2. Mrs. Manju C/o Mr. Lakanvir Singh S/o VPO Jao, Near Nala Par Kosi Kalan, Distt-mathura-281403 Uttar Pradesh

Declaration of Property: All the part and parcel of Residential House Measuring 125 Sq. Mtrs., M.C House Tax No-653, Situated At-- Mouja Kosi Kalan, Mani Mani Was Railway Area Raghunathpuri, Tehsil- Chhatta, Distt- Mathura Haryana Owned by Mr. Manju Vide Sale Deed No. 2655 Dated 11-FEB-2022. Boundaries-North -- Property of Sukdev, South -- House of Chhail Bihari, East -- Property of Roshan, West- Rasta

Date of Demand	NPA Date	Date of Possession	Amount Outstanding : Rs.
25-03-2026	01-01-2026	03-07-2026	Rs. 26,80,638.30/- (Rupees Twenty Six Lakhs Eighty Thousand Six Hundred Thirty Eight And Thirty Paise Only)

Place: Uttar Pradesh, Date: 10.07.2026

-SD/- Authorized Officer, Axis Bank Ltd.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform to all concern that M/s C. Lal & Brothers through its Prop. Mr. Jawahar Lal S/o Late Sh. Sohan Lal R/o Vill. 1433, Street No.7, Wazir Nagar, Kotla Mubarakpur, New Delhi who is the original allottee of property No. E.W.S Flat No. 187, Block-E, Sector-36 Noida (U.P.) had sold the said property to the following person of Attorney basis to the following person: Mr. Manju Singh S/o Late Sh. Ravindra Pratap Singh R/o Village-Phattapur, Nisphe, P.O. Kilaipuri, Distt. Jaunpur, (U.P.) if any one has/have any objection he/she may file his/her objection alongwith the sufficient proof in the Housing Department of the Noida Authority within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice.

Ravindra Pratap Singh

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of Poochendra Meena who is purchasing ENTIRE SECOND FLOOR WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, AREA MEASURING 100 SQ. YDS., PORTION OF PLOT NO. C-154/2 AND C-154/3, OUT OF KHASRA NO. 54, SITUATED AT VILLAGE PALAM DELHI STATE DELHI ABAZI KNOWS AS RAJ NAGAR PALAM COLONY NEW DELHI-110045 from Mr. Balwan Singh who had owned the subject property vide 2 Notarized GPA, ATS, WILL, dated 29.07.1998 executed by Purnan Singh now Poochendra Meena is intend to purchase the subject property and same to be mortgaged with ADITYA BIRLA HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED SO, to comply the requirements of BANK/NBFC, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest/creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within 15 days from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc. Lucern Legal LLP N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre New Delhi-110049 Contact # 011-40046316 & 41667327

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that Entire First Floor and Second Floor of the Property bearing Plot No. 1, area measuring 500 Sq. Yds., in Kharsa No. 478/396/87/1 Presently in the Village Masaudpur, New Delhi, situated owned and possessed by Shri Sandeep Chaudhary by virtue of GPA, Agreement to Sell, Will, Receipt, Possession, dated 31.10.2017 and the same is offered as Bank Premises to State Bank of India and as per present owner(s) version the said property is/are free from all sorts of encumbrance.

It is hereby notified that any person and/ or Bank/financial institution having any claim, any charge, interest or lien or claim and / or objection to same, he/ she/ they may lodge/ notify the thereof to the undersigned with documentary proof/ court judgment within 15 days from the day of publication of this public notice, failing which any further / future claim/ objection(s) shall be rejected.

SATYENDER YADAV (Advocate)
Chamber No. 561, 3rd Floor, Saket Courts, New Delhi, Mob.: 9711212421, E-mail: satender175@gmail.com

यूनियन बैंक ऑफ इंडिया
भारत सरकार का उपक्रम

Union Bank of India
A Government of India undertaking

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rule, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Secured Creditor, the Physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of Union Bank of India (secured creditor), will be sold on **below mentioned dates** "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" on the date mentioned below, for recovery of dues as mentioned hereunder to Union Bank of India from the below mentioned Borrower(s) & Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and the Earnest Money Deposit are also mentioned hereunder:

S. No.	Name of Branch	Name & address of Borrower & Guarantor	Description of the Immovable property put for auction	Status of the possession Physical/ Constructive	Dues to be Recovered from Borrower/ Guarantor (Rs.)	Reserve Price (Rs.) EMD Bid Increment	Date and Time of Auction (with 10 min unlimited auto extensions)
1	Kirti Nagar (05732)	1. Ms. Bharti Shami (Borrower) 71A, SG Pocket , Jhilmil, Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095 Also at: 127 D , 3rd floor, Pocket-I, Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095	All that part and parcel of the property no. 127 D, 3rd floor, Pocket - I, Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095, Bounded: On the North-east - open space/park, On the South-west - entrance/stairs, On the East-south - open space/road, On the West-north - other property	Physical	Rs. 60.69 Lacs + further interest thereon, charges and costs.	Rs. 90,00,000.00 Rs. 9,00,000.00 Rs. 90,00,000.00	11.08.2026 from 12.00 PM to 05.00 PM (with 10 min unlimited auto extensions)

Date & Time of E-Auction: 11-08-2026 from 12:00 Noon to 05:00 PM

Last date of Submission of bid: On or before the commencement of e-Auction

For All Property Sr. No. 1 : Invariably, the first bid of the property/ies will be Reserve Price + one Increment.

This amount will be the minimum bid amount to participate in bidding process.

Authorized Officer - Ms. Ankita Rajput, 7757016816

For detailed terms and condition of the sale, please refer to the link provided in <https://baanknet.com> and <https://www.unionbankofindia.bank.in/auction-property/viewauction-property.aspx>. Further Bidder for Registration and Login and Bidding Rules visit <https://baanknet.com> only.

This may also be treated as STATUTORY 30 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & Rule 9(1) OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES 2002, to the borrower's and guarantor/s

Date: 08-07-2026

Place : New Delhi

Authorised Officer, Union Bank of India

Regional Office New Delhi First Floor, 1, Faiz Road, Jhandewalan, New Delhi-110005
Email Id: law.ronewdelhi@unionbankofindia.bank.in
crld.ronewdelhi@unionbankofindia.bank.in

SALE NOTICE
for Sale of Immovable Properties

कार्यालय नगर निगम, हरिद्वार
पत्रांक- 06 / नविपनरि(कुम्भ-2027) / 2026-27
दिनांक- 08.07.2026

ई- निविदा सूचना

निविदा समिति द्वारा प्रदान किये गये अनुमोदन क्रम में नगर निगम हरिद्वार द्वारा कुम्भ मेला-2027 में मेला क्षेत्रांतर्गत एस०डब्ल्यूएम० के अंतर्गत कूड़ा उठाव व परिवहन एवं साफ-साफाई आदि व्यवस्था हेतु (हाइन / मशीनरी क्रेड) Refuse Compactor 10 CUM (10 Nos) & Refuse Compactor 14 CUM (08 Nos) क़य किये जाने हेतु टू-विड (तकनीकी एवं वित्तीय) प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से फ़र्म का चयन किये जाने हेतु www.uktenders.gov.in पर ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित सभी सूचना www.uktenders.gov.in से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

S.No.	Scheduled/Information	Date	Time
1	Date of Online publication	09.07.2026	16:00
2	Document Download start Date	09.07.2026	16:30
3	Online Bid Submission Start Date	23.07.2026	14:00
4	Pre-bid meeting (Municipal Commissioner office Mela Office CCR)	17.07.2026	12:00
5	Online Bid Submission End Date	03.08.2026	16:00
6	Offline Submission of Hard/Original copy of Document End date	03.08.2026	16:00
7	Bid opening Date	03.08.2026	17:00

उपरोक्त तिथियों में कोई संशोधन / परिवर्तन मात्र www.uktenders.gov.in

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नगर आयुक्त नगर निगम हरिद्वार

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that Entire First Floor and Second Floor of the Property bearing Plot No. 1, area measuring 500 Sq. Yds., in Kharsa No. 478/396/87/1 Presently in the Village Masaudpur, New Delhi, situated owned and possessed by Shri Sandeep Chaudhary by virtue of GPA, Agreement to Sell, Will, Receipt, Possession, dated 31.10.2017 and the same is offered as Bank Premises to State Bank of India and as per present owner(s) version the said property is/are free from all sorts of encumbrance.

It is hereby notified that any person and/ or Bank/financial institution having any claim, any charge, interest or lien or claim and / or objection to same, he/ she/ they may lodge/ notify the thereof to the undersigned with documentary proof/ court judgment within 15 days from the day of publication of this public notice, failing which any further / future claim/ objection(s) shall be rejected.

SATYENDER YADAV (Advocate)
Chamber No. 561, 3rd Floor, Saket Courts, New Delhi, Mob.: 9711212421, E-mail: satender175@gmail.com



(Left to right) Commuters make their way through a waterlogged road following heavy rain in the Gazipur area; a vehicle stuck in a caved-in section of a road after heavy rainfall in the Burari area; a commuter pushes his two-wheeler as he makes his way through a waterlogged underpass during heavy rainfall at Jangpura in New Delhi on Thursday. The India Meteorological Department issued a 'red' alert for Delhi, warning of moderate to heavy rain accompanied by thunderstorms and lightning. PTI

4 waterlogging-hotspot underpasses stay open amid rain; PWD minister reviews operations

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Minto Bridge, Zakhira, Dhaula Kuan, and Moolchand, four Delhi underpasses historically associated with severe waterlogging during heavy rain, remained open with traffic moving smoothly on Wednesday and Thursday.

However, parts of the city recorded over 100 mm of rainfall in 24 hours. The PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh reviewed live operations from the department's 24x7 Monsoon Control Room and said that during the last 48 hours, approximately 120 public calls were received and most waterlogging was cleared within 15 to 30 minutes.

Singh reviewed the situation from the control room, where officials monitored live CCTV feeds and coordinated field operations. He was informed that the PWD has identified 45 waterlogging-prone locations across the city, all under continuous surveillance through 179 CCTV cameras connected to the central control room.

The department has deployed 754 permanent pumps at 167 locations and 305 temporary pumps at 273



locations across Delhi. Engineering teams, machinery, and emergency staff remain on standby throughout the monsoon season.

The control room is staffed round the clock with Assistant Engineers who receive complaints through three channels: the toll-free helpline 1908, the control room number 011-23490323, and a WhatsApp Chatbot at 8130188222. All complaints received are forwarded immediately to the concerned Executive Engineer, Assistant Engineer, and field staff for action.

Officials told the minister that parts of Delhi recorded an average of approximately 100 mm in the last 24 hours, with several areas experiencing significantly heavier spells. Despite these condi-

tions, continuous monitoring and rapid field deployment kept disruption minimal at critical locations.

Singh drew a contrast with past monsoon seasons. "There was a time when Delhiites would worry every time it rained because waterlogging meant blocked roads, stranded vehicles and hours of inconvenience. We had assured the people that this situation would change through better planning and stronger infrastructure. Today's rainfall has shown that when preparation meets commitment, results are visible on the ground," he said.

He attributed the performance of the four historical problematic underpasses specifically to months of advance preparation. "More

than 100 mm of rainfall has been recorded in several parts of Delhi over the last 24 hours, yet locations like Minto Bridge, Zakhira, Dhaula Kuan and Moolchand, once known for severe waterlogging, have continued to function with traffic moving smoothly. This has been possible because of months of preparation and the tireless efforts of our engineers, field staff and emergency teams," he said.

The performance of the four underpasses is significant because they have historically been the most visible symbols of Delhi's monsoon failures. Photographs of submerged vehicles at Minto Bridge became a recurring image in media coverage of Delhi floods year after year. The Government's claim that an additional drain constructed at Minto Bridge has permanently addressed the problem was made before the rains began, and Wednesday's 100-plus mm rainfall provided the first significant real-world test of that claim. The underpasses staying open suggests that the infrastructure changes made over the past several months had their intended effect.

Heavy rain batters NCR: Waterlogging, traffic chaos

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Noida/Ghaziabad/Gurugram

Heavy rainfall disrupted normal life in Noida, Ghaziabad and Gurugram on Thursday, causing widespread waterlogging, traffic snarls and the collapse of a residential road that sent a parked car and a scooter plunging into a pit.

Ghaziabad witnessed heavy rainfall on Thursday, with the India Meteorological Department (IMD) recording 164 mm of rainfall at Kamla Nehru Nagar and 134 mm at Hindon over the past 24 hours. Authorities also declared a holiday in Government schools in Ghaziabad. The downpour left roads submerged, disrupted traffic and normal life, while dramatic visuals of people using boats in flooded neighbourhoods and a road collapse in Vasundhara highlighted the scale of the disruption.

In one of the most serious rain-related incidents, a section of a road in Vasundhara Sector 13 in Ghaziabad caved in beside an under-construction basement after incessant rain, sending a parked car and a scooter into the pit. A nearby electricity pole also tilted into the crater. No one was injured, but both vehicles



were extensively damaged.

The District Magistrate (DM) issued the order keeping students' safety in mind. Following the closure order, several schools advised students to remain indoors, stay safe, and make productive use of the day by completing their pending assignments. The major areas affected in the city were Vijay Nagar, Indrapuram, Vaishali, Nehru Nagar, Sahibabad, Shastri Nagar, Siddharth Vihar, Bhopura, Mohan Nagar, Khora, Lal Kuan, Masuri, etc where people were roads and streets were seen filled with rain water. Traffic in the area witnessed crawling throughout the morning and day hours with bottlenecks at various points.

Vehicle owner Ajay Agrawal said the vehicles were parked

outside his house, where he lives with his brother Pushkar Singh, a retired superintendent engineer of the Awaz Vikas Parishad.

He alleged that a builder had excavated nearly 20 feet for a basement without adequate safety arrangements and that the road suddenly gave way towards the excavation around 8 am due to continuous rain.

According to Agrawal, the builder later used a crane to retrieve the vehicles. He said he has lodged a complaint at the Indrapuram police station, seeking action against the builder, proper safety arrangements at the construction site and compensation for the damage caused to his vehicles.

In Noida, several areas, including Sectors 16, 33, 62 and 12, witnessed severe waterlog-

ging, with knee-deep water reported at places, making movement difficult for pedestrians and two-wheeler riders. Several motorcycles and scooters stalled after water entered their exhausts, forcing riders to push their vehicles through flooded stretches. Some commuters crossed inundated roads by walking along roadside dividers. Heavy traffic congestion was reported during the morning peak hours near the Botanical Garden area, where hundreds of cars, buses and two-wheelers moved at a crawl or remained stranded for long periods. A police officer said traffic was disrupted due to increased congestion caused by the rain but added that personnel remained deployed to regulate movement and ease traffic flow.

In Sector 63, a boundary wall of a company collapsed due to the rain. No injuries were reported. Millennium city Gurgaon received 33 mm of rain in just three hours in the afternoon, bringing the city to a grinding halt for the second consecutive day. As a result, commuters found themselves battling traffic snarls while also wading through murky, ankle-deep water, as several parts of the city witnessed waterlogging.

Most waterlogging stretches maintained by PWD, only 9 under MCD: Report

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi recorded 169 waterlogging locations during the 2025 monsoon, down from 194 in 2024, with the MCD claiming only nine of these fall under its jurisdiction.

According to the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD's) monsoon preparedness report for 2026, most of the waterlogging stretches identified by the Delhi Traffic Police are maintained by the Public Works Department (PWD), while only nine locations are under the civic body's jurisdiction.

It further suggested that waterlogging at these locations generally lasts between one and three hours, causing traffic disruption and inconvenience to commuters.

To ensure a swift response during heavy rainfall, nodal officers have been assigned for each of the 793 major drains and all identified waterlogging points under the MCD's jurisdiction.

According to the official report, to tackle water accumulation during the monsoon, the civic body has kept 79 permanent pumping stations operational round-the-clock with dedicated staff



A driver pushes an autorickshaw through a waterlogged underpass during heavy rainfall at Jangpura in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

and nodal officers.

It has also increased the number of temporary pumps from 427 last year to 465 this year, while another 40 pumps are under procurement. The civic body said it had removed 1,80,595 metric tonnes of silt from 793 major drains covering 545.35 km up to July 3, achieving 128.08 per cent of its desilting target of 1,41,003 metric tonnes.

It said desilting of major drains is being carried out through outsourced agencies using excavators, JCBs and manual labour, while 2,239 "nallah beldars" have

been deployed to clear floating waste on a daily basis.

The MCD has also set up 12 zonal control rooms and a central command and control room at its headquarters, besides constituting ward-level teams to respond to complaints and emergencies during heavy rainfall.

The report said all zonal heads have been directed to remain on alert and ensure prompt deployment of manpower and machinery to minimise waterlogging in areas under the corporation's jurisdiction.

DDA clears 57,000 MT silt from drains, 70% more than last year

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has cleared 57,000 metric tonnes (MT) of silt from stormwater drains till now, officials said on Thursday.

According to officials, a dedicated 24/7 helpline is also being set up for waterlogging-related complaints. Mobile pumping units have been stationed at identified vulnerable locations to enable the swift removal of accumulated rainwater.

Under the extensive drive, 70 per cent more silt has been removed till now than last year, they said. To facilitate efficient implementation, the city was divided into six operational zones, including East, South, North, Narela, Rohini and Dwarka, enabling focused planning, close supervision and timely execution of the works.

During the previous year's pre-monsoon drive, approximately 33,380 MT of silt was removed from stormwater drains.

"The extensive drive has significantly strengthened Delhi's drainage infrastruc-



ture ahead of the monsoon season and enhanced the city's preparedness to effectively manage heavy rainfall," the DDA said in a statement.

"The DDA has established a Central Flood Control Room along with flood control rooms in all engineering zones," it said.

"Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu has been continuously reviewing the progress of desilting operations to ensure that people in the national capital do not face any inconvenience due to heavy rainfall. In compliance with his directions, DDA accelerated field-level execution and monitored the progress on a regular basis," the statement said.

Compensation demands grow after Rohini building collapse

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The family of Ram, a 42-year-old man killed in the Rohini building collapse, has begun an indefinite protest at the cave-in site and refused to take his body or perform his last rites, demanding compensation for his widow and two school-going children.

A mechanic by profession, he was one of three people who died after an under-construction four-storey building at properties G-4/152 and G-4/153 near an MCD school collapsed in Rohini's Sector 16 on Wednesday, around 4.20 pm amid heavy rain, burying workers and others under tonnes of concrete.

While rescue teams worked through the night to recover those trapped under the debris, his family sat, mourning a loss they say has destroyed the future of an entire household.

Ram died when the building collapsed on him while he was passing by with his friend, who was saved.

"We have refused to take the body despite people telling us to complete the formalities, but we won't



Debris cleared after a three-storey under-construction house collapsed at Rohini amid heavy rainfall in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

We need financial help so that his wife can earn a livelihood and ensure that their two sons, studying in Classes VI and IX do not have to abandon their education. We are sitting on an indefinite strike. If nobody listens to us, we will intensify our protest. My brother is gone, but his family is still alive," Ram's twin brother, Shyam, said.

His voice breaking repeatedly, Shyam said, "Our family is devastated. We are not asking for anything unreasonable." The family, he said, would not collect Ram's body from the mortuary until the Government gives them a written assurance of compensation, as

the family had already endured the worst imaginable moment.

"We have already seen Ram in the worst possible condition. Whether his body remains in the mortuary for two days or four days makes no difference to us now. What matters is that the Government comes forward to help the family," he said.

Just a few metres away from where Ram lost his life, another family was grappling with an equally painful loss. Twenty-four-year-old Noorul, alias Kaif, had come to Delhi barely three months ago, hoping to earn enough to support his mother and siblings. Instead, his family will receive his body.

CM launches construction of 12.377 km underground Inderlok-Indraprastha Metro Corridor

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday launched the construction of the Inderlok-Indraprastha Metro Corridor at the Sarai Rohilla Metro Station construction site. The occasion marked the start of a 12.377-kilometre fully underground extension of Delhi Metro's Magenta Line that will add 10 new underground stations. The extension will connect to seven existing Metro lines and, once complete, make the Magenta Line the longest in the Delhi Metro network at nearly 89 kilometres.

The launch involved the start of diaphragm wall construction at Sarai Rohilla Metro Station, marking the first phase of the

project. The ten underground stations on the new corridor are Inderlok, Daya Basti, Sarai Rohilla, Ajmal Khan Park, Jhandewalan Temple, Nabi Karim, New Delhi, Delhi Gate, Delhi Sachivalaya-IG Stadium, and Indraprastha.

The corridor's seven interchange connections make it one of the most significant additions to the Metro network in connectivity terms. At Inderlok, passengers will be able to change to the Red Line and the Green Line. At Nabi Karim, there will be an interchange with the existing Magenta Line.

New Delhi station will offer interchange with the Yellow Line and the Airport Express Orange Line. Delhi Gate will connect to the Violet Line, and Indraprastha to the Blue Line.



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta during the commencement of construction work on the Inderlok-Indraprastha corridor of Delhi Metro Phase-IV in New Delhi. PANKAJ KUMAR

Together, these seven interchanges will reduce the number of transfers needed for a large number of daily journeys across the city.

The destinations the corridor will serve directly include Sarai Rohilla Railway Station, New Delhi Railway Station, Delhi Sachivalaya, Jhandewalan Temple, Arun Jaitley Stadium, Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, Delhi Gate, Kartavya Path, India Gate, the National War Memorial, and Central Vista.

The line will also strengthen public transport access to Karol Bagh, Deshbandhu Gupta Road, and surrounding educational and commercial areas.

Sarai Rohilla station has been identified as one of the corridor's most significant nodes.

It will connect densely populated parts of central Delhi, including Karol Bagh Market and Liberty Cinema, with the Metro network for the first time, providing residents of the area with a direct underground route to key destinations across the city.

The Chief Minister said the Delhi Metro is the foundation of a developed Delhi and that the expansion of the network is a historic step toward providing citizens with safe, fast, and environment-friendly public transport.

She framed the new corridor in terms of pollution reduction, saying that as more people shift to Metro travel, dependence on private vehicles will decline, leading to reduced traffic congestion, lower fuel consumption, and lower carbon emissions.

The Inderlok-Indraprastha Corridor, once complete, will give the Magenta Line the highest number of interchange stations and underground stations of any line in the Delhi Metro network, and at 89 kilometres, it will be longer than any existing line.

For daily commuters, the practical implication is that a large number of trips currently requiring two or three changes can potentially be made with fewer or no interchanges once the new stations are operational.

The corridor is being developed in coordination between the Delhi Government, the Central Government, and the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation. Construction has now formally begun with the diaphragm wall work at Sarai Rohilla.

IN FOCUS



PM pitches ‘Grow more, Achieve more’ in Melbourne

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday asserted that India is firmly on course to become a developed nation, driven by the mantra “Grow More, Achieve More” and powered by its people.

Addressing a packed stadium at the ‘Melbourne Meets Modi’ event, also attended by Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese, Modi highlighted the deepening partnership between India and Australia in education, skills development and innovation. “India of the 21st century is working towards the goal of becoming a developed nation... This is an India that believes in ‘Grow More, Achieve More’,” Modi said, drawing loud cheers from the audience.

The Prime Minister emphasised that the foundation of India’s ambitious dreams lies in its citizens. “The foundation of India’s big dreams and great aspirations is its people... We, the People,” he



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese and others during the Australia-India Annual Leaders’ Summit in Melbourne

said, adding that the Government’s policies are centred on citizen welfare under the guiding principle of “Nagrik Devo Bhava” (Citizen is God). Modi spotlighted India’s expanding manufacturing prowess, saying the country is building a

comprehensive ecosystem “from chips to ships” while simultaneously advancing in frontier technologies such as 6G.

He drew attention to ‘Operation Sindoor’, under which Indian defence platforms demonstrated

their precision and effectiveness. “You must have seen the demo during ‘Operation Sindoor’.

Explosions were taking place at the terrorists’ hideouts, and the echo was reverberating across the world,” he remarked, eliciting enthusiastic applause. The Prime Minister noted that India now has more than 200,000 registered startups, with over 4,000 new ones being added every month. Hundreds of these are working in critical sectors like defence and space, which were opened to private participation only a few years ago.

“India’s first private space startup is set to launch a satellite on its own rocket very soon,” he informed the gathering. Recalling the historic Chandrayaan-3 landing on the Moon’s south pole — a feat no other country has achieved — Modi said India is not resting on its laurels. “As we say, ‘Grow more. Achieve More.’ Now India will send Gaganyaan, and we are working towards the goal of

building our own space station,” he added. Modi recalled India’s swift response to the recent earthquakes in Venezuela, launching a relief and rescue operation without delay. “We didn’t look at how far the distance was. India considered Venezuela’s pain as its own pain. When India helps, it doesn’t look at passports... That’s why the world places immense trust in India,” he said. The PM, who arrived in Australia on the second leg of his three-nation tour, described the visit as his third in the last 12 years — a “hat-trick” that reflects the strengthening of India-Australia ties. “The most important role in this has been played not by me, but by all of you, the Indian diaspora,” he said, acknowledging the community’s contribution to bilateral relations. The event saw warm exchanges between the two prime ministers and reinforced the growing people-to-people and strategic connect between India and Australia.

Oxytocin shots stored at room temperature seized in Capital

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The Delhi Drugs Control Department has seized 31,700 Oxytocin injections from a pharmaceutical premises in the Patparganj Industrial Area. The injections had allegedly been stored at room temperature since their procurement in May 2026, in violation of the mandatory cold chain storage requirement of 2 degrees Celsius to 8 degrees Celsius. The inspectors found that although a functional refrigerator was available on the premises, no medicines requiring cold storage had been kept in it.

The inspection was conducted under the department’s special enforcement programme on the directions of Health Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh. The seized stock is a batch of Oxytocin Injection IP 5 IU/ml, a temperature-sensitive medicine that requires strict cold chain maintenance as clearly specified on the product label.

The department found that the stock had not been maintained in accordance with the provisions of Rule 65(17) of the Drugs Rules, 1945. Oxytocin is a critical drug used primarily in obstetric and gynaecological care, including inducing labour and preventing post-partum



haemorrhage. Improper storage at room temperature can significantly deteriorate its potency, making it less effective or potentially unsafe when administered to patients.

The duration of improper storage, from May 2026 until the date of the inspection, makes the potential potency loss a serious concern.

The department seized the entire stock under the provisions of the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940, to prevent any risk to public health. It has also collected details of quantities from the same batch already supplied to other locations, to facilitate stop-sale and recall directions wherever necessary.

Further legal proceedings are being initiated under the Act and Rules.

Meet the fugitive who slipped the net in the Mahadev app betting scandal

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH

■ New Delhi

While Sourabh Chandrakar may soon be extradited from Oman, Ravi Uppal, another main accused in the ₹6,000-crore Mahadev Betting App case, is still missing. Uppal is believed to have helped set up and operate one of India’s biggest illegal betting networks. He has been on the run since late 2025, and investigators think he is hiding in Vanuatu, a Pacific island nation that does not have an extradition treaty with India.

Uppal, who is also from Chhattisgarh, like Chandrakar, is named by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) as a main accused in the money-laundering investigation connected to the Mahadev Online Book platform. The app reportedly made ₹200-240 crore each day from illegal betting on sports, cards, poker, and even elections. The total proceeds of crime are estimated at ₹6,000 crore. Uppal was briefly detained in Dubai in December 2023 after the ED requested an Interpol Red Notice.

He was released and managed to escape. By November 2025, UAE authorities told Indian agencies that he had left the country, and investigators later found he had gone to Vanuatu. This move has made India’s efforts to bring him back much harder, since Vanuatu does not have an extradition agreement with India. Despite his disap-



Ravi Uppal

PIONEER PHOTO

pearance, the ED kept up its actions against him.

In January 2026, they attached a Dubai property owned by Uppal, valued at about ₹6.75 crore, as part of new provisional attachments totalling over ₹21 crore in the case. In November 2025, the Supreme Court directed the ED to find and secure Uppal, expressing strong displeasure at how accused persons treat courts and investigators.

The agency has also tried to declare him a Fugitive Economic Offender under the Fugitive Economic Offenders Act, but the matter is still in court. Sourabh Chandrakar’s recent detention in Oman is a sharp contrast to Uppal’s situation.

Chandrakar was briefly held in the UAE in 2024 but managed to avoid further action. A few weeks ago, Omani police caught him while he

was allegedly travelling on a fake passport. He is now being held in Muscat’s high-security Al Khoud detention centre. India has already sent a formal extradition request and hopes to bring him back.

However, he has not yet been extradited. Reports say he appealed to Interpol’s Commission for the Control of Files to remove the Red Notice against him, claiming it was politically motivated. Like Chandrakar, Uppal is named in several ED charge sheets in the case, which also includes allegations of links to politicians in Chhattisgarh. The ED and CBI have thoroughly investigated the Mahadev case, conducting over 175 searches, attaching assets worth more than ₹1,700 crore, and arresting 13 people so far. Still, Uppal’s continued freedom shows how hard it is to bring back accused people who move to countries with little cooperation.

Investigators believe that with Chandrakar now in custody abroad, new information could emerge during his questioning once he is brought back to India. This could help locate Uppal and reveal more about the network of people and hawala channels behind the syndicate. But this case still underscores the challenge of bringing high-profile economic offenders to justice when they exploit safe havens beyond India’s immediate reach.

DU to begin sports ECA quota trials from July 15

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The University of Delhi will conduct physical trials for admissions under the Extra-Curricular Activities (ECA) quota from around July 15, while candidates seeking admission under the Sports Supernumerary Quota will also undergo discipline-specific trials.

University officials said that allocations and admissions in both categories are going to be done after the third round of the undergraduate seat allocation process. University officials on Thursday said admissions under the ECA and sports supernumerary categories would be conducted separately from the regular Common Seat Allocation System (CSAS-UG) process, as those are dependent on trials as well.

The first and second phases of the undergraduate admission process are currently running simultaneously. Candidates have until 11.59 pm on July 11 to complete subject mapping and fill their programme and college preferences, after which the preferences will be automatically locked.



A correction window will remain open from 10 am on Friday, July 10, to 11.59 pm on Saturday, July 11, allowing candidates to edit their application details. The first allocation list under the regular admission process is scheduled to be announced on July 16.

Officials said allocations under the ECA and sports quotas will take place after or with the third round of regular admissions.

Under the ECA quota, candidates can apply in up to three ECA categories, including sub-categories, and must upload five of their best certificates related to the chosen activity while submitting their applications.

The university offers admissions under 14 ECA categories, including dance, music, theatre, debate, creative writing, fine arts, digital media, quiz and yoga.

India, Australia deepen defence, nuclear ties

Albanese termed the relationship “more consequential than ever” and said the nuclear pact would help Australia export uranium for peaceful purposes while supporting India’s non-fossil fuel power capacity. “Australia values India as a top-tier security partner,” he added. The Australian leader highlighted new initiatives in defence, education, science, technology, energy security and critical minerals.

The summit also saw educational ties strengthened with Victoria University receiving approval to operate a campus in Gurugram and Flinders University getting a letter of intent for a campus in Bengaluru.

Modi arrived in Australia from Indonesia on the second leg of his three-nation tour, aimed at boosting trade, energy and defence cooperation amid a complex geopolitical landscape. Both sides emphasised diversifying supply chains and enhancing resilience in critical sectors. Describing India and Australia as “two vibrant democracies and ocean powers”, Modi said their shared worldview and mutual trust would continue to drive the bilateral relationship forward. Albanese echoed the sentiment, noting that six years into the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, the two nations are poised to grow “from strength to strength”.

The agreements mark a significant elevation in India-Australia ties, positioning the two countries as key partners in shaping a secure, prosperous and stable Indo-Pacific.

US hits Iran, Tehran targets Gulf allies

Bahrain said it shot down incoming fire, without elaborating.

There was no immediate word of damage in Qatar. The US military’s Central Command said it hit some 90 targets across Iran, releasing black-and-white footage of what appeared to be strikes on an airport runway and missile launchers.

The US said the strikes were intended to “further degrade” Iran’s ability “to threaten freedom of navigation” in the strait, through which a fifth of the world’s traded oil and natural gas passed before the war began with US and Israeli attacks on February 28.

Iranian State media reported explosions in several locations, including Bushehr, home to Iran’s nuclear power plant complex, and southern port cities.

In Iran’s southwestern Khuzestan province, at least three people were killed Thursday, State media reported. In Inranshahr, authorities said a strike killed a firefighter at an airport. Those fatalities followed the deaths of at least nine members

of Iran’s armed forces in Wednesday’s strikes, according to State media. It wasn’t clear when the other death happened and who was killed.

For the first time since April, US strikes also appeared to target Iranian bridges. State media reported a strike on a railway bridge in Iran’s northeastern Golestan province, and the Revolutionary Guard said two bridges were attacked on the route to Mashhad, where officials plan to bury the late Ayatollah Ali Khamenei on Thursday. Meanwhile Thursday, the State-run IRNA news agency quoted Ehsan Jahanian, a local official in Bushehr, as accusing the US of striking near Iran’s Bushehr nuclear power plant. He said the strike came around noon, hours after the US military’s Central Command said it had ended its strikes on Iran. Central Command did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

During the Iran war, several strikes hit in the area around the plant, which is managed by Russian technicians, but caused no damage to the plant itself. Trump fuelled concerns that the war could restart by saying Wednesday that the interim agreement to pause the fighting was “over.” He added that he would allow negotiations to continue, though he cast doubt on the outcome. “They can talk, but I think they’re wasting their time,” he said.

Iranian Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi, also a top negotiator, retorted on X that Trump’s remarks “are not a sign of power but an admission of the failure” of the US policy toward Iran. Negotiations to reach a final deal were due to start after the funeral for Khamenei, who was killed in the war’s first moments. The funeral, which ends Thursday, was supposed to be a period of lower tensions.

The talks are meant to focus on the toughest matters, including fully reopening the strait and rolling back Tehran’s disputed nuclear programme. (AP)

Heavy rain brings Delhi-NCR to a standstill

“Around 40 calls were received for waterlogging, of which 32 have been resolved till afternoon. Waterlogging was witnessed in areas like Mayur Vihar and Seelampur Gurudwara Road. Also, teams are working to clear the water in these areas,” an official said.

Trees uprooted by strong winds blocked roads at several places, while flooding disrupted vehicular movement and damaged houses.

According to the Delhi Fire Service (DFS), two trees fell on Raja Dhir Singh Marg in southeast Delhi’s East of Kailash: One near the ISKCON temple, and another near the National Heart Institute. Officials said these incidents briefly blocked traffic before authorities cleared the debris and no injuries were reported in any of the incidents across Delhi.

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Two more trees fell on Guru Ravidas Marg in the Kalkaji-Govindpuri area and on Dhingra Marg, prompting emergency response teams to remove the obstructions and restore vehicular movement. In a separate incident, a large tree fell on a parked car in Ranjeet Nagar, damaging the vehicle and the occupants escaped unhurt. Jagpinder Singh, a resident, claimed that despite his repeated complaints about the tree’s bad condition, civic authorities didn’t take action.

Several commuters and residents took to social media to share their ordeal. The IMD said the minimum temperature in Delhi settled at 24.3 degrees Celsius, 3.6 notches below normal. Generally cloudy skies with moderate to heavy rain, thunderstorms and lightning are expected during the day.

Weather experts have attributed the persistent rain over the past two days to the seasonal monsoon trough shifting northwards from central India towards the Himalayan foothills. They said Delhi is likely to continue receiving widespread rainfall until the system moves further north, after which the city is expected to witness drier spells.

After heavy rainfall lashed Delhi, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta hit the ground inspecting the drainage arrangements in Shalamar Village in her assembly constituency on Thursday and directed officials to ensure proper water drainage. The Public Works Department (PWD) minister Parvesh Sahib Singh also visited the PWD’s control at ITO to review the dewatering arrangements and said that in most cases the stagnant water was removed and the “situation is better than in previous years”.

Officials said that on the instructions of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, teams of Public Works Department, Municipal Corporation of Delhi and Delhi Jal Board have been deployed across the city to prevent waterlogging. They claimed that the situation on all major roads was “under control” despite the heavy rain.

Three ex-TMC MPs join BJP

“Today and at present they are BJP members and would work for the progress of West Bengal under the leadership of world’s most popular leader and Prime Minister Narendra Modi,” he added. Welcoming the three leaders at the party’s Salt Lake office Bhattacharya refused to dwell on whether more TMC leaders would follow suit.

Roy who had been complaining of victimization within the TMC had recently resigned from the Rajya Sabha citing rampant corruption in the party. His joining comes days after Union Home Minister Amit Shah held a closed door meeting with him during his visit to Kolkata on the 125th anniversary of Jana Sangh founder Dr

Shyama Prasad Mookerjee early this week.

“West Bengal has thus far been ruled by the political parties like the Left, the Trinamool Congress... this is the first time that we have a State Government that strives to work for its overall development so as to realize its full potentials that we have in skilled labour, minerals, three international borders, good agriculture and market ... the three leaders who have joined us will work towards achieving the dreams of Dr Mookerjee of one united India,” Bhattacharya said.

SC cracks down on civic bodies over violations

“We are particularly concerned with the conduct of Municipal Corporation of Delhi with regard to non-compliance of directions issued by the court in 2024 and specific directions of May 20, which were issued as to what was required to be done by the authorities,” the bench told Additional Solicitor General SD Sanjay, appearing for the MCD. The SC was also irked over the fact no effective action was taken on ground with regard to its May 20 directions for sealing, demolition, or any other action warranted in law for the unauthorised structures.

Observing that no “slackness” on the part of civic authorities will be tolerated, the court took on record status reports filed by senior advocate Ajit Sinha, who has been appointed amicus in the matter with regard to recent fire strategies in Delhi, Lucknow and action on unauthorised constructions. It also warned of initiating suo-moto contempt action against civic bodies which do not comply with its earlier directions.

Sinha, assisted by advocate Govind Jee, pointed out that recently two fire incidents that occurred on June 3 at Delhi’s Malviya Nagar and June 22 at Lucknow were not tragedies that were caused by a single failure but by the convergence of several. The bench, which took serious exception of non-compliance of its earlier directions, said the court has passed specific directives with respect to congested Lajpat Nagar and Sarojini Nagar areas in the Capital and indicated that such structures be immediately demolished to prevent any mishappening.

Sinha submitted that demolition of unauthorised construction and those violating building by-laws were to be done in two weeks but except for giving violators notice, no follow-up has been done. The bench said in such circumstances as no action has been taken in compliance with the directions issued in 2024 and on May 20, “we are of the opinion that strict cognisance be taken of the issue and officials of the MCD be summoned to the court.” The bench said it is not fully satisfied with the bona fide of the MCD but before taking any final view on the issue, was granting one last opportunity to the authorities to comply with its directions.

CBI expands Mahadev app probe, names 66...

The charges relate to offences under the IPC and the Chhattisgarh Gambling Prohibition Act. According to the CBI, Mahadev App was promoted and operated primarily from Dubai by Chandrakar and Uppal, both originally from Chhattisgarh. It functioned as an umbrella syndicate and provided platforms for illegal online betting on cricket, football, poker and other games.

The model relied on franchising panels or branches to associates on a profit-sharing basis (reportedly 70-30). These panels enrolled users via aggressive social media campaigns, created betting IDs and generated massive illegal profits. Investigators estimate the network processed enormous daily turnovers, with some reports citing up to 7200 crore per day at its peak, funneling proceeds through mule bank accounts, layered transactions and hawala channels before transferring funds abroad.

According to the CBI, part of the illicit gains were allegedly paid as protection money to public servants to shield the operation from enforcement action. The accused fled abroad years ago. Investigators have found that the promoters of the app and several of their associates fled to West Asian countries a few years ago. They are alleged to have continued operating the network from outside India. The CBI has already issued Red Corner Notices against the four main accused persons who are currently abroad. The agency has also initiated proceedings to declare them as Fugitive Economic Offenders (FEOs). At the same time, further investigation continues to trace the full extent of the syndicate, including any political or bureaucratic patronage it may have enjoyed.

According to the CBI, the investigation has found signs of political and bureaucratic support for the syndicate. Earlier Enforcement Directorate (ED) probes and CBI raids, including searches at more than 60 locations in March 2025 linked to politicians and senior officials, suggested protection money was involved. Investigations found that part of the illicit gains were allegedly paid as protection money to public servants to shield the operation from enforcement action.

Former Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Bhupesh Baghel has been named in related FIRs and accused of taking kickbacks, with some claims mentioning cash seizures linked to promoters through voice notes. Baghel has firmly denied these allegations, saying his Government filed numerous FIRs and took action against the app while he was in office.

The CBI has said more charge sheets will be filed as the probe progresses to bring all those involved to justice.

PoJK faces showdown as JAAC ultimatum raises tensions

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

Tensions in Pakistan-occupied Jammu and Kashmir (PoJK) have escalated after the Jammu Kashmir Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC) gave Islamabad a 48-hour ultimatum. JAAC warned of a "grand and final" phase of protests if its 38-point charter is ignored, and it planned major demonstrations before the July 27 Assembly elections. What began as economic complaints has now turned into a direct challenge to the region's political relationship with Pakistan.

JAAC is a coalition of traders, transporters, lawyers, students, and civil society groups formed in 2023. It initially gained support due to rising electricity bills and wheat prices, even though PoJK has its own hydropower resources. The group's 38-point charter, created after deadly protests in 2025, calls for immediate relief and long-term reforms. Economic demands include setting electricity tariffs based on local generation costs and providing wheat subsidies, as in Gilgit-Baltistan. Structural demands include reducing elite privileges, shrinking the PoJK Cabinet, cutting bureaucratic perks, and,



Protests in PoK

FILE PHOTO

most controversially, abolishing 12 reserved seats in the PoJK Legislative Assembly for refugees from Jammu and Kashmir who live in Pakistan.

JAAC argues that these seats allow parties close to Islamabad to influence PoJK Governments without being accountable to local people. After violent clashes in 2025, an agreement promised compensation, new education boards, health funding, infrastructure projects, and a monitoring committee. However, only some of these promises have been kept, leading to renewed protests.

Pakistan's Supreme Court ruling upheld their constitutional status, requiring amendments to remove

them. JAAC responded with renewed agitation. On June 5, authorities banned the organisation under anti-terrorism laws. A region-wide shut down and wheel-jam strike on June 9 triggered clashes, particularly in Rawalakot and Poonch, with reports of multiple deaths and injuries on both sides. Security forces were deployed in large numbers, and communications were restricted in parts of the region.

People in PoJK accuse authorities of using arrests, excessive force, and a blockade that has caused shortages. Sit-ins continue, and leaders have promised to keep protesting until all demands are met.

As the July 9 deadline neared, JAAC stepped up its calls for action, urging people in PoJK and the Kashmiri diaspora to join a "grand and final" protest. They plan new demonstrations and may march on the capital, similar to earlier threats of a long march. The timing is deliberate, as nominations for the July 27 elections have started, and any unrest could disrupt the electoral process that Islamabad wants to show as normal.

There are deeper issues behind the current crisis. Most of the hydropower produced in PoJK is fed into Pakistan's national grid, yet local people still pay high electricity rates. Islamabad still has strong control over the region, and real autonomy is limited, even though the area is called "Azad." The refugee seats show this imbalance, as critics say they weaken local representation.

In the coming days, it will become clear whether talks will work or if protests and unrest will continue and become even riskier. JAAC's actions show how frustrated ordinary people are with broken promises. Pakistan now faces the challenge of controlling the unrest without making people feel more alienated or attracting international attention.

Mining banned in Himachal Pradesh till September, says Industries Minister Chauhan



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Shimla

A complete ban has been imposed on mining activities in Himachal Pradesh till September due to the monsoon, Industries Minister Harshwardhan Chauhan said on Thursday. He said stringent action will be taken against those violating the ban.

Talking to mediapersons here, Chauhan said the state government has completed all preparations to tackle potential disasters during the monsoon. Necessary instructions have been issued to all deputy commissioners, and adequate funds have been made available for relief and rescue operations.

In the event of a disaster, the district administrations would immediately launch relief and rescue operations to ensure that people receive assistance as quickly as possible, the minister said.

Chauhan said the State Government has adopted a strict stance against illegal mining, and continuous action is being taken across various regions, including the Himachal-Punjab border. Accountability is being fixed for the departments concerned wherever complaints of illegal mining arise.

Regarding the Bulk Drug Park project, the industries minister said construction work is progressing rapidly, with approximately 15 to 20 per cent of the work completed so far.

He informed that some tendering processes are in the final stages and will be concluded soon. About 75 per cent of work related to the power supply and approximately 95 per cent of work related to the drinking water system in the project area have been completed.

Additionally, funds have been released to the Public Works Department for road construction, and a double-lane road will be built to connect the project area, he added.

Shah unveils roadmap for smart borders

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah addressed the Land Border Districts' Superintendents of Police Conference-2026 in New Delhi, outlining a comprehensive strategic plan for enhancing India's border security infrastructure.

The conference has established a holistic approach to land border management and is poised to extend this integrated framework to coastal borders in the near future. Shah emphasised that the Modi Government is developing a robust quadrangular security network that integrates border-guarding forces, State and district administrations, Central Government stakeholders, and local communities. This development signifies a transition from isolated border outposts to a cohesive, proactive security system.

India's border security, guided by the "Smart Border" initiative, is anticipated to become one of the most advanced globally through the deployment of cutting-edge technology, real-time surveillance, and scientific planning.

Highlighting key accomplishments, the Home Minister noted that under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, the country has made significant progress in eradicating Naxalism and terrorism in



Jammu and Kashmir as well as in the North-East.

To combat the narcotics trade, the government aims to inflict substantial damage within the next three years and achieve complete victory. A comprehensive mechanism is being established to make India entirely infiltration-free by addressing fundamental issues rather than implementing temporary solutions. Border infrastructure has been expanded by 400 per cent through a scientific, technology-driven approach.

The Vibrant Villages Programme has transformed the narrative by prioritising the last village in the country as its first. The initiative focuses on preventing out-migration, creating local employment opportunities, and ensuring the full delivery of Government welfare schemes in remote border regions. Prime Minister Modi has launched the Demography Mission to systematically analyse demo-

graphic changes in border areas, identify abnormal growth patterns driven by infiltration, and recommend corrective measures. The Government is committed to addressing such demographic shifts with a firm and rigorous approach.

Information regarding demographic changes must be disseminated swiftly from the grassroots to the highest policy levels. In a major initiative to secure vulnerable frontiers, the Modi government is constructing fencing along the entire 1,610-kilometre India-Myanmar border at an estimated cost of over ₹31,000 crore.

The overarching objectives are to prevent proxy warfare, illegal infiltration, radicalisation, narcotics trafficking, smuggling, drone threats, cybercrime, organised crime, and demographic alterations. The vision is to transform border areas into secure, prosperous, and livable regions while maintaining zero tolerance for any threats to national security.

Congress questions PM's silence on Ayodhya row



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Congress on Thursday questioned Prime Minister Narendra Modi's silence over the issue of "embezzlement" of Ram temple donations and alleged that attempts are being made to save the "big fish" and take action against small employees.

In a post on X, Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh claimed that several irregularities relating to land purchase and construction of the temple have also come to light.

"After the theft of offerings at the Ram temple in Ayodhya came to light, several major irregularities related to land purchase and construction have also surfaced.

"Despite all this, Prime Minister Modi remains silent and the entire BJP-RSS apparatus is attempting to protect the big fish by taking action against a few small employees," Ramesh said in a post in Hindi on X.

Addressing a press conference here, Congress leader Surinder Rajput said Modi cannot escape responsibility in the Ram temple "donation-theft case" as it was he who had established the trust to look after the management of the shrine.

He also questioned the involvement of people with a specific ideology in this trust.

"In the donation-embezzlement issue, a few small fish are being used as bait to protect the big fish. In this entire matter, the needle of suspicion also points towards the RSS and the VHP, and we demand answers from them," Rajput said.

He said it was Modi who had laid the foundation stone of the Ram temple and it was he who had performed the "Pran Pratishtha" (consecration) of the deity.

"When a big sin of stealing the offerings has been committed, Prime Minister Modi should clarify. The Ram temple is a matter of faith for crores of people and the prime minister, the RSS and the VHP cannot escape responsibility," the Congress leader said.

He also demanded that the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) clarify whether it had any role in the "donation theft" and asked why the temple trust was kept out of the purview of the Right to Information (RTI) Act.

"If the trust is entirely religious, why were only people connected to the BJP-RSS placed in it? The prime minister will have to answer these questions," he said.

PM 3-nation tour yields strategic gains: BJP

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The BJP on Thursday said Prime Minister Narendra Modi's ongoing three-nation tour has been marked by several "unprecedented" achievements, including a major BrahMos missile deal with Indonesia, agreements on critical minerals and the development of strategic infrastructure that strengthen India's global standing.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP headquarters here, party national spokesperson Tuhin Sinha said every foreign visit by Modi reflects the Government's commitment to development and national progress.

"This visit, too, has been associated with several significant and, in many ways, unprecedented achievements that deserve greater attention," he said.

Sinha termed the pro-



posed BrahMos missile agreement with Indonesia, the "biggest outcome" of the visit and said India has agreed to supply the supersonic cruise missile system to Jakarta under its "largest-ever" defence deal, valued at around ₹5,400 crore.

"Indonesia becomes the third country, after the Philippines and Vietnam, to procure the BrahMos missile system from India. This is a major endorsement of the Modi Government's 12-year push for Make in India in defence manufacturing and reflects India's growing

Nation Focus



BAIL GRANTED TO SANJAY KUMAR SON IN POCSO CASE

The Telangana High Court on Thursday granted conditional bail to Union Minister Bandi Sanjay Kumar's son, Bageerath, who was arrested in connection with a POCSO case registered against him.

The High Court on July 6 reserved its orders in the bail petition filed by Bageerath. The court allowed Bageerath's plea and directed him to furnish a personal bond for a sum of Rs One lakh with two sureties for a like sum each and other conditions, including directing him to cooperate with the investigation.

"The petitioner shall appear before the concerned SHO at 11:00 am on every Monday for a period of eight weeks or till filing of chargesheet, whichever is earlier, for the purpose of investigation, and thereafter, as and when required," the court order said. (PTI)



ABVP CELEBRATES 78 YEARS WITH MULTIPLE CAMPAIGNS

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) on Thursday celebrated National Students' Day and its 78th foundation day by organising seminars, blood donation camps, tree plantation drives, cleanliness campaigns and other programmes across the country.

According to a statement issued by the ABVP, the celebrations also included youth interactions, counselling sessions, essay and debate competitions, cultural programmes and intellectual discussions, it said.

"The celebrations included seminars, youth interactions, community service initiatives, blood donation camps, tree plantation drives, cleanliness campaigns, counselling sessions, essay and debate competitions, cultural programmes, intellectual discussions, and floral tribute and cleanliness programmes at memorials of Swami Vivekananda," the statement said. (PNS)

Centre approves 17 road projects worth ₹611 crore for Arunachal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Itanagar

The Centre has approved 17 road projects worth ₹611.17 crore to improve connectivity across Arunachal Pradesh, Chief Minister Pema Khandu said on Thursday.

Announcing this in a social media post, Khandu termed it another major boost to the State's development journey and thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari for their continued support.

"Our State's development journey has received another significant boost with the Ministry of Road Transport & Highways (MoRTH), Government of India, approving 17 road projects worth ₹611.17 crore under the Central Road and Infrastructure Fund (CRIF) 2026-27 for Arunachal Pradesh," the chief minister



Arunachal Pradesh Chief Minister Pema Khandu

said in a post on X. According to an official communication by the ministry, the approval follows a proposal submitted by the Arunachal Pradesh Public Works Department seeking clearance for 17 priority road projects under the CRIF scheme.

While the State Government had sought approval for projects worth ₹592.50 crore, the ministry approved works amounting to ₹611.17 crore. The sanctioned projects are spread

across several districts and include the construction and improvement of major district roads as well as important connectivity projects.

Among the major works approved are the construction of the Ningcho-Langpia road in East Kameng, Latsum Pate-Namorah road in Pakke Kessang, Hara Happa to Upper Nyorch road in Papum Pare, Gengi to Subansiri Ferry Ghat road in Lower Siang, and Mirem to Resing road in East Siang.

■ States Focus ■



Hyderabad should host 2036 Olympics, says CM Reddy

Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy on Thursday said that his vision is to see Hyderabad hosting the Olympics in 2036. Speaking at the launch of the logo and website of Young India Physical Education and Sports University (YIPESU) here, he said sports policy should be formulated first, followed by the establishment of training institutes, academies and other institutions.

The State Government is keen on establishing such institutions, he said. Telangana had no sports policy during the last 12 years (during the previous BRS regime), he said. Recalling that Hyderabad had hosted the Afro-Asian Games and Military World Games during 1999-2004, he said no such major events were held in Hyderabad in the last two decades. The sports infrastructure, including sports stadiums, built in Hyderabad during undivided Andhra Pradesh, was used for organising marriages and political programmes in the last several years, which is unfortunate, he said.

"I have decided to revive sports culture in Hyderabad, Telangana. In 2036, India wants to host the Olympics. We are preparing our state, our Hyderabad to host the Olympics. That's my dream," he said. (PTI)



Himachal Govt withholding MPLADS fund: Kangana

Mandi MP Kangana Ranaut on Thursday accused the Congress-led Himachal Pradesh Government of withholding the MPLADS fund which she had allocated for the development of Kullu and Mandi districts.

She said this during her visit to Chansari village in Kullu, where she inaugurated a mobile medical van-based primary and preventive health services operated by Matrix Society for Social Services in collaboration with NHPC Limited.

Addressing the people, Ranaut said that the BJP government at the Centre is continuously providing funds for the development of Himachal Pradesh, but the Congress Government is blatantly denying this fact.

"Just as a corrupt Government was ousted from West Bengal, the Congress party will soon be wiped out in Himachal Pradesh. This will enable the BJP, both at the Centre and in the state, to approve major projects and restart public welfare services," she said. (PTI)

Flash floods submerge 100-foot iron bridge in HP's Kinnaur

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Shimla/Rampur

Flash floods triggered by heavy rains submerged a 100-foot iron bridge, cutting off Lippa village from other areas in Himachal Pradesh's Kinnaur district on Thursday, officials said. A massive surge in the Pejar Nallah (stream) within the Lippa Panchayat obstructed the flow of the Teti Khad (drain). Consequently, the iron bridge was completely submerged and is now unsafe. Several houses located near the bridge are also at risk.

Due to rainfall since Wednesday, water levels in many of the district's rivers and streams have risen significantly above normal. The administration is monitoring the situation and urging people to avoid venturing near water bodies and to refrain from unnecessary travel. A debris fall on the Shiller-Pathia link road near Kasauli in Solan district also impacted the traffic movement. The Shimla Met Office issued a yellow alert for heavy rains at isolated places in the state till July 15.

Since Wednesday evening, moderate to heavy rains continued to lash parts of the state, with Shimla, Kangra and Jot receiving thunderstorms and lightning.

Nahan in Sirmour district was wettest in the state recording 89.6 mm of rainfall followed by Solan (46.8 mm), Jot (45.2 mm) Malroan (41 mm), Sarahan (38.7 mm), Poanta Sahib (34.4 mm), Kalpa (29.9 mm), Bilaspur 24.8 mm, Guler (24.4 mm).

Assam-Meghalaya ties cordial, says Himanta

TONY DAS ■ Jowai (Meghalaya)

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Thursday said his State and Meghalaya continued to maintain a friendly and cooperative approach towards resolving their decades-old boundary dispute, asserting that there was "no friction" between the two neighbouring States.

Speaking to reporters on the sidelines of the annual Behdienkhlam festival in Jowai, Sarma said both governments remain in constant communication and are committed to resolving any issues that arise along the inter-state border through dialogue and mutual understanding.

Sarma was in Meghalaya to attend the festival, one of the most significant religious and cultural festivals of the Pnar (Jaintia) community.

Celebrated annually in Jowai town in eastern Meghalaya, the festival is observed to seek divine blessings for a bountiful harvest, good health and prosperity, while warding off diseases, calamities and evil spirits.

"I keep on meeting the CM and deputy CM. So, the channel of discussion is always open. We keep on meeting, and there is no friction. Whenever something happens, we resolve that immediately with the spirit of friendship," Sarma said.



Asked about reports of frequent friction in border areas, the Assam CM dismissed such concerns, saying the overall situation remains peaceful.

"I don't think so... everything is smooth," he added.

His remarks come days after the Meghalaya Government reconstituted its regional committees to take forward the second phase of boundary negotiations with Assam.

The committees have been tasked with holding consultations with local stakeholders and examining the remaining six disputed areas between the two States.

In the first phase of the talks, Assam and Meghalaya signed a landmark border settlement agreement in March 2022, resolving disputes in six of the 12 identified areas of difference. The second phase aims to resolve the remaining six areas of difference — Langpih, Borduar, Nongwah-Mawtamur, Deshdmoreaah, Block I and Block II, and Psiar-Khanduli.

Both Sarma and Meghalaya Chief Minister Conrad K Sangma have repeatedly reiterated their commitment to resolving the long-pending inter-state boundary dispute through dialogue, consultation and mutual understanding.

Sangma has said the reconstituted regional committees will engage with stakeholders, assess ground realities and submit their recommendations to facilitate progress in the second phase of the border talks.

J&K CM Omar Abdullah backs value-driven tourism

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Srinagar

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Thursday called for a shift from volume-driven to value-based tourism, saying there is a need to develop Jammu and Kashmir as a sustainable tourism destination and regulate the flow of visitors.

Addressing the inaugural session of the Conclave on Sustainable Tourism Planning — Designing Tourism for Tomorrow, organised by the Department of Tourism at the SKICC, Abdullah called for a paradigm shift in Jammu and Kashmir's tourism strategy.

He urged policymakers, industry stakeholders and local communities to move



beyond volume-driven tourism towards a value-based and sustainable tourism model that safeguards the region's fragile

ecology while ensuring long-term economic prosperity.

The CM said that tourism devoid of sustainability inevitably leads to long-term

Tripura has immense potential in manufacturing, logistics: Goyal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Agartala

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Thursday said Tripura has immense potential to emerge as a manufacturing and logistics hub because of its strategic location and connectivity with Bangladesh.

Addressing the inaugural session of the two-day 'Destination Tripura: Business Conclave 2026' virtually from New Delhi, Goyal said the northeastern State has undergone significant transformation over the past decade under the Centre's Act East Policy.

"Tripura has unlimited possibilities in the manufacturing and logistics sector because of its strategic location, surrounded by Bangladesh on three sides. The State should leverage its strengths to promote exports of MSME products, and the Commerce Ministry will extend all possible support," he said.

Tripura shares an 856-km international border with Bangladesh, while Sabroom in South Tripura is located about 75 km from Bangladesh's Chittagong Port.

Goyal said the State's business environment has improved significantly with the development of highways, inland waterways, railways and air connectivity under the Centre's HIRA



THE STATE SHOULD LEVERAGE THEIR STRENGTHS TO PROMOTE EXPORTS OF MSME PRODUCTS, AND THE COMMERCE MINISTRY WILL EXTEND ALL POSSIBLE SUPPORT

(Highways, Internet, Railways and Airways) model. "Tripura lacked basic infrastructure for business a decade ago, but the overall scenario has changed after implementation of the HIRA model," he said.

He said projects such as the Agartala-Akhaura rail link and the Maitri Setu connecting Sabroom with Bangladesh have enhanced Tripura's connectivity and strengthened its potential as a trade gateway to Southeast Asian countries.

Goyal said Tripura's Gross

State Domestic Product (GSDP) has increased from ₹19,208 crore in 2011-12 to around ₹90,000 crore in 2024-25.

He also pointed to the State's abundant natural resources, including rubber, bamboo, agarwood and tea, as key advantages for industrial development.

Welcoming around 1200 business leaders, entrepreneurs and investors, Chief Minister Manik Saha said the State expects to sign memoranda of understanding (MoUs) worth around ₹1 lakh crore during the two-day conclave.

"Our strategic location, the Agartala-Akhaura rail link and the Maitri Setu have positioned Tripura as a gateway to Southeast Asia. We hope the investment proposals translate into projects on the ground and become part of the state's next phase of growth," he said.

Karnataka CM orders CCTV in all Muzrai temples after Ayodhya donation theft

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Belagavi (Karnataka)

Karnataka Chief Minister DK Shivakumar on Thursday directed officials to install CCTV cameras in all major temples under the Hindu Religious Institutions and Charitable Endowments (Muzrai) Department across the State.

The directive comes in the wake of allegations of embezzlement of donations received at the Ram temple in Ayodhya.



Karnataka CM DK Shivakumar

He said the CCTV cameras should operate round the clock and cover all areas within the temples, including places where money is collected and counted.

"The recent developments at the Ram Mandir are disrespectful to all of us. Out of devotion, all of you have donated bricks, money, gold and silver for the temple. But the major theft that allegedly occurred there is deeply humiliating. What has happened there in the name of religion is known to everyone," Shivakumar said.

Speaking to reporters here, he said that, as a precautionary measure, it had been decided to install CCTV cameras in Muzrai temples across the state.

Jharkhand unveils roadmap for AI-driven governance, digital innovation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren has said that Jharkhand's identity should extend beyond its mineral wealth and emphasised the need to build a knowledge-driven economy powered by research, innovation and technology.

Inaugurating the two-day National Stakeholders Consultation in the national Capital, Soren said that the integration of the State's traditional knowledge with modern technologies would drive the development of both Jharkhand and the country. "Jharkhand should be known not only for its mines, but also for its minds," said the Jharkhand CM.

The conference brought together policymakers, industry leaders, technology experts and academicians to discuss Jharkhand's long-term development strategy



Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren during the National Stakeholders Consultation 2026 in New Delhi on Thursday

under Vision 2050. Representatives from leading technology companies, including Microsoft and Google, shared recommendations on strengthening Jharkhand's digital ecosystem, promoting IT investments and preparing the state for future technological opportunities.

The State Government launched a transformative roadmap to accelerate the State's digital transformation and establish

Jharkhand as India's leading Public Governance-led AI State through Artificial Intelligence (AI). The roadmap outlines a comprehensive strategy to integrate AI across governance, education, healthcare, agriculture, mining, environmental management and disaster response, while ensuring transparency, data privacy, cyber-security and the responsible use of technology.

To transform governance, the Chief Minister Data Intelligence Platform (CM-DIP), an AI-enabled decision-support system for real-time monitoring of government programmes, infrastructure projects and departmental performance has been proposed.

As part of its long-term digital vision, the Government announced plans to establish

a State AI Mission, Jharkhand AI Cloud, AI Innovation Hub, AI Park, AI Innovation Zones, Centres of Excellence and an integrated startup and skilling ecosystem to promote research, innovation, entrepreneurship and industry-academia collaboration.

To support this transformation, the Government has proposed an investment of ₹1,150 crore over the next five years to build AI infrastructure, strengthen digital capabilities, support innovation and accelerate AI adoption across Government departments.

The State also showcased its proposal for a 100.97-acre IT Park in Ranchi, envisioned as a hub for Global Capability Centres (GCCs), IT companies, startups and innovation-driven enterprises.

Under Vision 2050, Jharkhand aims to attract over ₹10,000 crore in investments, establish 50+ Global Capability Centres (GCCs), nurture more than 1,000 AI startups, and generate over

one lakh AI-enabled employment opportunities, positioning the State among India's foremost destinations for AI innovation, digital transformation and technology-led industrial development.

Addressing the concluding session on Thursday Soren stated that institutions of innovation and research are welcome in Jharkhand to elevate the State's intellectual capacity. He emphasised that Jharkhand must move forward on the path of sustainable progress, aiming to develop the State into a research and innovation hub powered by new technological advancements while working holistically on long-term plans for overall development.

During the event, the Chief Minister presented a fresh vision for the comprehensive and long-term development of Jharkhand to members of the industry, tech experts, investors, tourism partners, and policymakers.

ational preparedness of formations under the corps, officials said.

General Seth later visited forward locations in the Poonch district and reviewed the security arrangements and operational preparedness, they said.

The Army chief also met senior military officials at the Poonch Brigade headquarters, where he was briefed on troop deployment, the prevailing security scenario and operational readiness.

The top officers apprised the Army chief of the overall security environment and

the preparedness of troops to effectively respond to emerging challenges.

General Seth has been on a visit to Jammu and Kashmir since Tuesday. During the visit, he called on LG Manoj Sinha and CM Omar Abdullah and reviewed the overall security situation in Kashmir.

"General Dhiraj Seth, COAS, visited forward areas along the Line of Control in Poonch, Rajouri and Sunderbani. He reviewed the prevailing security dynamics along the Line of Control and the counter-insurgency grid of the White Knight corps," the ADGPI said.

Army Chief Dhiraj Seth reviews LoC security in Rajouri, Poonch

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Jammu

Chief of Army Staff General Dhiraj Seth on Thursday took first-hand account of the prevailing security situation along the Line of Control (LoC) in the frontier districts of Rajouri and Poonch.

During his maiden visit to Jammu and Kashmir, General Dhiraj Seth visited Srinagar-based Chinar Corps headquarters on Wednesday and its formations and reviewed the prevailing security situation, operational preparedness and combat readiness along the

Line of Control and in the hinterland. On Thursday, the Chief of Army Staff visited forward areas along the Line of Control in Poonch, Rajouri & Sunderbani.

The visit, his first to the forward areas in Poonch after assuming office, comes amid heightened security measures in Jammu and Kashmir in the wake of the ongoing Amarnath Yatra.

The Army chief visited the Nagrota-based White Knight Corps headquarters, where he was briefed by senior commanders on the security situation in the Jammu region and the oper-



Chief of the Army Staff General Dhiraj Seth during a visit to the forward areas along the Line of Control in Poonch, Rajouri and Sunderbani

PIONEER PHOTO



States Focus



VCK still with DMK alliance, says Thol Thirumavalavan

Reiterating that his party has not "officially" severed its alliance with the DMK, VCK president Thol Thirumavalavan on Thursday launched a sharp attack on what he termed "political hypocrisy" and media double standards. He said the media repeatedly interrogates VCK on its political alignments while failing to question rival leaders.

"Shouldn't the media ask our Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay: You called them an evil force. The people voted for you to oppose it. Then on what basis did you go to his (DMK chief M K Stalin's) house and receive his greetings," Thirumavalavan asked, while addressing party cadres in an event organised in Chennai to induct 500 members from other parties.



NCP (SP) MLA seeks probe in Ajit Pawar death

Opposition Nationalist Congress Party (SP)'s MLA Rohit Pawar on Thursday demanded a judicial inquiry into the plane crash that killed former Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Ajit Pawar and expressed dissatisfaction with the pace of the ongoing investigation.

Initiating discussion on the Opposition-sponsored 'Last Week Motion' in the Assembly, the MLA said he was not in favour of a CBI inquiry and insisted on a judicial probe headed by a retired judge to ensure an independent investigation into the crash in January. He pointed out that even allies of the BJP-led ruling coalition had sought a CBI inquiry, but no decision had been taken on the issue and added delays in the investigation would erode people's confidence in the justice system.

Channi camp relents amid Punjab Congress buzz, claims will meet Baghel, present its views

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chandigarh

In a climbdown amid the Punjab Congress leadership buzz, senior leaders considered close to former chief minister Charanjit Singh Channi on Thursday relented and decided to meet AICC general secretary in-charge Bhupesh Baghel, a day after he ruled out any change in the State party leadership.

Jalandhar Cantt MLA Pargat Singh said, "We will meet Baghel and present our views". The development

comes days after Baghel, also the former chief minister of Chhattisgarh, began his five-day visit to Punjab to prepare the party for the Punjab polls due early next year.

Sources said the meeting is likely to take place on Friday, the concluding day of Baghel's visit.

Former chief minister and Jalandhar MP Channi, who is said to be unhappy over not being appointed the state president, along with leaders considered close to him, including Pargat Singh, Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa,

Mehbooba urges Gadkari to retain NH-701 alignment



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Srinagar

People's Democratic Party (PDP) chief Mehbooba Mufti has appealed to Union Minister Nitin Gadkari to retain the existing alignment for the National Highway NH-701 through the Beerwah town in Budgam district.

In her letter to Gadkari, Mehbooba said, "I wish to draw your kind attention to the representation submitted by a delegation comprising members of Beerwah Civil Society, Trade Federation, Transport Association, market associations, and other stakeholders, who have urged that NH-701A be developed by upgrading the existing road through Beerwah town instead of constructing a bypass."

She said Beerwah is the commercial and administrative hub of Central Kashmir, serving thousands of people from surrounding villages.

The existing road connects the Sub District Hospital, educational institutions, govern-

ment offices, banks, markets, and other essential public services. A bypass would divert economic activity away from the town, adversely affecting the livelihoods of over 2,000 families dependent on businesses along this corridor, she said.

The former Jammu and Kashmir chief minister said upgrading the existing alignment would also strengthen connectivity with Srinagar, the Ring Road, and the airport while minimising the acquisition of fertile agricultural land, protecting orchards, and reducing displacement.

"In view of these compelling public, economic, and environmental considerations, I earnestly request you to direct the concerned authorities to retain the NH-701A alignment through Beerwah town," she said.

Such a decision would ensure that this important project promotes inclusive and sustainable development while benefiting the people it is meant to serve, the PDP president said.

Bhopal to digitally monitor all Govt schools

UMESH NIGAM ■ Bhopal

In a major push towards technology-driven governance in the education sector, the Bhopal district administration has decided to establish a Centralised Education Monitoring System that will enable round-the-clock monitoring of government schools through a dedicated control command centre. The initiative aims to strengthen accountability, improve learning outcomes and ensure that every aspect of school functioning is tracked through a robust digital mechanism.

The command centre will monitor key parameters, including student attendance, dropout records, generation of APAAR IDs, school

bus safety, infrastructure, academic performance and implementation of various Government schemes. District officials believe the technology-enabled system will help identify shortcomings in real time and facilitate prompt corrective action.

The decision was taken during a review meeting of the Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan held at Sandipani School, where Collector Priyank Mishra emphasised that improving the quality of education remains one of the district administration's top priorities. He said the education system must become more transparent, data-driven and outcome-oriented to ensure better learning opportunities for every child.

Issuing a stern warning



against manipulation of official records, Mishra directed officials to upload accurate and verified data of students who have dropped out of school. He made it clear that any attempt to conceal facts,

submit incorrect information or display negligence would invite strict disciplinary action against the officials concerned. To ensure quicker resolution of school-related issues, Sub-Divisional

Solution-based policy needed for wildlife conservation, says Bhupender Yadav

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Asserting that wildlife conservation remains central to India's environmental governance, Union Minister Bhupender Yadav on Thursday said scientific planning, habitat connectivity and effective mitigation measures should continue to guide decision-making on developmental projects in and around wildlife habitats.

The environment minister further said wildlife conservation requires solution-based policy interventions involving technological and sociological studies, while also utilising traditional knowledge, according to a statement released here.

His remarks came at the



91st meeting of the Standing Committee of the National Board for Wildlife (SC-NBWL) in Coimbatore.

During the meeting, the Standing Committee reviewed the progress made on the decisions taken during the seventh meeting of the NBWL, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra

also reviewed the progress of conservation programmes for threatened species and released important scientific publications on rhinoceros, sloth bear and the Great Indian Bustard.

More than 100 proposals across the country involving activities and other essential development works requiring wildlife clearance under the provisions of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, were also considered by the committee.

"The proposals were appraised on the basis of their ecological impacts, importance for public welfare and national development and the adequacy of mitigation measures to ensure conservation of wildlife and their habitats," an official said.

Modi, and deliberated upon several important national conservation initiatives.

The long-term conservation strategy for the greater one-horned rhinoceros based on the rhino DNA indexing system was discussed, among other issues, officials said.

The Standing Committee



AICC general secretary in-charge Bhupesh Baghel

Rana Gurjit and Bharat Bhushan Ashu are yet to meet Baghel. The AICC general secretary has held a

series of interactions with party leaders and office-bearers during his visit.

Talking to reporters,

Baghel expressed confidence about the party's prospects of forming Government in Punjab after the Assembly elections.

He asserted that the Congress was united in Punjab in its mission and purpose and noted that leaders voicing their opinions was unique to the Congress as the party encourages debates and discussions.

"Unlike in other parties, it is not a one-way communication and command in the Congress," he said, adding

the Congress values and respects the seniority and contribution of each and every leader which is acknowledged and rewarded at the right time.

Pargat Singh and and MP Randhawa asserted that the Congress remained "united and strong", saying the party's larger objective was to return to power after the 2027 Assembly polls.

Pargat Singh, however, acknowledged that some "differences of opinion" existed and said these would be conveyed to Baghel.

CBI-DRI joint operation busts inter-state wildlife trafficking racket

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi/Mumbai

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) and the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) in Mumbai, with help from the Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB) teams in Mumbai and Kolkata, worked together to break up an inter-state wildlife trafficking group. They rescued 53 protected animals and birds and arrested six people.

The rescued animals and birds include 15 Slow Lorises, 2 Binturongs, 28 Star Tortoises, 6 Egyptian Vultures, and 2 Shikra birds. These species are all listed under Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, which gives them the highest legal protection in

India. Trading, possessing, or hunting these animals is strictly banned and can lead to up to seven years in jail and heavy fines.

A CBI spokesperson said the operation took place at several locations in Maharashtra and West Bengal. It was based on information from DRI Mumbai about a criminal group involved in illegally sourcing and trading these protected animals. The animals and birds came from different parts of India and were meant for the illegal wildlife trade. The CBI filed two cases on July 7 and 8, 2026. Three people were arrested in Mumbai and three in Kolkata.

The cases were filed under the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, and for criminal con-



spiracy under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023. After the initial legal steps, the rescued animals were handed over to the Forest Departments in Maharashtra and West Bengal for safe-keeping, health checks, and rehabilitation.

This successful operation shows how working togeth-

er across agencies is helping to fight wildlife trafficking. The DRI, which is usually known for combating smuggling and economic crimes, has begun focusing more on wildlife crime because it is often linked to organised groups.

The CBI adds its experience in handling complex interstate and conspiracy

CISF recovers pilfered coal in Jharkhand, Bengal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) personnel has recovered more than 428 metric tonnes (MT) of coal during a five-day special operation to check the pilferage and theft of the fossil fuel from mines in Jharkhand and West Bengal, officials said on Thursday.

Hand-picked jawans and Quick Reaction Teams (QRTs) deployed by the paramilitary covered multiple acres of coalfields belonging to Bharat Coking Coal Limited (BCCL), Eastern Coalfields Limited (ECL) and Central Coalfields Limited

(CCL) in the two adjoining States. The CISF is entrusted with guarding the country's major coal fields.

The Union Government recently authorised the force as a designated agency to undertake search and seizure operations under the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 to check coal theft from the coalfields under its jurisdiction.

"The operation, conducted between July 4 and 8 under the Union Government's 'zero coal leakage' initiative, resulted in the recovery of 428.34 metric tonnes of illegally mined, stored, or transport-



ed coal, the registration of four FIRs, and the seizure of a heavy duty dump truck, 13 motorcycles and other equipment used in illegal mining and transportation of the country's precious energy source," a senior CISF officer said.

Union Home Minister Amit

Shah reviewed illegal coal mining and theft in the country on July 5. There, he directed the CISF to enforce a "zero coal leakage plan" to plug illegal mining by forming quick action teams and setting up a multi-layered security arrangement in vulnerable areas,

Magistrates (SDMs) and the District Education Officer have been designated as the first point of contact for Government schools.

The administration has also directed education officials to ensure 100 per cent generation of APAAR IDs for students and timely admission of eligible children under the Right to Education (RTE) Act. Increasing enrolment and preventing school dropouts will remain key focus areas under the district's education strategy.

Student safety has also been accorded high priority. All school buses have been instructed to keep CCTV cameras and panic buttons operational at all times. Police and Regional Transport Office (RTO) teams

will conduct regular inspections of school vehicles, while drivers and conductors will undergo breathalyser tests to ensure safe transportation of students.

In line with the National Education Policy, the district administration has asked schools to strengthen skill-based education by activating Atal Tinkering Labs and ensuring that every student acquires at least one practical, employment-oriented skill. Directions have also been issued for regular teacher training, timely completion of infrastructure projects under the Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan, solarisation of school campuses and the provision of nutritious meals under the PM Poshan Scheme.

Nadda to lay foundation stone for ICMR high-altitude research centre in Himachal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Health Minister JP Nadda will lay the foundation stone for the ICMR Centre for High Altitude Medicine and Public Health Research at Keylong in Lahaul and Spiti district of Himachal Pradesh on July 11.



The centre, being set up by the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) under the Department of Health Research, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, will upgrade ICMR's existing field station at Keylong into a full-fledged, multidisciplinary hub for research, innovation and capacity-building focused on India's high-altitude and climate-sensitive regions.

The Himalayan ecosystem, with its high altitude, extreme climatic conditions, difficult terrain and rising climate variability, poses distinct public health challenges that shape disease patterns, healthcare access and emergency response, a health ministry statement said.

The Keylong centre will gen-

erate context-specific scientific evidence and scalable solutions across a wide research mandate: high-altitude physiology and acclimatisation, mountain medicine, climate-sensitive and emerging diseases, infectious and non-communicable diseases, maternal and child health, nutrition, mental health, environmental

and occupational health, and disaster medicine. It will also integrate digital health platforms, telemedicine, drone-enabled healthcare logistics and real-time public health surveillance to improve delivery in hard-to-reach areas, the statement said.

Located in Lahaul and Spiti, the centre will have year-round access to high-altitude and tribal populations in a strategically important border region, enabling long-term cohort studies and field research on environmental determinants of health. It is expected to support national priorities in tribal health, disaster preparedness and digital health innovation, while feeding into global research on high-altitude medicine.

NC INVITES MIRWAIZ TO DELHI PROTEST FOR J&K STATEHOOD

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Srinagar

The ruling National Conference on Thursday said the party has invited Kashmir's chief preacher Mirwaiz Umar Farooq to join its protest in New Delhi to press for the restoration of statehood to Jammu and Kashmir.

Mirwaiz has been invited in his capacity as the head of the Muthaida Majlis-e-Ulema, an umbrella organisation of several religious outfits.

The party has also invited the Grand Mufti of Kashmir, Mufti Nasir-ul-Islam.

"Apart from the political parties, the National Conference has invited Mirwaiz sahab, who is chief of the Muthaida Majlis-e-Ulema, and Mufti Nasir-ul-Islam, the Grand Mufti of Kashmir," said the party's chief spokesperson Tanvir Sadiq.

He said the National Conference has invited all political parties in Jammu and Kashmir, including the BJP, to take part in the protest. Most of the invitations have been sent out, while others are being processed.

"We have invited the president of Jammu and Kashmir BJP, as well as the heads of other political parties, including Mehbooba Mufti of the Peoples Democratic Party and Altaf Bukhari of the Apni Party," Sadiq said.



Editor's
TAKE

US-Iran: The truce that could not hold

As missiles fly over the Strait of Hormuz again, the fragile peace signed at Versailles in June lies in ruins and once again the world may pay the price

For a few weeks this summer, it looked like the worst had passed. A fourteen-point memorandum, signed with fanfare by Donald Trump and Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian, had promised a permanent end to hostilities, a reopened Strait of Hormuz, and a path back to sanctions relief. That illusion collapsed this week. After Iranian projectiles struck three commercial tankers transiting Hormuz, the United States answered with strikes on more than eighty targets across Iran. Trump, speaking from a NATO summit in Ankara, declared the agreement "over," calling peace talks a "waste of time" – even as he left the door open, however grudgingly, for negotiators to keep talking. The breakdown was not really sudden. It was the third time Washington has struck Iran even as talks were supposedly underway, and Tehran has said, not unreasonably, that this pattern has poisoned any basis for trust.

Underneath the ceasefire's language always sat the same unresolved fault lines: how much uranium Iran can keep, whether it retains any enrichment capacity at all, how far sanctions relief should go, and who compensates whom for a war that has already cost billions of dollars. A sixty-day pause was never going to settle questions that a decade of diplomacy failed to answer, and the assassination of Ayatollah Khamenei has left Tehran's succession – and therefore its negotiating authority – genuinely unclear. Where this heads next is not known to any human being given the fact that Iran plays the cards close to its chest and Trump is as erratic as ever. Washington has floated seizing Kharg Island outright. Iran has warned it will strike wherever it judges necessary to protect its coastline and its leverage over Hormuz. The Lebanon front, only loosely stabilized, remains combustible. And every option on the table – a wider blockade, an American occupation of Iranian energy infrastructure, a renewed missile exchange with Israel – points toward escalation rather than resolution. The world will not watch this from the sidelines. Brent crude has already jumped past \$78 a barrel on the latest news, continuing a rally that has made this the largest oil supply shock in a generation. Shipping insurers are pricing in war risk through the Gulf; European equities have slid; Central Asian trade routes reliant on Iranian ports are choked; and fertiliser and LPG shortages are rippling through economies from the Philippines to Chile. This is not a regional war anymore – it is a tax on every importing economy on earth. Few nations are as exposed as India, which sources roughly half its crude and the bulk of its LPG through Hormuz. New Delhi's room to maneuver is real but narrow. It cannot broker peace – that leverage now sits with Qatar, Oman, and, awkwardly, Pakistan. What it can do is practical: accelerate the diversification of crude sources it has already begun through renewed Russian and Iranian purchases, expand strategic reserves beyond today's roughly three-week cushion, and use its genuine historical relationship with Tehran to keep a back channel open rather than being seen as leaning entirely toward Washington and Israel. Above all, India should resist being pulled into anyone's camp.

America @250: Mired in global challenges

The nation that emerged from the Declaration of Independence in 1776 remains the world's largest economy and one of its most formidable military powers. Yet, beneath the patriotic pageantry lies a country grappling with sharp political divisions, economic anxieties, cultural conflicts and questions about its global leadership



MR DUA

AS Americans celebrate the nation's glorious unique landmark, turning-point and milestone occasion its 250th birthday: It's an established reality that the Unites States is a country that is currently striding though most trying internal strife and challenging global conundrums in which it's deeply involved. But at the same time the fact is that the USA at its 250th birthday is the world's greatest economy and a towering military might. That's why America's current President, Donald J. Trump, has put himself at the center of the nation's 250th birthday celebrations though he may be struggling to 'tip the scales' for building the America of the next 250 years. Trump has made 'plain his intent on doing a battle with the rest of the world from his unique position of unbeatable strength; he very often threatens and humiliates small entities; remember his one-to-one meeting with Ukraine's Vladimir Zelensky, the beleaguered, war-weary and fatigued from the nearly four-year old war with Russia, and to request for enhanced defence support in war with Moscow. Trump also openly insulted Canada's former prime minister Justin Treadu when he visited Washington suggesting Canada's 51st state. Trump also angered India prime minister Narendra Modi when sarcastically branded India as 'dead economy' knowing fully that India was being openly addressed as the 'world's fastest growing economy.'

Be that as it may, though America's spirited, powerful media outlets are lending their exuberant support to the Trump, a battery of influential critics and naysayers don't let the Trump administration have it all a full-blooded top claim. For example, the gussy financial-political national daily, The Wall Street Journal, da become America's says 'Americans are in a sour mood as they celebrate 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence. President Trump is unpopular; real wages are flat, and many of the political left don't even think July Fourth is the real anniversary. They prefer 1619, the year when the first batch of slaves arrived and provided colossal, plentiful support in building up the then developing America from scratch.

As of today, Americans are angry, peeved and bitterly anguished at the greatest threats to (American) liberty from WITHIN the country, such as the cracking high school system that fails to educate half of its student population



A RECENT GALLUP REPORT AVERS, 'PRIDE IN AMERICA HAS FALLEN TO A LOW 24 PER CENT OF GEN Z. THOUGH DEMOCRATS SAY THEY'RE PROUD OF AMERICA TO BE AMERICAN . BUT AS PER A RECENT POLL, 58 PER CENT OF AMERICAN PEOPLE BELIEVE, THE COUNTRY'S BEST YEARS ARE BEHIND IT, AND 78 PER CENT SAY THE "AMERICAN DREAM" IS FURTHER OUT OF REACH THAN EVER

The writer was a professor and head of print journalism in Delhi's Indian Institute of Mass Communication, ex-head-founder, journalism-communication department University of Calicut, kerala

to even minimal standards. Higher education becoming out of reach for the children of middle families.

Second, the current prevailing progressive elite university system that sees America corrupt and exploitative. The young generation of the 2026 Gen-Z has been 'taught' to 'dislike' their country, and to believe that socialism is superior to the free-market system that made their affluence possible. They often quote an Independent Senate member, Berny Sandars, and Zohran Mamdani, the Indian-origin newly-elected mayor of America's biggest city of New York, who was recently elected with a whopping electoral majority.

Three, America's current deep razor-sharp political divisions heightened by strong, continual presence of a plethora of omnipotent, omnipresent social media with their dominant and electrifying influence through the hungry media outlets. Social media's unusually expanding and deep pressures, particularly over the Gen Z, amply demonstrate the 'signs of devolving into fundamental disputes' that can prove suicidal.

Fourth, the people's multiplying demands for government free benefits are too large to afford, but too politically entrenched to reform. Moreover, with public debt held by the public at 100% of GDP and growing, sooner or later financial markets will rebel, cautions the WSJ's noted economist, the late Mancur Olson, described the danger that, in democracies, interest groups proliferate that cause the government to calcify until it's unable to act. There are signs of the failure of Congress, America's Parliament

consisting of both legislative chambers, the senate and the house of representatives in this century to address the problems of the welfare-entitlement states, according to the late professor.

Meanwhile, it's important to remember that America's political influence, respect and reputation, besides its monetary and moral image, have been on the wane, particularly during its current Donald Trump's presidency. Even a casual look at the US's leverage in international affairs, can't miss its rapid downward surge. America's European friends, the Arab world, South-East Asian block besides Russia or China care two hoots for American viewpoint. Trump's general trade tariffs deemed unreasonable and arbitrary policy has further broadened the gulf.

Finally, as a recent Gallup report avers, 'pride in America has fallen to a low 24% of Gen Z. Though Democrats say they're proud of America to be American (whatever it means, according to their own vision). But as per a recent poll, 58% of American people believe, the country's best years are behind it, and 78% say the "American Dream" is further out of reach than ever. Meanwhile, many Americans feel patriotism along the party lines; it's still revealing-and disappointing. It's frustrating to see how many Americans fell pessimistic to see living in the greatest country in the world.'

Besides, THE USA TODAY, a popular daily, opines: the economy isn't where it should be; the housing is more expensive than ever before. Some people are unhappy that Trump was elected. But think again: America still offers greater gender parity, stronger legal equality, and more opportunities to get an education, find fulfilling work and succeed than almost anywhere else. It's perhaps because of such assumption (fake?) that Trump has remarked on the nation's 250th birthday: "I am thrilled to declare that America is back...a short three time ago we were a 'dead country, we were dead. Now, we are the hottest country in the world, we are respected by everybody," said Trump kicking off the 250th birthdayweek anniversary festivities at the National Mall in Washington, the national capital.

Worried Americans sit hoping against hope, and wonder how can and will all this happen during the remaining Donald Trump presidency which ends 20 January 2029. Let's wait and see, fingers crossed.



Artisans paint a chariot as preparations are underway ahead of the annual Jagannath Rath Yatra, in Puri, Odisha

PHOTO: PTI

Safeguarding Gen Z from the digital addiction trap

of which is now prohibited.

From Access to Discipline

India's youthful population has long been seen as its greatest economic asset. But a demographic dividend depends on more than numbers; it requires young people who can concentrate, learn, self-regulate and work productively. That capacity is under strain. Online gaming in India grew to roughly 488 million players in 2024, up 33 million from the year before - a scale at which even a small share of problematic use becomes a major public concern.

Compulsive gaming functions as a hidden tax on the demographic dividend, one that GDP figures don't capture. It shows up first as poor sleep, shrinking attention spans, anxiety, mood swings, falling academic performance and financial strain - then spreads into classrooms, workplaces and homes. This is not speculative: government estimates presented in the Rajya Sabha while introducing the online gaming bill put the number of people affected by online money games at nearly 45 crore, with losses exceeding Rs 20,000 crore.

The Economic Survey 2025-26 flagged digital addiction as a drag on both mental health and productivity, framing the Online Gaming Regulation Act 2025 as a response to its impact on children and young people. The stakes are amplified by scale: India's population is around 1.46 billion, according to UNFPA's 2025 dashboard, with the 15-64 age group anchoring its future workforce, innovation and consumption. Whether that generation stays healthy and

focused, or slides into addiction, disrupted sleep and poor concentration, will shape whether the dividend becomes a growth engine or a liability. Other countries have already moved on this front - China restricts gaming for minors, South Korea once enforced a shutdown rule for under-16 users, and Vietnam caps gaming time for those under 18.

None of this means gaming itself is the enemy; esports, educational and social gaming all have real value. Notably, the WHO's ICD-11 already recognises gaming disorder, marked by loss of control, prioritising gaming over other activities, and continuing despite harm.

Building a Culture of Responsible Gaming

Rules alone can't teach judgment. Digital wellness needs to be treated as a life skill - alongside financial literacy and civic education - covering how attention works, how apps are designed to be persuasive, and why sleep, exercise and offline relationships matter. One survey found 47% of urban Indian parents of 9-17-year-olds reported over three hours of daily screen time. Just as road safety needed public awareness beyond traffic rules, and financial inclusion needed literacy beyond bank accounts, digital wellness needs behavioural education beyond compliance. Attention and self-regulation are now economic assets - worth protecting as much as highways or data centres.

The writer is an alumnus of IIM-Ahmedabad and an associate member of the Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICS) and works as a management consultant. He is the Co-founder of Smile Foundation

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Liveability should be India's urban priority

The Economist Intelligence Unit's Global Liveability Index 2026 offers an important reminder that the true measure of a city's success is not its skyline but the quality of everyday life experienced by its residents. Assessing 173 cities across stability, healthcare, education, and environment, and infrastructure, the index once again placed Copenhagen at the top, while New Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai and Bengaluru remained far behind. These rankings demonstrate that citizens value safety, reliable public transport, accessible healthcare, quality education and clean surroundings far more than rapid urban expansion alone.

Economic growth loses much of its significance if it is not accompanied by better living conditions. India's relatively low rankings should serve as a wake-up call rather than a cause for disappointment. Urban planning must prioritise affordable housing, pollution control, waste management, public transport and, green spaces. Greater coordination between governments, urban local bodies and citizens is essential for building cities that are not only economically vibrant but also healthy, inclusive and liveable. Development should ultimately be judged by how comfortably and securely people live every day.

R.S. NARULA | PATIALA |

Cooperative insurance must protect rural India

India's cooperative movement began with the Co-operative Credit Societies Act, 1904, to strengthen farmers through mutual support and collective ownership. The proposed Cooperative Life Insurance Company, following the Bharat Taxi Cooperative initiative, represents an important expansion of this model beyond its traditional rural credit framework. Nearly half of India's workforce continues to depend on agriculture, making rural livelihoods highly vulnerable to crop failures, livestock losses, climate shocks and fluctuating farm incomes. The limited acceptance of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana in states such as Punjab, coupled with persistent agrarian distress and debt-driven farmer suicides, highlights significant gaps in rural social security.

The cooperative insurer should therefore evolve into a comprehensive rural risk assurance institution by integrating life, crop, livestock and livelihood protection under one umbrella. Such an approach would reduce financial vulnerability, improve resilience and reinforce farmers' confidence in the cooperative model. Since the cooperative movement was founded to safeguard the economic interests of rural communities, the proposed insurance company should remain true to that legacy.

BRIJ B. GOYAL | LUDHIANA

Child safety must override platform profits

The Centre's ultimatum directing Meta to remove advertisements promoting child sexual exploitative and abuse material from Instagram is more than a regulatory warning; it is a serious indictment of one of the world's largest technology companies. Child sexual abuse is not a content moderation issue but a grave criminal offence, and no platform can escape responsibility by blaming algorithms or automated systems. Technology companies that profit from user engagement have an equally important obligation to ensure that their recommendation systems, advertising tools and search functions do not facilitate criminal activity or expose children to exploitation.

The appearance of advertisements linked to child sexual abuse raises troubling questions about the effectiveness of these safeguards and the company's commitment to child protection. Government intervention must be followed by stringent enforcement through independent audits, substantial financial penalties and criminal liability.

Child safety cannot become secondary to commercial interests or engagement metrics. Protecting children must remain the highest benchmark of responsible platform governance.

YASH PAL RALHAN | JALANDHAR

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DOWRY DEATHS MUST NEVER BE NORMALISED

The recent judicial observations by the Calcutta High Court in a dowry death case are deeply disturbing. While courts have the discretion to determine punishment according to legal principles and the facts of each case, describing dowry-related suicides as "not very rare" risks conveying the impression that such tragedies have become an accepted social reality.

If these crimes are indeed frequent, the response should be stronger deterrence and stricter accountability, not diminished seriousness.

Dowry is not merely a domestic dispute; it is a gross violation of a woman's dignity, equality and right to live with respect. Every dowry death represents the collective failure of families, communities and institutions to eradicate this

regressive social evil. Justice must not only be fair but also reassure victims' families that the legal system stands firmly against such crimes.

Alongside speedy investigations, scientific collection of digital and forensic evidence, and time-bound trials, governments must intensify public awareness campaigns, promote women's economic empowerment and ensure strict enforcement of anti-dowry laws.

Parents, educators and community leaders must also reject extravagant marriage demands and challenge harmful social norms.

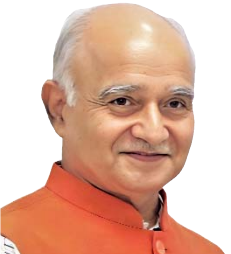
A society that truly values women cannot afford to normalise dowry deaths under any circumstance.

SANJAY CHOPRA | MOHALI

Please send your letter to the info@dailypioneer.com. In not more than 250 words. We appreciate your feedback.

Indian higher education: A decade of transformation

India's higher education system is undergoing one of the most significant transformations in its post-Independence history. Indian higher education system, it is now earning global recognition for its expanding research ecosystem, growing innovation capacity, entrepreneurial culture, and improving academic standards



RAMA SHANKER DUBEY

Ten years ago, an Indian university breaking into the world's top rankings was a rare event worth celebrating. Today, it is closer to routine. When the QS World University Rankings 2027 were released on 18 June 2026, ten Indian institutions had made it into the world's top 500 - the clearest sign yet of a higher education system that has spent a decade quietly reinventing itself. But rankings are only the visible tip of a much larger transformation, one that spans research, innovation, entrepreneurship, access, and, perhaps most tellingly, a renewed argument about what education is actually for. Together, these threads tell the story of a system that has grown not just larger, but more serious about what it owes the students passing through it.

Climbing the Global Ladder

IIT Delhi now stands at 118th globally, India's highest-ranked institution this year, with IIT Bombay, IISc Bengaluru, IIT Madras and other IITs posting sustained gains of their own. What has changed is the breadth of the story. The University of Delhi and Anna University have joined the world's top 500, while the University of Hyderabad, Jamia Millia Islamia, Banaras Hindu University, Jawaharlal Nehru University and Aligarh Muslim University all sit within the top 800 - proof that India's rise is no longer an engineering-and-technology story alone. The numbers underline the shift: just 14 Indian institutions featured in the QS rankings in 2015; 52 do today, making India the fourth most-represented higher education system in the world. Collectively, these gains reflect not one institution's success story but a system-wide rise in quality, research depth and international recognition.

The Research and Innovation Engine

This climb rests on genuine substance. India now ranks third globally in science and engineering publications and sixth in patent filings, with research increasingly steered toward national priorities - clean energy, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, robotics, semiconductors, quantum technologies and space among them. The Global Innovation Index tells a parallel story: India rose from 81st in 2015 to 38th in 2025 among 133 economies, and now hosts two of the world's top 30 innovation clusters - Bengaluru (21st) and Delhi (26th), per WIPO's 2025 data. Publication volume, though, is not the finish line. Research must still convert into translational outcomes - solutions that solve industry problems, inform public policy, and improve lives - which is exactly why deeper industry-academia collaboration remains the next frontier for Indian HEIs to cross.

From Campuses to Companies

That industry linkage is most visible in the entrepreneurial boom reshaping Indian campuses. Of the country's 1,100-plus incubators, nearly two-thirds sit within HEIs - IITs, IIMs, NITs, and central, state and private universities alike. Government initiatives such as Startup India (2016), the Atal Innovation Mission, and the Ministry of Education's Institution's Innovation Council programme, launched in 2018, have pushed entrepreneurship into the academic mainstream, while NEP 2020 has embedded entrepreneurial skills directly into degree curricula. The results speak for themselves: from roughly 450 startups in 2016, India counted more than 2.23 lakh recognised startups by 31 March 2026, generating over 23.36 lakh direct jobs and making the country the world's third-largest startup ecosystem.

Widening the Gate

Quality gains have come alongside a genuine widening of access. Between 2015-16 and 2021-22, the number of HEIs grew by nearly 15.8%, according to AISHE data, while the Gross Enrolment Ratio climbed from 23.7% to 28.4% - millions more young Indians in classrooms than a decade ago. New colleges and universities, digital and open-distance learning platforms, rising participation by women, and NEP 2020's flexible, multidisciplinary programmes have all driven this expansion. That same multidisciplinary turn - letting



REFORMERS FROM SWAMI VIVEKANANDA TO SRI AUROBINDO TO MAHAMANA PANDIT MADAN MOHAN MALAVIYA INSISTED THAT EDUCATION'S FIRST TASK IS BUILDING CHARACTER - CULTIVATING SELF-DISCIPLINE, INTEGRITY AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY ALONGSIDE KNOWLEDGE. WHEN MALAVIYA FOUNDED BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY IN 1916, HE MADE CHARACTER FORMATION, GROUNDED IN DHARMA AND ETHICS, A STATED OBJECTIVE OF THE INSTITUTION ITSELF

The writer is Chancellor, National Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, New Delhi

students range freely across sciences, humanities, arts and vocational tracks - is reshaping how graduates think, building the versatility and problem-solving ability that twenty-first-century challenges demand. NEP 2020 has also, for the first time, brought Indian Knowledge Systems into mainstream curricula, introducing students to the country's scientific, philosophical, linguistic and artistic heritage - yoga, Ayurveda, classical languages and Indian philosophy among them - taught alongside contemporary science rather than instead of it.

Building a Future-Ready Workforce

Skilling has kept pace with all of this. The Skill India Mission has trained more than 60 million people since 2015, while the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana has certified over 16 million youth in industry-relevant trades. NEP 2020 has folded Skill Enhancement Courses in AI, data science, cybersecurity, robotics and smart agriculture directly into degree programmes, alongside apprenticeship schemes that pair classroom learning with workplace exposure. The payoff already shows: in the QS World Future Skills Index 2027, India ranked 13th among 89 economies and was named a leading AI-ready economy.

The Gap That Remains

Scale, though, brings its own challenge. India's higher education system now spans over 1,338 universities and 53,354 colleges, serving more than 4.33 crore students - a demographic dividend the country cannot afford to waste. For decades, most academic programmes stayed disconnected from real skill-building, leaving a persistent gap between what graduates know and what industry actually needs. Closing that gap means HEIs must move faster to revamp curricula around societal priorities, industrial demand, and the economy's shifting requirements. Only then can the system deliver the future-ready workforce that the vision of Viksit Bharat@2047 depends on.

Character Before Curriculum

There is an older, simpler idea running underneath all of this: that the true worth of a person is reflected in character and conduct, not credentials alone. Skills, however useful, were never meant to be the whole point of education. Reformers from Swami Vivekananda to Sri Aurobindo to Mahamana Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya insisted that education's first task is building character - cultivating self-discipline, integrity and social responsibility alongside knowledge. When Malaviya founded Banaras Hindu University in 1916, he made character formation, grounded in Dharma and ethics, a stated objective of the institution itself. That tradition draws on scripture - the Vedas, the Manusmriti, the Bhagavad Gita, the Ramayana - which hold truth, non-violence, self-control, compassion and service among Dharma's essential virtues, and which educators carry a responsibility to instil in their students. NEP 2020 has revived this thread through value-added, multidisciplinary courses that build ethics, empathy and leadership alongside technical learning, though how deeply students absorb these lessons still rests on the integrity and commitment of the teachers delivering them.

The Decade Ahead

Put together, the last decade tells a coherent story: Indian higher education has grown in scale, climbed the global rankings, and deepened its research and innovation base. What remains is to finish what NEP 2020 started - weaving industry-relevant skilling and values-rooted education into a single curriculum, so that India's graduates emerge not merely qualified, but responsible, ethical, and ready to build the nation's future.

How Jamia Hamdard effectively implemented NEP 2020



MD AFSHAR ALAM

The National Education Policy 2020 was envisioned as a framework through which Indian higher education could be restructured around flexibility, multidisciplinary and quality. A policy of such scope, however, is only as meaningful as the manner in which it is implemented, and it is this question of effective implementation that was placed at the centre of institutional planning at Jamia Hamdard between 2021 and 2026. Rather than being treated as a set of directives to be formally noted, the policy's provisions were converted into measurable academic and administrative practice.

A multidisciplinary curriculum structure was among the earliest reforms undertaken. Rigid departmental boundaries were loosened, and students were given the option of combining courses across schools of pharmacy, medicine, engineering, management and humanities. Through this restructuring, a foundation was laid for the kind of breadth that NEP 2020 had called for, and the university's traditional strength in pharmaceutical and health sciences was preserved even as new academic pathways were opened.

The Academic Bank of Credits was integrated into the university's examination and academic systems, and multiple entry and exit options were made available to undergraduate students. Through these mechanisms, learners who needed to pause their studies for personal, financial or professional reasons were no longer required to forfeit the credits already earned. This flexibility was regarded as one of the more consequential changes brought about by the policy, since it altered the relationship between the institution and the student from one of rigid progression to one of accommodated pathways. Indian Knowledge Systems were given particular emphasis during this period, in keeping with both the letter of NEP 2020 and the university's own scholarly inheritance. Jamia Hamdard's century-old association with Unani medicine positioned it uniquely for this task, and courses and research

initiatives were designed through which classical systems of medicine, Sufi philosophical traditions and indigenous scientific knowledge were brought into dialogue with contemporary curricula. Rather than being treated as a symbolic gesture, this integration was approached as a serious academic exercise, and scholars from within the university were drawn upon to ensure that rigour was not sacrificed for the sake of relevance.

Skill development and vocational training were woven into academic programmes across disciplines, in accordance with the policy's insistence that employability be treated as a core outcome of higher education rather than an afterthought. Internships, industry linkages and hands-on training components were made mandatory in several programmes, and it was ensured that these were not reduced to token exercises but were built into the credit structure itself.

Research output was strengthened considerably during this period, and this strengthening was reflected in the university's improved standing in the National Institutional Ranking Framework, particularly within the pharmacy category, where Jamia Hamdard has consistently been placed among the leading institutions of the country. The university was also awarded an A+ grade by the National Assessment and Accreditation Council, and this outcome was regarded as external, independent confirmation that the reforms undertaken were not merely procedural but had produced a demonstrable effect on teaching, research and governance.

Governance itself was reformed in ways that were less visible to the public but were, in many respects, foundational to everything else that was achieved. Compliance frameworks under the University Grants Commission, the National Medical Commission, the All India Council for Technical Education, the Pharmacy Council of India and the Bar Council of India were strengthened, and procurement processes were brought into closer alignment with General Financial Rules and the oversight expectations of the Comptroller and Auditor General. It was recognised early in the tenure that academic reform without administrative discipline tends to remain superficial, and considerable effort was therefore invested in ensuring that the two proceeded together. Digital infrastructure was expanded to support the flexibility that NEP 2020 demanded. Learning management systems were upgraded, and blended and online components were incorporated into programmes where appropriate, without allowing the university's traditional strength in laboratory-based and clinical education to be diluted. Faculty development was treated as a continuing priority throughout this period. Workshops, training programmes and orientation sessions were organised on subjects ranging from outcome-based education to generative artificial intelligence, and it was through these sessions that faculty members were equipped to translate policy intent into classroom practice.

None of these efforts were undertaken without difficulty, and it is precisely in the handling of such difficulty that effective implementation is distinguished from formal compliance. Resistance was encountered at various points, both from within sections of the academic community that were accustomed to older structures and from the practical constraints imposed by regulatory frameworks that had not yet been fully harmonised with the spirit of NEP 2020. Rather than being allowed to stall progress, these difficulties were addressed through consultation and phased adjustment, and it is acknowledged that the process of implementation remains unfinished in certain respects, as is perhaps true of any policy of this scale and ambition.

Looking back over five years, it can be said that the effectiveness of NEP 2020's implementation at Jamia Hamdard is best measured not by the number of provisions formally adopted but by the extent to which they were embedded into everyday academic and administrative practice. The extent to which this work will be sustained depends on the continued commitment of those who now carry it forward. What can be affirmed with some confidence is that the foundations laid during this period were built with care, and that they were designed to function well beyond any single tenure.



The author served as Vice Chancellor of Jamia Hamdard, New Delhi, from 2021 to 2026

Why faculty, not facilities, should top every IHM checklist



GYAN BHUSHAN PRATIK GHOSH

Every admissions season, the same checklist does the rounds among hospitality aspirants: best campus, best placement record, best-known alumni. Ask any working hotelier what shaped their career, and the answer rarely starts with a building. It starts with a name - a professor who pushed them harder than they wanted, who picked up the phone years after graduation, who turned a textbook chapter on guest recovery into a story they still tell at work. The better admissions question, then, is this: who teaches at the institute you're considering, and what faculty culture stands behind them? New research on India's premier Institutes of Hotel Management (IHM) suggests this matters more than almost anything else on the checklist.

The Real Engine

A study of 112 hospitality-management faculty across leading Indian institutes examined what

drives strong faculty performance - sharper teaching, better mentorship, industry-ready graduates. Three factors, working together, stood out: resilience, work engagement, and affective commitment to the institute. Faculty who collaborated well under pressure, learned visibly from setbacks, and treated change as opportunity rather than threat were more engaged in their work, and that engagement was closely tied to stronger performance.

For a prospective student, this is concrete. Resilient, engaged faculty don't just deliver a syllabus - they model how to handle the unpredictability of a real hospitality career.

For industry partners scouting placements, it signals which institutes are producing graduates shaped by people who demonstrate resilience daily, not merely describe it in a lesson plan.

What the best educators have in common

The research points to specific traits: collaborating through unexpected challenges, sustaining high workloads, resolving crises competently, welcoming feedback as fuel for improvement, and treating added responsibility as growth rather than burden. It's the same profile hotels look for in a duty manager or a chef de cuisine.

The difference is that at a strong IHM, students don't just hear about these traits - they watch faculty demonstrate them, term after term.



A new way to read your admission offers

For a student weighing offers, this should reframe the whole decision. You are not simply buying a curriculum. You are choosing the people who will model, for three to four formative years, how a professional handles pressure, recovers from failure, and stays engaged in demanding, high-stakes work. Resilient faculty tend to be better-engaged faculty - and engaged faculty go beyond the lesson plan, mentor outside class hours, and notice when a student is struggling.

Institutional culture deserves scrutiny, since faculty perform best where leadership treats resilience as an institutional resource rather than an individual trait. During campus visits, it is

worth asking: Does this institute invest in faculty development? Are facilitators engaged in industry research, or only classroom delivery? The answer says as much about your education as any placement statistic.

A faculty-led talent pipeline

For hotel groups and hospitality brands building campus-recruitment strategy, the implication runs just as deep. Faculty performance - and, by extension, how well students are prepared - depends on resilience, engagement, and commitment acting together. Recruiters evaluating which IHMs to deepen ties with should look for institutes where faculty are visibly engaged in research, mentorship, and industry collaboration, not merely fulfilling teaching hours.

This also marks a shift in how IHMs relate to industry. The strongest institutes are no longer positioning themselves as downstream training grounds that simply absorb industry standards and pass them on. They are building faculty research capacity robust enough that industry can begin drawing insight from academia too - on workforce resilience and service innovation in the Indian context. For recruiters, that is a signal worth reading: graduates trained to think critically about improving standards, not just execute them. This shift is already institutional policy. Upgrading faculty capability in step with evolving industry trends is a stated priority for IHMs

under the NCHMCT, Ministry of Tourism, whose syllabus includes training on digital tools in culinary and marketing, pedagogy for grooming and etiquette, hotel security, and employability and life skills. Trainers are drawn from IIMs, industry veterans, and international leaders, with a fixed academic calendar meant to keep faculty current with global hospitality practice.

Choosing well this season

For a student filling out applications now, the takeaway is simple: look past the lobby-management lab in the brochure and ask about the faculty - how long they've taught, what they research, how they mentor, and whether the institute deliberately builds their resilience and engagement. For industry, the takeaway is just as simple: the IHMs worth partnering with are the ones that measure and nurture faculty performance with the same seriousness a hotel floor reserves for guest satisfaction. The best hospitality institutes of the years ahead will not be defined by their buildings. They will be defined by the resilience, engagement, and commitment of the faculty who walk into classrooms every single day - and by how visibly that translates into the students who walk out.

Mr. Gyan Bhushan, (IES), Senior Economic Advisor, Ministry of Tourism and Chief Executive Officer, National Council for Hotel Management and Catering Technology (NCHMCT), Government of India & Dr Pratik Ghosh, Head of Department, Dr. Ambedkar Institute of Hotel Management Catering & Nutrition, Chandigarh



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Merger of banks does not shield tenant from eviction: SC

In a significant verdict, the Supreme Court on Thursday held that the amalgamation of a tenant bank with another does not exempt the transferee bank from eviction under the Delhi Rent Control Act if the landlord's written consent was not obtained. Putting an end to nearly a four-decade-long protracted legal battle, a bench comprising Justices Sanjay Karol and K Kottiswar Singh ordered the Punjab National Bank (PNB) to deliver "a peaceful and vacant possession of the tenanted premises" by January 31, 2027 at Connaught Circus here to the owner, the British Motor Car Company Ltd.



It allowed the eviction plea of British Motor Car Company which had moved a local court in 1987. The dispute dates back to 1947, when the landlord, British Motor Car Company Ltd, leased a prime commercial space in Pratap Building, Connaught Circus, to Hindustan Commercial Bank (HCB). Following a Reserve Bank of India-backed scheme, the HCB was amalgamated with the PNB in December 1986. This led to PNB taking over the possession of the premises. The landlord initiated eviction proceedings on the ground that the transfer of possession to the PNB amounted to assignment or parting with possession without its written consent attracting Section 14(1)(b) of the Delhi Rent Control (DRC) Act. The DRC Act provision says that a tenant is liable to be evicted if the tenanted premises are sublet, assigned or otherwise parted with the possession "without obtaining the consent in writing of the landlord". The bench dealt with the question whether the amalgamation of HCB with PNB attracted Section 14(1)(b) of the DRC Act or not.

SC judge recuses from hearing plea on equestrian team selection



Supreme Court judge KV Viswanathan on Thursday recused himself from hearing a plea challenging the Delhi High Court's refusal to interfere with the non-selection of riders Anush Agarwalla and Sudipti Hajela in India's dressage team for the upcoming Asian Games in Japan. When the matter was called for the hearing, Justice Viswanathan said he would recuse from hearing. The bench, also comprising Justice Alok Aradhe, said now the matter will be listed for hearing before another appropriate bench under the direction of the Chief Justice of India. Subsequently, the plea was mentioned before a bench led by Justice Ahsanuddin Amanullah, the senior-most available judge. He allowed the listing of the case on Friday. On July 7, a bench said that the plea will be taken up for hearing on Thursday after the counsel submitted that the selection is scheduled to be held on July 15. On July 6, the high court refused to interfere with the non-selection of Agarwalla and Hajela, upholding a previous ruling made by a single judge, which denied relief to the duo. Both riders are gold medal winners from the Asian Games 2022 and filed petitions against the selection decisions made by the Equestrian Federation of India (EFI). Dismissing the riders' appeals, the high court had said that while it did not find any infirmity with the preparation of the list of probables, the EFI had failed to duly comply with certain clauses of the selection criteria. It, however, was of the opinion that a fresh trial was not possible at this stage and exercised "restraint" in the larger interest of sports and to avoid any adverse impact on the country's prospects at the Asian Games.

Delhi HC seeks Govt stand on Ambassador Hotel's plea against show-cause notice for eviction

The Delhi High Court on Thursday sought the stand of the central Government on a petition by the Ambassador Hotel owner against a show-cause notice for eviction from the 7.58-acre premises at Sujan Singh Park here. Justice Harish Vaidyanathan Shankar issued notice on the petition by Sir Sobha Singh and Sons Private Limited and granted three weeks to the Centre to file its reply. Senior counsel for the petitioner said he apprehended that an order of eviction could be passed on July 10. The matter has been listed before the estate officer on this date. He urged the court to direct the estate officer to decide the

issue of the maintainability of the proceedings under the Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act before moving ahead in the matter. Justice Shankar, however, refused to interfere with how the proceedings were being held, saying, "They are the statutory authorities. They will take care of it themselves." "I am not going to direct how he has to conduct his proceedings," the judge added. Central Government counsel Ashish Dixit opposed the petition and stated that the matter is listed before the estate officer on July 10 for filing a reply to the petitioner's applications. "Proceedings can continue. He says an eviction order is going to be passed tomorrow. (But) it is listed for filing of our reply on their applications," he stated. Dixit also argued that the petition was not maintainable and that proceedings were being conducted by the estate officer as per the law. In the petition, Sir Sobha Singh and Sons Pvt Ltd challenged a show-cause notice dated June 11 issued by the

SC mulls larger bench reference in Sonam Raghuvanshi murder case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday said it might refer to a larger bench the legal question whether the mere mention of a wrong statutory section in an arrest memo, specifically a typographical error, was sufficient to invalidate an arrest and grant bail to Sonam Raghuvanshi in the murder case of her husband. A partial working day bench comprising Justices Manoj Misra and Shree Chandrashekhar also indicated that it would closely examine whether the Meghalaya High Court was justified in granting bail to Raghuvanshi on the grounds that the arrest memo contained a typographical error. On July 3, another bench of Justices MM Sundresh and Sheel Nagu had refused to stay the high court order granting bail to Raghuvanshi. On Thursday, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the state Government, raised the question whether the mere mention of a wrong statutory section in an arrest memo, specifically a typographical error, was sufficient to invalidate an arrest and grant bail in the "shocking" murder case. The high court had upheld Raghuvanshi's bail on the grounds that the police failed to supply proper written grounds of arrest, noting a "total non-application of judicial mind" because the memo cited Section 403 (which does not exist in the context) instead of Section 103(1) (punishment for murder) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS). The solicitor general argued that the error was purely clerical. "In this matter, this is a very serious case where bail is granted on the grounds that grounds (of arrest) were not supplied... though at the time of arrest, there is a record that



there is a supply of grounds," he said. The bench, however, said the court must reconcile conflicting judgments regarding the necessity of providing grounds in writing at the time of arrest. "We will consider this matter at length. We will decide whether this requires to be referred to a larger bench," Justice Misra said. The top law officer said the gravity of the crime should outweigh a technical typo. "This is the case where both of them went on honeymoon in Meghalaya. It was a pre-meditated murder. She killed the husband on a hill and threw the body into a gorge... This is a very, very serious offense," Mehta said. The bench directed the state police to provide legible photocopies of the original documents supplied to the accused to verify what information was actually communicated at the time of arrest. "If this ground (the technicality) is not sustainable, then the bail order goes," Justice Misra orally observed. On July 3, another bench had refused to stay the high court order granting bail to Raghuvanshi. The accused, a resident of Indore in Madhya Pradesh, was arrested in June last year in connection with the killing of her businessman husband, Raja Raghuvanshi. The couple had gone missing while vacationing in Meghalaya's Sohra area on May 23 last year. Subsequently, Raja Raghuvanshi's body was found in a deep gorge on June 2, 2025. Police have alleged that Sonam Raghuvanshi conspired with hired assailants to kill her husband for financial gains. On June 29, the Meghalaya High Court upheld a trial court order granting bail to the accused. The high court had dismissed a criminal petition filed by the state Government, seeking cancellation of the bail granted by the trial court on April 27.

Calcutta HC appoints special officer to manage TMC bank accounts

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court on Thursday appointed a special officer to manage the day-to-day expenses of the Mamata Banerjee-aligned TMC from three debit-frozen bank accounts of the party. A complaint was lodged on June 18 before the Cyber Crime Police Station of Bidhannagar Police Commissionerate, alleging that the three accounts of the TMC in a private bank were repositories of proceeds of crime and the police authorities concerned were requested to take steps. The three accounts were made debit-frozen the very next day following the registration of the FIR on June 18. Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya appointed retired Calcutta High Court judge Subrata Talukdar as a special officer for running the day-to-day expenses of the Mamata Banerjee-led group till September 30,



2026. Leaders of the other party faction, led by TMC MLAs Ritabrata Banerjee and Sandipan Saha, lodged the police complaint that led to the freezing of debit transactions from the three accounts. Justice Bhattacharyya permitted any two authorised signatories of the three bank accounts to present a cheque before the special officer, which will thereafter be presented before the bank authority for encashment. The court clarified that the petitioner is permitted to operate bank accounts for day-to-day expenditures only to run the political party. On a plea by the petitioner, Justice Bhattacharyya permitted transactions to meet legal expenditure of the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC and the honorarium of ₹1.25 lakh per month of the special officer from the three bank accounts till September 30. The court directed the special officer to file a report disclosing the statement of expenditure incurred

Calcutta HC refuses relief to hawkers in Howrah

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court refused to grant any interim relief to hawkers of the century-old Manglahat in Howrah city from police action aimed at maintaining road and pavement space. Alleging overaction by the police, the Howrah Hawkers' Samity prayed for an order restraining the police from evicting them and interfering with their businesses. Refusing any interim order restraining the police, as prayed for by the association, Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya on Wednesday said that the hawkers' association could not prima facie satisfy the court regarding their right to earn livelihoods by hawking wares while blocking roads and pavements. The court observed that the issue needs consideration upon the exchange of affidavits, and directed the respondent authorities to file their affidavits in opposition to the petitioner's contention within the next two weeks. The petitioner would have the liberty to file their affidavit



in reply to those within the subsequent week, Justice Bhattacharyya directed. Petitioner's lawyer Bikash Ranjan Bhattacharya stated that while certain restrictions can be imposed on the marketplace, the hawkers cannot be evicted entirely in view of the Hawkers' Vending Act. He stated that the century-old market in the central district of Howrah city takes place twice a week on the streets. Maintaining that earning a livelihood by hawking is a fundamental right, he stated that the Howrah Municipal Corporation (HMC) authorities had not given any notice for the eviction of the hawkers. Representing the state, lawyer Suryaneel Das stated that the police have a duty to keep the roads clear.

Punjab and Haryana HC restrains Oberoi Realty from fresh allotments in project

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Gurugram

The Punjab and Haryana High Court has restrained Oberoi Realty from making any fresh allotments or creating third-party rights in its 'Oberoi 360 North' residential project in Gurugram until the Haryana Department of Town and Country Planning (DTCP) decides a pending complaint challenging the validity of the project's licence. The complaint alleges violations of foreign direct investment (FDI) norms and other provisions. Oberoi 360 North is the company's first project in Gurugram. The order was passed by a division bench of Justices Jasgurpreet Singh Puri and Sanjiv Berry while hearing a plea filed by Advance India Projects Ltd (AIPL) in an ongoing writ petition against the director of the DTCP, Haryana, and others. AIPL has sought a stay on License No. 69 of 2025, issued on



and subsequent transfer of the licence were contrary to the provisions of the Haryana Development and Regulation of Urban Areas Act, 1975, and that the transaction breached conditions governing foreign direct investment (FDI). The bench recorded these as the petitioner's allegations and did not express any finding on their merits. The petitioner further argued that FDI in such projects is intended for development and construction activities and not for facilitating an exit through the sale of the project, an allegation that was contested by the private respondents. During the hearing, counsel for the petitioner submitted that the project's estimated value is around ₹8,000-10,000 crore and will be developed in multiple phases. It was also stated that nearly 350 units had already been allotted and around ₹750 crore collected from buyers.

May 12, 2025, and the subsequent order dated June 17, 2025, approving the transfer of the development licence to another developer. The company has also claimed rights over the project and sought cancellation of the sale deed executed in favour of Oberoi Realty. According to the court order, the dispute relates to a 14.816-acre land parcel in Sector 58, Gurugram, where a residential colony with a commercial component is proposed. The petitioner alleged that the grant

NGT directs completion of proceedings to levy ₹2.65 cr on BHU for illegal tree-felling

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The National Green Tribunal has directed the Uttar Pradesh Pollution Control Board to complete the proceedings for levying an environmental compensation of over Rs 2.65 crore on the Banaras Hindu University for illegal felling of trees. The green body had earlier formed a panel which said that 33 trees, including seven sandalwood and 26 other tree species, were illegally felled in the 1,300-acre campus, following which it disposed of the matter and directed the UPCCB to assess the environmental compensation and complete the proceedings within three months in August last year. The petitioner, Advocate Saurabh Tiwari, had then filed an execution application seeking compliance



with the tribunal's directions. In an order dated July 7, made public on Thursday, a bench of NGT Chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava and expert member Afroz Ahmad noted that UPCCB had assessed a compensation of over ₹2.65 crore for the illegal felling of 33 trees, and further steps for imposition of environmental compensation are in process. The tribunal said that, according to the board's

counsel, proceedings concerning the levy of the environmental compensation will be completed within three months. It said, "Though the UPCCB has not carried out the direction of the tribunal to complete the proceedings within three months from the date of the order of the original application (OA), considering the circumstances which are disclosed, we extend the time further and direct the UPCCB to complete the proceedings concerning the levy of environmental compensation." The tribunal also noted the Divisional Forest Officer's (DFO's) report, according to which 978 trees of different species had been planted by the University in 2025 as compensatory plantation, of which 859 trees were found to be surviving and in safe condition.

Kerala HC directs CorroHealth, employees to resolve dispute through conciliation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kochi

The Kerala High Court has directed US-based health care technology company CorroHealth and its retrenched employees to attempt conciliation as contemplated under the Industrial Relations Code 2020. Justice Gopinath P issued the direction on a petition moved by the company challenging a communication by the District Labour Officer, Ernakulam to maintain status quo regarding its decision to close its operations in Kerala and discharge its employees. The company said it was forced to shut down operations in Kerala due to reasons beyond its control, and resolutely nearly 800 employees

had to be retrenched. It also told the court that it has already transferred the retrenchment compensation to the accounts of its employees. The company contended that the Labour Officer can attempt conciliation of the industrial dispute but cannot direct that the employees shall continue in service in the interim. It also told the court that due to the Labour Officer's direction, the company was facing a huge organised protest headed by some labour unions. The company also agreed to cooperate with the conciliation proceedings. Advocate General (AG) Jaju Babu, appearing for the state Government, told the court that majority of the 800 retrenched employees are



women. He said that the state has a social obligation to attempt conciliation in the matter and the Government has convened a meeting on July 10 for the same. The meeting will be conducted by senior officials of

the Labour Department and the company has been requested to attend it, the AG told the court. After hearing the company and the Government stands, the court said that the Advocate General was right in contending that the state has a social obligation to attempt a conciliation, "especially when a large number of employees are likely to lose employment on account of the closure of operations by the petitioner (CorroHealth) in the state of Kerala". Accordingly, it is directed that Ext.P8 (Labour Officer's communication) need not be treated as a mandate in any manner, and need only be seen as a part of the conciliation proceedings initiated by the District Labour Officer.

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Gautam Adani to file affidavit in US court this week

Billionaire Gautam Adani will file this week a sworn affidavit in a US federal court stating whether he is aware of any promise, agreement or benefit linked to the US government's decision to dismiss a criminal indictment against him. US District Judge Nicholas Garaufis directed Adani to file the affidavit by July 15 before ruling on the Justice Department's motion to dismiss the indictment with prejudice. The judge asked Adani to state whether he is aware of any promise, offer, agreement or benefit connected to the dismissal, or of any exchange made in return for the charges being dropped. Sources said Adani is likely to file the affidavit this week. The Adani group did not offer any comment on the issue, saying the matter is sub judice. (PTI)

Low tyre pressure costs India ₹4,500 cr in fuel every year: ATMA

India is estimated to be losing over 42 crore litres of petrol worth more than ₹4,500 crore every year due to low tyre pressure, one of the most neglected aspects of vehicle maintenance, according to a study by industry body ATMA. A large number of passenger vehicles on Indian roads are being driven with tyre pressure below the manufacturer-recommended levels, resulting in substantial fuel wastage, higher vehicle operating costs and increased road safety risks, as per the study by Indian Tyre Technical Advisory Committee (ITTAC), the technical arm of Automotive Tyre Manufacturers' Association (ATMA). Over the past few years, tyres of more than 1.3 lakh passenger vehicles, including two-wheelers, have been checked across the country, including nearly one lakh tyres during the last year alone, ATMA said. (PTI)

Rupee further rises 7 paise to settle at 95.41 against USD

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

The rupee appreciated by 7 paise to settle at 95.41 (provisional) against the US dollar on Thursday even as crude oil prices firmed up and the greenback strengthened in the global markets. A recovery in the stock markets and dollar selling by state-run lenders supported the local currency amid rising volatility triggered by the fresh escalation in the West Asia crisis.

Rupee vs Dollar

₹ per US \$

Date	Rate (₹ per US \$)	Change
2	95.35	-19p
3	95.43	-25p
6	94.96	+47p
7	95.18	+17p
8	95.41*	+07p
9	95.48	-52p

*Provisional

July 2026

KBK Infographics

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened lower by 4 paise at 95.52 against the US dollar and later traded in the range of 95.58 to 95.28 during the day. It settled at 95.41 (provisional), up 7 paise from the previous close.

Govt waives basic customs duty on key inputs for electronics manufacturing

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The government has waived basic customs duty on goods used in manufacture of display assemblies, lithium ion cell and inductor coil module as it looks to promote domestic production of electronic devices like smart-phones, laptops, wearables and smart TVs.

The finance ministry issued three separate notifications giving effect to the basic customs duty (BCD) waiver on the goods used in manufacture of the three key components used in electronic devices.

This exemption is in line with the government's efforts to promote domestic electronics manufacturing under the PLI scheme. The duty waiver would reduce import dependence and strengthen the electronics ecosystem with local production.

The exemptions on inputs used in display assemblies

and inductor coil module would be valid till March 31, 2029, the notifications said.

AMRG Global, Managing Partner, Rajat Mohan said the government has now consolidated separate customs exemptions for machinery used in the manufacture of lithium-ion cells for mobile handsets and electric vehicles, into a single technology-neutral exemption applicable to

machinery used for the manufacture of 'lithium ion cells'.

"This simplifies the customs framework, removes end-use-based distinctions, and significantly reduces compliance and interpretational challenges for manufacturers," Mohan said.

The amendment is expected to encourage fresh investments in domestic lithium-ion cell manufacturing by pro-

viding greater flexibility to manufacturers operating integrated production facilities.

"The biggest beneficiaries will be battery gigafactories, electric vehicle manufacturers, consumer electronics companies, battery energy storage system (BESS) manufacturers, renewable energy projects, telecom infrastructure providers, data centres, medical device manufacturers, drone manufacturers and industrial automation sectors, all of which increasingly depend on lithium-ion cells," Mohan added.

Grant Thornton Bharat, Partner and Tax Controversy Management Leader, Manoj Mishra said the exemption for inputs used in display assemblies for automotive, medical and industrial applications broadens support beyond consumer electronics, while the relief for inductor coil modules used in wireless charging will benefit smartphone manufacturers adopting advanced features.

BSNL announces satellite phone for ₹1.34 lakh

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

State-run BSNL on Thursday announced the availability of a satellite phone for ₹1.34 lakh, part of its push to expand satellite communication services to defence, maritime and disaster-response users. In a social media post on Thursday, BSNL mentioned that the satellite phone is priced at ₹1,34,166 apiece, including all taxes, and has been designed for challenging environments, offering voice calls and SMS services in remote areas not covered by conventional mobile networks.

"When conventional mobile networks can't reach, the BSNL Satellite Phone keeps you connected. Designed for challenging environments, making it an ideal solution for Defence, Maritime, Disaster Response, Mining, Remote Operations and Adventure Travel," the BSNL social

media post displaying the price of a satellite phone said. Users can contact the nearest BSNL office for more details, the telco said while sharing a mobile number in the post. The mobile number, however, was not responsive.

"As Always. No one is responding to the above Given Number," a verified account holder on X commented on the post. An email query sent to BSNL did not elicit an immediate response. In February, an official statement said that BSNL had been

providing voice call and SMS services through the Global Satellite Phone Service (GSPS) to the general public and private enterprises since January 1, 2018.

According to an official statement dated February 11, the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) issued the instructions on June 12, 2017, in respect of the provision of satellite-based services, which inter alia mandated that BSNL is required to complete the customer acquisition process prescribed for mobile connections, as amended from time to time.

"BSNL shall also obtain from the subscriber the details such as place of use, period of use and the purpose for which satellite handset shall be used. Additionally, the GSPS service is inherently a secure communication as information is transferred in encrypted form," the statement had said.

Govt has done its part on GCC, industry must build capabilities to meet AI challenge: CEA

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran on Thursday said the government has done its part by announcing several measures in Budget to support Global Capability Centres (GCCs), and called on industry to invest in skilling, capability development and innovation to address the challenges posed by artificial intelligence.

Observing that AI has exposed old model, Nageswaran said it is likely to displace routine, repetitive and rule-based tasks, and it

would be unrealistic to deny the risks posed to business models built solely around low-cost execution.

Highlighting the role of government-industry collaboration, the CEA said the Union Budget has addressed a long-pending industry demand by simplifying and expanding the transfer pricing safe harbour regime for GCCs.

The revised framework provides a uniform margin, significantly higher thresholds and faster, more predictable approvals over a multi-year period, improving tax certainty for such centres, he said addressing

CII GCC Summit here.

The government has also launched a national framework to encourage the

expansion of GCCs beyond the six major metropolitan cities into tier-II and tier-III locations, he said.

"This is not only an economic goal; it is a matter of fairness. The opportunity should not sit in a few metros alone," Nageswaran said.

At the same time, he underlined that government policy alone cannot secure India's leadership in the sector.

"Government can build the runway, but it cannot fly the plane. The move from cost to capability, from execution to innovation, has to be made by firms and by people," he said.

The CEA identified skilling as one of India's biggest challenges, noting that while the country produces a large number of graduates every

year, too few are industry-ready when they enter the workforce.

Besides, he asked industry to focus on building capabilities and innovation as the country's long-term advantage will depend on its ability to move from cost competitiveness to capability.

"Artificial intelligence does not build, deploy, or govern itself. Someone has to design these systems, train them, test them, correct them, and hold them to account. Someone has to decide where they should be used and where they must not be used," he said.

Skilling vital in India's goal of becoming AI solutions capital, says IT Secretary

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Reorienting and readying skills for the AI era will be key to India's ambition of harnessing its STEM talent and becoming the artificial intelligence solutions capital of the world, IT Secretary S Krishnan said on Thursday.

Speaking at the CII GCC Business Summit, Krishnan noted that the deployment of AI in enterprises is still lagging across the world, not just in India, presenting an opportunity for GCCs here to play a critical role.

Artificial intelligence (AI) presents an opportunity to transition beyond routine work, with automation expected to handle lower-order functions while humans focus on higher-value roles, he said.

Krishnan said the government's approach towards AI has been "extremely positive" with an "optimistic outlook" right from the start.

He said India should aim to become the world's hub for AI applications and solutions by leveraging its talent to drive enterprise adoption of the technology.

While investments in AI infrastructure and foundation models are accelerating globally, deployment across enterprises remains limited, creating a key opportunity for Global Capability Centres

WHATSAAPP'S REPLY ON 'USERNAME' NOTICE DUE TODAY: IT SECRETARY

New Delhi: Meta-owned WhatsApp's response to the government notice on the 'username' feature is due on Thursday, IT Secretary S Krishnan said.

Last Wednesday, the Centre issued a notice to Meta questioning the proposed username feature on WhatsApp, flagging concerns that it could materially increase online fraud, phishing, digital arrest scams, and impersonation attacks.

The username feature essentially allows people on the messaging platform to communicate without sharing their phone numbers. The government had also directed the platform not to launch the feature until consultations on the issue are completed "to the satisfaction of the Government". (PTI)

(GCCs) in India. "...The deployment of AI in enterprises is still lagging, not just in India, but across the world. And that is truly where I think GCCs in India will come in and play that critical role...higher-level functions in various segments of the domain need to be moved and shifted to, and that's the function that a GCC needs to perform," he said.

Gold futures rebound nearly 1% to ₹1.44 lakh/10g on value buying

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Gold futures rebounded by ₹1,038 to ₹1.44 lakh per 10 grams on Thursday after opening lower in domestic markets as value buying aided the rally, ending a three-session decline despite escalating tensions in West Asia.

On the Multi Commodity Exchange, gold futures for August delivery appreciated by ₹1,038, or 0.72 per cent, to ₹1,44,749 per 10 grams in a business turnover of 10,018 lots.

Traders said bargain hunting at lower levels lifted the precious metal after its recent correction, while a weaker US dollar also lent support to prices.

"However, prices were capped on the upside as

renewed US-Iran tensions fuelled inflation concerns, strengthening expectations that the US Fed could keep interest rates higher for longer," said Gaurav Garg, Research Analyst at Lemonn Markets Desk.

In the international markets, Comex gold futures for the August contract gained \$36.44, or 1 per cent, to \$4,118.84 per ounce in New York. Analysts said gold futures in the overseas trade pared losses to reclaim the \$4,100 an ounce level on value buying after the recent selloff.

India's crude imports remain resilient: Analysts

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India's crude oil imports remain well insulated from the latest tensions around the Strait of Hormuz, although prolonged instability could disrupt LPG and LNG supplies and raise shipping costs, according to a Kpler analyst. The latest exchange of fire in the region, following US President Donald Trump's comments on a ceasefire, has renewed concerns over the security of one of the world's busiest energy shipping lanes.

However, the impact on India's crude supplies is likely to be limited because refiners have diversified their

sourcing over the past few years, Sumit Ritolia, who manages refinery and oil markets at Kpler, said.

"Crude flows through the Strait had not fully recovered before the latest escalation. For India, however, it has largely been business as usual over the past 100 days,

with refiners successfully managing supply through a diversified import portfolio," Ritolia said.

Russia continues to account for a significant share of India's crude imports, while supplies from Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates routed

through bypass infrastructure provide additional supply security. West African and Latin American grades have also helped diversify refinery feedstock, he said.

India's crude oil imports rose to a record 4.93 million barrels per day (bpd) in June, driven by a sharp increase in purchases from Russia as refiners sought to bolster supplies amid disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz.

Russian crude imports climbed to about 2.7 million bpd, accounting for more than half of India's total crude imports during the month, cementing Russia's position as the country's largest oil supplier by a wide margin.

Germany strikes deal to buy US long-range Tomahawk missiles

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Berlin

Germany has struck a deal with the United States to buy American-made Tomahawk cruise missiles and station them in Germany, Chancellor Friedrich Merz announced on Thursday.

The German leader said the agreement on the long-range missiles, which are used to strike targets deep inside enemy territory, was reached this week on the sidelines of the NATO summit in Türkiye's capital, Ankara. "This will close an important strategic gap in our defence, and at the same time, we will work to develop our own European systems and station them in Europe," Merz told parliament after returning from the two-day summit.

The deal struck with the Trump administration amounts to broader export of American know-how to



Chancellor Friedrich Merz

some of its major allies in Europe, whose security posture has been upended by Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in early 2022.

On Wednesday, President Donald Trump said the US will give Ukraine a license to make Patriot air defence systems to counter missile

attacks from Russia - a huge coup for Kyiv which has long requested the technology.

The Tomahawk cruise missile has been in the US military's inventory since the 1980s. While slow by missile standards, the cruise missile flies around 100 feet off the ground,

making it harder to detect by defence systems.

The missile boasts an impressive range of around 1,600 kilometres and precision guidance systems that make it the go-to weapon for striking targets that are deep inland or in hostile territory.

Italy's Calabria defies US pressure to end Cuban doctors programme

PAOLO SANTALUCIA ■ Polistena

Italy's southern Calabria region is the rare place in Europe where Cuba sends medical professionals under a long-running programme that the United States wants to stamp out.

Cuba's doctors for decades have worked in developing nations such as Gambia and Venezuela, skilled in providing care with scarce resources. Over 200 now staff remote hospitals across Calabria, Italy's poorest region in the tip of the country's boot. A shortage of homegrown healthcare workers had forced some hospital departments to close.

"It was a disaster. I was keeping the emergency room open all by myself," the chief physician of Polistena hospital, Francesco Moschella, told The Associated Press, recall-



ing the days before the Cubans arrived in January 2023. Their presence triggered a visit this year from US officials. The US has long criticized the Cuban programme and called it a money-maker for the socialist Government that the Trump administration has isolated, sanctioned and wants to see changed.

Facing US pressure, some Caribbean and Central American countries have cancelled Cuban missions. But Calabria's governor has refused. Even if Cuba's socialism doesn't

fit with his political views, he says the region depends on them. One Calabria hospital had lines several hours long.

Despite growing tourism and a strong farming economy, Calabria symbolises southern Italy's lack of development compared to the more wealthy and industrialised north. Wages are about 30 per cent lower, and its unemployment rate is double the national average.

Calabria ranks last among Italy's 20 regions in public healthcare access, according to the health ministry.

Until April, Calabria had spent 17 years under special administration due to persistent budget deficits, which along with corruption scandals and Mafia infiltration affected health investments. Many newly graduated doctors built careers in the north instead. (AP)

India's envoy to China visits famous Kaiyuan temple

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Beijing

Indian Ambassador to China Vikram Doraiswami visited the 7th-century Kaiyuan Temple in Quanzhou, Fujian, on Thursday. Doraiswami, along with Indian Consul General in



Indian Ambassador to China Vikram Doraiswami

Guangzhou Gince Mattom, visited the temple where they were received by Chief Monk Ven. Shi De Sheng.

"A testament to centuries of India-China cultural exchanges, the temple reflects artistic and architectural influences of both local and ancient Indian traditions," the Indian Embassy said in a social media post.

Public Notice / General Information

The general public is hereby informed that my client has lawfully purchased the below described land/property/agricultural land from 1. Harl Singh S/o Bharti resident House No. 218 Ward No. 5 Mandkola(217), District Palwal Haryana – 121103 2. Heera Singh S/o Arjun urf Arjan resident House No. 1386, Goga Patti, Mandkola (217), Hathin Palwal Haryana – 121103 3. Lalit Kumar S/o Khajani devi resident House No. D-171, Ward No. 05, Chaupal Daulah, Daula(197), Gurgaon Haaryana – 122103 4. Mahender urf Mahendra S/o Sohan lal resident Mekan No. 22A, Shyam Patti Bus Stand Ke Pass, PO: Mandkola(217), District Palwal Haryana 121103 5. Smt. Manjari Mathur W/o Sh. Vipul Mathur D/o Shyam Lal Mathur resident C-502, Park View City -2, Sohna Road Sector 49, South City – II, Gurgaon Haryana – 122018 6. Naresh Kumar S/o Sh. Kishan resident Norangabad, Mandkola(217), District Palwal – 121103 collectively referred as "Sellers"

The details of the said land of the Seller are as under: Khewat/Khata No. 1365/1358 Rectangle. No.153 Killa No. 4(8-0), 5(8-0), 6(8-0), 7(8-0), 8(8-0), 13/12(0-10) total fields 6 land measuring 42 Kanal 10 Marla having share to the extent of 80/850 share 4 Kanal 0 Marla Fard Jamabandi for the Year 2021-2022 ("Seller No.1") Khewat/Khata No. 1926/1908 Rectangle No. 78 Killa No. 13(8-0), 16/2(8-0), 18(8-0), 23/1(2-10), 23/2(5-10), 24/1(7-11), 25/1(3-4), 25/3(2-0), Rectangle No. 79 Killa No. 21/12(6-3) Rectangle No.113 Killa No.3/1(7-12), 4/1/1(1-16), 4/1/3(0-15), 5/1/2(4-11) total fields 13 land measuring 65 Kanal 12 Marla having share to the extent of 51/1312 share 2 Kanal 11 Marla Fard Jamabandi for the Year 2021-2022 ("Seller No. 2"), Khewat/Khata No. 2128/2109 Rectangle No. 202 Killa No. 19(8-0), 20(8-0), total fields 2 land measuring 16 Kanal 0 Marla 1/2 share 8 Kanal 0 Marla Fard Jamabandi for the Year 2021-2022 vide Mutation No. 23220 ("Seller No.3") Khewat/Khata No. 2193/2172 Rectangle No. 223 Killa No. 12(8-0), 13(8-0), 18(8-0), 19(8-0), 20(7-13), 23(7-9) total fields 6 land measuring 47 Kanal 2 Marla 10/157 share 3 Kanal 0 Marla Fard Jamabandi for the Year 2021-2022 ("Seller No 4") Khewat/Khata No. 355/355 Rectangle No. 154 Killa No. 15/2 land measuring 7 Kanal 13 Marla Salam share and Khewat/Khata No.. 1413/1404 Rectangle No. 154 Killa No. 14/2/2 land measuring 4 Kanal 7 Marla Salam share i.e total land measuring 12 Kanal 0 Marla Fard Jamabandi for the Year 2021-2022 ("Seller No 5") Khewat/Khata No. 1452/1443 Rectangle No. 117 Killa No. 16(8-0), 25/1(7-3), Rectangle No. 159 Killa No. 4(9-7), 5/1(5-13), 6/1/1(3-2), 14(8-15) total fields 6 land measuring 42 Kanal 0 Marla 1/10 share 4 Kanal 4 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 1648/1635 Rectangle No. 191 Killa No. 20(8-0), 21/1(6-0), 21/2(2-0), 22/7(1-3), Rectangle No. 192 Killa No. 14(8-0), 16(8-0), 17(8-0), Rectangle No. 202 Killa No. 4/3(3-0), 5(8-0), 6(8-0), 7/1(2-17), 15(8-0), 16(8-0), Rectangle No. 203 Killa No. 1(8-0), 2/1(3-1), 11(8-0), 20(8-0), 21/1(2-3) total fields 18 land measuring 114 Kanal 14 Marla 38/1147 share 3 Kanal 16 Marla i.e total land measuring 8 Kanal 0 Marla Fard Jamabandi for the Year 2021-2022 vide Mutation No. 20893 ("Seller No. 6") Situated within the revenue estate of Village Mandkola Tehsil Hathin District Palwal Haryana ("Scheduled Property/Land")

The said purchase has been undertaken by my Client with due care and proper due diligence. The said Public notice is being issued, so as to ascertain and invite disclosure of any hidden claims, rights, or disputes, if any, relating to the said Scheduled Property/Land.

The Seller had further declared that the said Scheduled Property/Land is completely free from all kinds of encumbrances including but not limited to charges, mortgages, loans, claims, disputes, litigations, attachments, stay orders, ceiling proceedings, acquisition, surplus land, government dues, or any third-party rights or claims whatsoever, and that the title of the Scheduled Property/Land is clear, clean, and marketable. The Seller had further represented and warranted that the Seller has clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership and was in actual, vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession of the said Scheduled Property/Land and that no prior, existing, or subsisting agreement, transaction, understanding, or arrangement of any nature whatsoever, whether oral or written, in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land has been entered into with any third party in respect thereof. It was also declared that no case, proceeding, or dispute in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land is pending before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

Therefore, any person, bank, financial institution, government department, or any other party, firm, company, or entity, who has or claims to have any valid, legal, or equitable right, title, interest, claim, demand, charge, or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land—whether by way of sale, gift, lease, tenancy, license, exchange, partition, mortgage, lien, inheritance, succession, agreement, litigation, decree, stay order, possession, or otherwise—shall intimate the undersigned in writing, along with full particulars of such claim/objection and supporting documentary evidence, within fifteen (15) days from the date of publication of this notice.

In case no information or objection is received within the stipulated period, it shall be conclusively and lawfully presumed that there exists no encumbrances including but not limited to third-party claim, right, or dispute etc. in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land and my client shall be legally deemed to have clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership therein along with actual,vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession thereon, entitling my Client to lawfully proceed, sell and deal with the Scheduled Property/Land.

Thereafter, any such claim, objection, or dispute shall be treated as legally untenable, deemed to have been waived, and my client shall not be held liable for the same in any civil or criminal proceedings before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum. The Scheduled Property/Land shall be deemed to include all rights, easements, pathways, appurtenances, standing crops, trees, plants, constructions, fences, boundary walls, etc. attached thereto.

The general public is hereby cautioned not to deal or enter into any transaction concerning the Schedule Property/Land with any person, party, or entity, failing which such transaction shall be at their own cost, risk and consequences.

This public notice is issued on behalf of my Client with complete bona-fide, transparency, and good faith so as to safeguard my client against any future allegations of fraud, misrepresentation, or collusion or any other allegations whatsoever in relation to the Schedule property. This notice is being issued without prejudice to any of the legal rights, contentions and remedies available to my client under applicable law.

Durga Lal - Advocate, Law Consultant Office,
Office No. 57 Nehru Ground Near Main Post Office,
B.K. Chowk, NIT Faridabad, Haryana. ENROL. No. PH/5563/2022
Mobile No.7303834091, Email- lawconsultantsoffice@gmail.com

**BHAGWAN PARSHURAM INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY**
A UNIT OF BHARTIYA BRAHMIN CHARITABLE TRUST (REGD.)
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PSP-4, Sector-17 (Opp. Sector-11) Rohini, New Delhi-110089
Tel # - 27571080, 27572900, email-bpitindia@yahoo.com

NOTICE FOR ADMISSIONS UNDER MANAGEMENT QUOTA
Application are invited from the eligible candidates, who fulfill the eligibility conditions as laid down in Admission Brochure of 2026-27 issued by GGSIP University, for provisional admission in B.Tech (CSE/IT/CSE-DS/ECE/EEE), LE- B.Tech (CSE/IT/ECE), BBA (Shift I & Shift II) & MBA for the Academic Session 2026-27 against Management Quota seats. Candidates can apply online at the portal of the institute and offline in Room No.4 of the Institute on the prescribed form downloaded from the institute's website www.bpitindia.ac.in between 11 am to 1 pm with effect from 13.07.2026 to 31.07.2026 after paying the prescribed fee of Rs.2500/- (Rs. Two thousand five hundred only). Candidates are requested to visit Institute's website www.bpitindia.ac.in for Schedule of Admission Process, Counselling and any other further updates.

Public Notice / General Information

The general public is hereby informed that my client has lawfully purchased the below described land/property/agricultural land from 1. Jitender Singh S/o Rajender urf Rajender Singh resident House No. 132, Near Government School Ghata Teh Sohna, Sector – 55, Wazirabad (75), Gurgaon Haryana – 122003 2. Ravi Kumar S/o Rajender resident Village Ghata Gurgaon Haryana 122001 collectively referred as "Sellers"

The details of the said land of the Seller are as under: Khewat/Khata No. 149/183 Rect. No. 14 Killa No. 18/2(3-14) 19(6-19) total fields 2 land measuring 10 Kanal 13 Marla Salam Share and Khewat/Khata No. 114/146min Rect. No. 15 Killa No. 14/2 land measuring 6 Kanal 13 Marla having share to the extent of 4/13 share which comes to 2 Kanal 0.92 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 126/159min Rect. No. 15 Killa No. 7/1(2-13) 7/2(5-7) 8/1(0-10) 8/2(5-13) 8/3(1-17) 13/1(6-17) 14/1(1-7) total fields 7 land measuring 24 Kanal 4 Marla having share to the extent of 931/1374 share which comes to 16 Kanal 7.95 Marla i.e. total land measuring of all Khewat 29 Kanal 1.87 Marla as per Fard Jamabandi for the year 2022-2023 vide Mutation No. 1251 Situated within the revenue estate of Village Akbarpur Natol, Tehsil Hathin, District Palwal Haryana ("Scheduled Property/Land")

The said purchase has been undertaken by my Client with due care and proper due diligence. The said Public notice is being issued, so as to ascertain and invite disclosure of any hidden claims, rights, or disputes, if any, relating to the said Scheduled Property/Land. The Seller had further declared that the said Scheduled Property/Land is completely free from all kinds of encumbrances including but not limited to charges, mortgages, loans, claims, disputes, litigations, attachments, stay orders, ceiling proceedings, acquisition, surplus land, government dues, or any third-party rights or claims whatsoever, and that the title of the Scheduled Property/Land is clear, clean, and marketable. The Seller had further represented and warranted that the Seller has clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership and was in actual, vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession of the said Scheduled Property/Land and that no prior, existing, or subsisting agreement, transaction, understanding, or arrangement of any nature whatsoever, whether oral or written, in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land has been entered into with any third party in respect thereof. It was also declared that no case, proceeding, or dispute in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land is pending before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

Therefore, any person, bank, financial institution, government department, or any other party, firm, company, or entity, who has or claims to have any valid, legal, or equitable right, title, interest, claim, demand, charge, or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land—whether by way of sale, gift, lease, tenancy, license, exchange, partition, mortgage, lien, inheritance, succession, agreement, litigation, decree, stay order, possession, or otherwise—shall intimate the undersigned in writing, along with full particulars of such claim/objection and supporting documentary evidence, within fifteen (15) days from the date of publication of this notice.

In case no information or objection is received within the stipulated period, it shall be conclusively and lawfully presumed that there exists no encumbrances including but not limited to third-party claim, right, or dispute etc. in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land and my client shall be legally deemed to have clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership therein along with actual,vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession thereon, entitling my Client to lawfully proceed, sell and deal with the Scheduled Property/Land.

Thereafter, any such claim, objection, or dispute shall be treated as legally untenable, deemed to have been waived, and my client shall not be held liable for the same in any civil or criminal proceedings before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

The Scheduled Property/Land shall be deemed to include all rights, easements, pathways, appurtenances, standing crops, trees, plants, constructions, fences, boundary walls, etc. attached thereto. The general public is hereby cautioned not to deal or enter into any transaction concerning the Schedule Property/Land with any person, party, or entity, failing which such transaction shall be at their own cost, risk and consequences.

This public notice is issued on behalf of my Client with complete bona-fide, transparency, and good faith so as to safeguard my client against any future allegations of fraud, misrepresentation, or collusion or any other allegations whatsoever in relation to the Schedule property. This notice is being issued without prejudice to any of the legal rights, contentions and remedies available to my client under applicable law

Durga Lal - Advocate, Law Consultant Office,
Office No. 57 Nehru Ground Near Main Post Office,
B.K. Chowk, NIT Faridabad, Haryana. ENROL. No. PH/5563/2022
Mobile No.7303834091, Email- lawconsultantsoffice@gmail.com

Public Notice / General Information

The general public is hereby informed that my client has lawfully purchased the below described land/property/agricultural land from 1. Nova Terra Developers registered Office Room No. 09, House No. 448, Khasra No. 92, First Floor Ring Road Flyover, Village Azadpur, New Delhi-110033 collectively referred as "Sellers"

The details of the said land of the Seller are as under: Khewat/Khata No. 96/126 Rect. No. 43 Killa No. 13(8-0) 18/1(2-8) total fields 2 land measuring 10 Kanal 8 Marla having share to the extent of 4559/6795 share which comes to 6 Kanal 19.55 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 134/166min Rect. No. 28 Killa No. 18 measuring 8 Kanal 0 Marla Salam Share and Khewat/Khata No. 174/207 Rect. No. 29 Killa No. 1/1 land measuring 6 Kanal 15 Marla having share to the extent of 2629/5208 share which comes to 3 Kanal 8.14 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 175/208 Rect. No. 19 Killa No. 24(8-0) 25(8-0) total fields 2 land measuring 16 Kanal 0 Marla having share to the extent of 376799/651000 share which comes to 9 Kanal 5.21 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 178/211 Rect. No. 18 Killa No. 21/1 land measuring 7 Kanal 6 Marla having share to the extent of 3727/5256 share which comes to 5 Kanal 3.52 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 179/212 Rect. No. 18 Killa No. 20 land measuring 7 Kanal 7 Marla having share to the extent of 1097/3000 share which comes to 2 Kanal 13.75 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 190/223 Rect. No. 34 Killa No. 23(8-0) Rect. No. 43 Killa No. 4(8-0) 5(8-0) total fields 3 land measuring 24 Kanal 0 Marla having share to the extent of 11441/27180 share which comes to 10 Kanal 2.04 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 231/283 Rect. No. 14 Killa No. 13(8-0) 14(8-0) 15(7-13) 16(7-13) 17/1(1-12) 17/2(6-8) 18/1(3-3) 18/2(4-17) 22/2(3-3) 23(8-0) 24(8-0) 25(7-13) total fields 12 land measuring 74 Kanal 2 Marla having share to the extent of 205/2964 share which comes to 5 Kanal 2.5 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 233/286 Rect. No. 15 Killa No. 1(8-0) 11(8-0) 19(8-0) 20(8-0) 21(8-0) total fields 5 land measuring 40 Kanal 0 Marla having share to the extent of 626/9351 share which comes to 2 Kanal 13.55 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 234/287 Rect. No. 15 Killa No. 9/2(4-10) 10(8-0) 12(8-0) total fields 3 land measuring 20 Kanal 10 Marla having share to the extent of 5/492 share which comes to 0 Kanal 4.16 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 288/346 Rect. No. 49 Killa No. 13/2 land measuring 5 Kanal 12 Marla having share to the extent of 1/5 share which comes to 1 Kanal 2.40 Marla and Khewat/Khata No. 343/246 Rect. No. 4 Killa No. 14/2(1-17) 15(3-5) 16(7-17) 17/1/1(1-17) 25(8-0) Rect. No. 5 Killa No. 20(1-13) 21/1(2-3) 21/2(2-17) Rect. No. 6 Killa No. 1(6-17) 10(8-13) Rect. No. 7 Killa No. 5/2(2-7) total fields 11 land measuring 47 Kanal 6 Marla having share to the extent of 5/12 share which comes to 19 Kanal 14.16 Marla i.e. total land measuring in all Khewats 74 Kanal 8.98 Marla as per Fard Jamabandi for the year 2023-2024 vide Mutation No. 2713 and Badar No. 13 Situated within the revenue estate of Village Pondri, Tehsil Hathin District Palwal Haryana ("Scheduled Property/Land")

The said purchase has been undertaken by my Client with due care and proper due diligence. The said Public notice is being issued, so as to ascertain and invite disclosure of any hidden claims, rights, or disputes, if any, relating to the said Scheduled Property/Land.

The Seller had further declared that the said Scheduled Property/Land is completely free from all kinds of encumbrances including but not limited to charges, mortgages, loans, claims, disputes, litigations, attachments, stay orders, ceiling proceedings, acquisition, surplus land, government dues, or any third-party rights or claims whatsoever, and that the title of the Scheduled Property/Land is clear, clean, and marketable. The Seller had further represented and warranted that the Seller has clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership and was in actual, vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession of the said Scheduled Property/Land and that no prior, existing, or subsisting agreement, transaction, understanding, or arrangement of any nature whatsoever, whether oral or written, in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land has been entered into with any third party in respect thereof. It was also declared that no case, proceeding, or dispute in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land is pending before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum.

Therefore, any person, bank, financial institution, government department, or any other party, firm, company, or entity, who has or claims to have any valid, legal, or equitable right, title, interest, claim, demand, charge, or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land—whether by way of sale, gift, lease, tenancy, license, exchange, partition, mortgage, lien, inheritance, succession, agreement, litigation, decree, stay order, possession, or otherwise—shall intimate the undersigned in writing, along with full particulars of such claim/objection and supporting documentary evidence, within fifteen (15) days from the date of publication of this notice.

In case no information or objection is received within the stipulated period, it shall be conclusively and lawfully presumed that there exists no encumbrances including but not limited to third-party claim, right, or dispute etc. in respect of the said Scheduled Property/Land and my client shall be legally deemed to have clear, valid, absolute, and marketable right, title, interest and ownership therein along with actual,vacant, peaceful physical and legal possession thereon, entitling my Client to lawfully proceed, sell and deal with the Scheduled Property/Land.

Thereafter, any such claim, objection, or dispute shall be treated as legally untenable, deemed to have been waived, and my client shall not be held liable for the same in any civil or criminal proceedings before any court, tribunal, or any competent legal or quasi-legal authority/forum. The Scheduled Property/Land shall be deemed to include all rights, easements, pathways, appurtenances, standing crops, trees, plants, constructions, fences, boundary walls, etc. attached thereto.

The general public is hereby cautioned not to deal or enter into any transaction concerning the Schedule Property/Land with any person, party, or entity, failing which such transaction shall be at their own cost, risk and consequences.

This public notice is issued on behalf of my Client with complete bona-fide, transparency, and good faith so as to safeguard my client against any future allegations of fraud, misrepresentation, or collusion or any other allegations whatsoever in relation to the Schedule property. This notice is being issued without prejudice to any of the legal rights, contentions and remedies available to my client under applicable law.

Durga Lal - Advocate, Law Consultant Office,
Office No. 57 Nehru Ground Near Main Post Office,
B.K. Chowk, NIT Faridabad, Haryana. ENROL. No. PH/5563/2022
Mobile No.7303834091, Email- lawconsultantsoffice@gmail.com

PROSPECT

IVF CELEBRATES 14TH FOUNDATION DAY IN NEW DELHI

The International Vaish Federation (IVF) celebrated its 14th Foundation Day and organised the 'Vaish Mitra Samman' ceremony at the Constitution Club of India, bringing together prominent leaders, entrepreneurs, and social contributors to recognise the Vaish community's role in nation-building.

Union Minister for Law and Justice, Arjun Ram Meghwal, was present as the Chief Guest, while senior BJP leader and former National Vice President Shyam Jaju was also present. The event honoured distinguished personalities from the fields of education, industry, healthcare, social service, culture, and public welfare for their exemplary contributions to society. Addressing the gathering, Meghwal said that the vision of a 'Viksit Bharat' can only be realised through the active participation of every section of society.

He highlighted the Vaish community's significant contribution through entrepreneurship, social responsibility, and service to the nation. Speaking on the occasion, Dr Ashok Agarwal, International President of the International Vaish Federation, said, "Our objective is not only to unite the community but also to empower future generations through service, values, and social responsibility, thereby contributing meaningfully to the country's development." (PNS)

ARO Narangi motivates 182 NCC cadets on career opportunities in Army

TONY DAS
■ Narangi Cantt

Army Recruiting Office (ARO) Narangi, under Zone Recruiting Office (ZRO) Shillong, conducted a motivational outreach programme on "Career Options in the Indian Army" for NCC cadets of Guwahati Group NCC and Imphal Group NCC at Brahmaputra Hall, Narangi Cantonment.

A total of 182 NCC cadets attended the programme, which aimed to create awareness about the diverse career opportunities available in the Indian Army and inspire young aspirants to serve the Nation.

During the session, representatives from ARO Narangi provided detailed information on various entry schemes, including Agniveer (Women Military Police), National Defence Academy (NDA), Officer Entries, and NCC Special Entry. The cadets were also briefed on eligibility criteria, selection procedures, career progression, and the numerous benefits

Bharat Ki Soch, Manav Rachna Univ ties to harness knowledge system

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ NEW DELHI

In a significant step toward aligning classical civilisational wisdom with modern academic and policy frameworks, Bharat Ki Soch (BKS) and the Manav Rachna Centre for Peace & Sustainability (MRCPS), Manav Rachna University, officially signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) at the Bharat Ki Soch office.

This research collaboration establishes a strategic partnership to leverage the Indian Knowledge System (IKS) as a foundational framework for sustainable development, civic responsibility, and national progress, aiming directly to support the country's journey towards a Viksit Bharat. All joint initiatives, academic outputs, and advocacy campaigns will be



carried out under the joint branding of Bharat Ki Soch and MRCPS.

Speaking at the event, Anil Rajput, Chairperson of Bharat Ki Soch, shared a profound vision for the country's future, emphasising that true macro-level transformation must begin at the grassroots—with our students and children. He noted that while youth are traditionally viewed as the future of the nation, they

shaped by what they can contribute to their country, rather than being overly focused on what the country can do for them. Reflecting on the deeper psychological and spiritual dimensions of national development, he concluded that true economic sustainability demands greater resilience and innovation.

The signing ceremony was attended by a high-level delegation from Manav Rachna University, led by the Vice Chancellor, Prof. Deependra Kumar Jha, alongside Dr Anandajit Goswami, head of the Centre for Peace & Sustainability. Expressing his strong support for the partnership, Prof. Jha deeply appreciated the vision of Bharat Ki Soch, noting how closely it resonates with the core civilizational ideals of Manav Rachna University.

DFCCIL organises Stakeholder Conference on financing, construction of East–West Dedicated Freight Corridor

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited (DFCCIL) organised a Stakeholder Conference on the financing and construction of the proposed East–West Dedicated Freight Corridor (EWDFC) at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi. The conference brought together developers, landowners, investors, financial institutions, and prospective bidders to facilitate stakeholder consultations and discuss the project's implementation framework and financing opportunities.

The conference was led by Praveen Kumar, Managing Director, DFCCIL; Shyam Sundar Gupta, Principal Executive Director (Infrastructure), Railway Board; B Mugunthan, Director (Finance), DFCCIL; and Rahul Kapoor, Executive Director (Finance/RM & PPP), Railway Board.

Convened by Ajay Kumar, Executive Director (Asset Management) and Sanjeev Gupta, Executive Director (Finance), the conference was attended by Shobhit Bhatnagar, Director (Opera-



tions & Business Development); Anurag Sharma, Director (Infrastructure); Pawan K Rai, Director (Project Planning); and senior officers from DFCCIL.

The discussions focused on the financing framework, construction strategy, stakeholder participation, and implementation roadmap for the EWDFC under the Hybrid Annuity Model (HAM). The interactive session provided a platform for addressing stakeholder queries, exchanging valuable inputs, and strengthening collaborative efforts for the timely development of India's next-generation freight corridor.

The conference witnessed enthusiastic participation from a wide cross-section of stakeholders, including leading infrastructure developers, EPC contractors, logistics and port operators, rolling stock and rail technology companies, finan-

cial institutions, multilateral agencies, infrastructure investors, rating agencies and consultants. Prominent organisations represented at the conference included Larsen & Toubro (L&T), Afcons Infrastructure, Tata Projects, IRCON International, Rail Vikas Nigam Limited (RVNL), RITES Ltd., G R Infra projects, Ashoka Buildcon, Megha Engineering & Infrastructures Ltd. (MEIL), Hindustan Construction Company (HCC), Kalpataru Projects International, KEC International, GPT Infraprojects, Dineshchandra R Agrawal Infracon Pvt. Ltd. (DRAIPL), GMR Group and Hindalco Industries. Representatives from the logistics and freight sector, including Container Corporation of India (CONCOR), Adani Road Transport Ltd and DP World also participated in the deliberations. The conference was further attended by infrastructure investors and advisory organisations such as National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF), CDPQ India, Morgan Stanley Investment Management, EY, PwC, Siemens Financial Services, ICRA, CARE Ratings, CRISIL and India Ratings & Research.

Participation from leading domestic and international financial institutions and development finance organisations, including Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA), World Bank, State Bank of India, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, Axis Bank, Bank of Baroda, Canara Bank, Central Bank of India, IDBI Bank, IndusInd Bank, Union Bank of India, UCO Bank, Indian Overseas Bank, Indian Infrastructure Finance Company Limited (IIFCL), Indian Railway Finance Corporation (IRFC), Power Finance Corporation (PFC), REC Limited, HUDCO, National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaBFID), International Finance Corporation (IFC), New Development Bank (NDB), MUFG Bank and YES Bank, reflected strong investor confidence and broad stakeholder interest in the implementation of the East–West Dedicated Freight Corridor.

Praveen Kumar, reiterated DFCCIL's commitment to taking forward the EWDFC with full momentum through collaborative engagement, innovative financing, and focused execution.

First World War Indian soldiers commemorated after historical omission



AGENCIES
■ Maidenhead, UK

The Commonwealth War Graves Commission (CWGC) on Thursday announced the largest single addition to its casualty records since the Second World War, following a major international research project drawing on rare historical records. A total of 9,909 Indian Army servicemen - previously missing from the CWGC's records - have now been added, correcting a past historical omission that meant they were never formally commemorated.

Singh, had not been properly commemorated. She said: "When I attended the annual Chattri Memorial Service in Brighton, held in honour of the soldiers from Undivided India who gave their lives during the First World War, I never expected to receive such momentous news.

"Learning from the UK Punjab Heritage Association that my maternal great-grandfather will now be officially recognised on the CWGC casualty database was incredibly moving and overwhelming.

"To know that his service and sacrifice are finally being properly acknowledged means so much to our family over 100 years on. In the present difficult times, this recognition feels especially significant. After all these years, he is finally being given the honour, dignity and remembrance he always deserved"

Claire Horton CBE, Director General of the CWGC, said, "Over a century after the end of the First World War, our mission endures, ensuring all those who died in the service of the Commonwealth receive the commemoration they deserve. The Punjab Registers project is a landmark moment in that mission. The recovery of every one of these 9,909 names helps restore missing chapters in family and world histories. It stands as a constant, timeless reminder that commemoration is not only about the past - it is about personal identity, family legacy and recognising the human cost of war." "CWGC remains committed to meaningful physical commemoration and to working with governments and nations to seek their views on a memorial to honour these individual soldiers with dignity and respect they so rightly deserve."

DAILY SUDOKU

7832

4

6471

8597

215

1689

3954

1537

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9x9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3x3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9x9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3x3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.

SOLUTION (9.7.26)

5	7	8	2	6	4	3	9	1
6	3	1	9	8	7	4	2	5
2	4	9	1	3	5	7	8	6
7	2	4	5	1	8	6	3	9
1	5	3	4	9	6	2	7	8
8	9	6	3	7	2	5	1	4
4	1	5	7	2	9	8	6	3
3	8	2	6	4	1	9	5	7
9	6	7	8	5	3	1	4	2

DOUBLE CROSSWORD FRIDAY | JULY 10, 2026

1234567

891011121314151617

20212223242526272829303132333435363738

ACROSS

3 Name for a liquid asset (5)

8 To horrify dad is wrong, mate (5)

10 Left in the dark (5)

11 Rubbish from a protester (3)

12 Badly grown? (5)

13 Bookish carrier of strange tales about the church (7)

15 Wherein householders may provide mutual backing (5)

18 He stopped with Ted (3)

19 Choose the best carbon content for steel, possibly (6)

21 Failure due to lack of maintenance? (7)

22 Like some troops seen in retreat? (4)

- 23 A handy plant (4)
- 24 Heartbroken when things are in tatters? (7)
- 26 Those home ones that can hurt in extremes of tediousness? (6)
- 29 It quite alters one's meaning (3)
- 31 Fine new purse (5)
- 32 Taxform sent out for guidance (7)
- 34 Well known to have done wrong, being out to start trouble (5)
- 35 She turns to give a hail (3)
- 36 Thus, during January, he partnered Medea (5)
- 37 River forded at Griffin Park (5)
- 38 Read a letter from a novelist (5)

DOWN

- 1 Prays for fine distribution (5)
- 2 One keeping an eye on the time? (7)
- 4 Fearless nobleman? (4)
- 5 Time for us to return to the nest, possibly (6)
- 6 Tube station in a strange land (5)
- 7 Of the citizens, 104, I see (5)
- 9 Shoot for a trophy (3)
- 12 They keep you feet dry (in wells, that is) (7)
- 14 Witch in ancient Carthage (3)
- 16 Gong finally heard during dinner? (5)

- 17 Put your foot down! (5)
- 19 Disdained to treat Ed's corn (7)
- 20 Sees notices in places (5)
- 21 Like a bouncer one shouldn't hit, being in bed (3,2)
- 23 The midshipman says they're clubs! (7)
- 24 Four-legged form of hornet? (6)
- 25 A noisy beast, cunning, too! (3)
- 27 Like the air terminal over the river, not in town (5)
- 28 He sings for some rotten orchestra! (5)
- 30 In a way, silly (5)
- 32 Check the figure possibly broadcast (4)
- 33 The short way out of Newhaven (3)

SOLUTION (9.7.26)									
ACROSS	1, Essay	6, P-O-pp-y	9, Bar-tram	10, Chest	11, Ralls	12, Son-nets	15, Des(-pots)	17, Pit	18, Co-gent
	19, Gruel	20, D-rear-y	22, Do-pe	24, So-T	25, Liberal	26, Man-la	27, Ab-b-ot	28, C-I-V-en	29, Old boys
	30, Weedy	31, Meaty							
DOWN	2, School	3, AB-sent	4, Yo-T	5, Si-ops	6, Paras-ol	7, OM-ar	8, Pollen	12, Story	13, Spuds
	15, D-E-cor	16, St-eel	18, Cella	19, Gre-at-ly	22, Devise	23, Pa-rent	25, Limbo	26, Moo-D	28, Gym

SBI Life, IIT-B launch Bharat Innovation Hub to bolster AI and cyber defences

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

SBI Life Insurance, one of the country's most trusted private life insurers, has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay) to establish 'Bharat's AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance' (the "Bharat Innovation Hub"), a joint research and innovation centre dedicated to building India's own deep-technology defences for the insurance sector. This partnership will ensure enhanced safety of customer information by creating technologies conceived, developed, and owned in India.



The MoU was signed by Prof. SV Kulkarni, Dean-R&D, IIT- Bombay and Vishal Bhatia, Chief Information & Digital Officer, SBI Life Insurance in presence of Prof. Shireesh B Kedare, Director, IIT-Bombay; Abhijit Gulanikar, President - Ops & IT, SBI Life;

Subhendu Bal, President - Chief Risk Officer, SBI Life; Balaji Venketaswar, Professor of Practice, IIT-Bombay; Prof. Ganesh Ramakrishnan, Chair Professor, Department of CSE, IIT-Bombay & Founding Director, BharatGen; and Pravin Ghatge, EVP & Head- Infra Core, Cloud & CITSO among other respected dignitaries.

India's insurance premium growth is forecasted at 6.9% annually until 2030, making it the strongest growing major insurance market. As the country's insurance penetration improves, customer data is set to grow by the day, protecting that data is as important as protecting the

policies themselves. Thus the need for 'Bharat Innovation Hub', which marks a decisive shift away from dependence on imported security frameworks and towards cyber defence capabilities that are designed, built, and owned in India.

The partnership marks a significant step in SBI Life's journey towards becoming an AI-native insurer; an organisation that does not merely adopt technology, but actively creates it. The goal is to build scalable, resilient, deep-tech solutions capable of meeting the expectations of both customers and regulators in an increasingly digital world.

TRAI seeks authorisation from MeitY to act against call management apps: Sources

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Telecom regulator TRAI has sought authorisation from the IT ministry to act against call management apps like Truecaller, sources aware of the development said.



The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) has already floated a draft regulation to tighten the noose on pesky and fraudulent

calls with a provision to regulate call management apps – a move which has been countered by caller identification app Truecaller CEO Rishit Jhunjhunwala.

"TRAI has sought authorisation from MeitY to regulate the functioning of the call management app for robust action against spam and fraud calls. Discussions have been held with the Department of Telecom as well. The authorisation will help in making apps and service providers more accountable towards unsolicited calls," a source, who did not wish to be named, said.

Jyoti AI Vision Glasses, AI-powered assistive technologies launched to aid visually impaired

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Blind Relief Association, in collaboration with Torchit Electronics Pvt. Ltd., launched a range of AI-powered assistive technologies, including Wireless Jyoti AI Vision Glasses and Advanced Foldable Smart White Cane, to enhance accessibility, inclusive education, and independent living for persons with visual impairments. Jyoti AI Web, EnableMart Experience & Resource Center, and the EnableMart Assistive Technology Resource Book were also launched for Dvyangjan.

Inaugurating the event, Manmeet Kaur Nanda, Additional Secretary, Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (DEPwD), Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment, said that assistive technology is key to education, employment, mobility, and dignity, and reaffirmed the government's commitment to promoting AI-enabled assistive technologies through the upcoming Divyang Sahara Yojana and the vision of the Purple Economy.

Dr Suraj Senjam, Professor, Dr Rajendra Prasad Centre for Ophthalmic Sciences, AIIMS, New Delhi, stressed the need for affordable 'Make in India' assistive technologies and highlighted AIIMS' collaboration with Torchit in conducting user evaluations to further improve AI-based solutions for persons with visual impairments.

Cannot remain silent about officiating in Egypt’s 3-2 loss to Argentina: EFA

MAURA CAREY ■ Atlanta

The Egyptian Football Association (EFA) said Wednesday it “cannot remain silent” after what it believes was unfair and biased officiating in Egypt’s 3-2 round of 16 loss against Argentina.

Egypt coach Hossam Hassan and several players criticised the officiating after being left in disbelief as Argentina scored three unanswered goals in 13 minutes to pull off one of the biggest comebacks in World Cup history.

“Defending the rights and interests of the Egyptian national team is not a matter that can be ignored, minimised, or treated as secondary,” the EFA said in a statement. “It is a responsibility that we carry with full conviction and determination.”

FIFA’s chief of refereeing Pierluigi Collina, in a statement issued later Wednesday, said while constructive discussion about decisions would always be part of football, “unfounded



allegations have no place in our sport.”

“Nobody can question the integrity of the FIFA World Cup match officials,” he said. “When this happens, it may provoke reactions that lead to threats against them and their families. This is not right.” The EFA said that the referee failed to use the Video Assistant Referee (VAR) system appropriately, leading to the loss to Argentina.

Egypt appeared to have netted its second goal in the 58th minute, but a VAR review determined that Marwan Attia had fouled Argentina defender Lisandro Martinez early in the buildup up to the goal. “Several key incidents raised serious concerns and left profound questions about the consistency and fairness of decisions that directly influenced the course of the game,” the EFA statement read.

Collina said “during a competition, we prefer not to focus on specific incidents,” but he defended the Attia decision. “If a foul is identified in the

build-up and is deemed to have had an impact on the goal, the VAR will recommend an on-field review,” Collina said. “There is no defined limit regarding either the distance from goal or the amount of time between the incident and the goal.” He said in the disputed case, Attia

“clearly treads on the foot of Argentina No. 6 Lisandro Martinez.” “We believe that a foul is a foul,” Collina added.

“Regardless of whether the foul appears obvious,” if the referee did not see it on the field of play, the VAR can intervene.” (AP)

Belgium gets serious for quarterfinal with Spain



GREG BEACHAM ■ Carson (US)

No more playful dances. No more taunting social media posts. Belgium is done celebrating its victory over the host United States and hard at work on extending its World Cup run on American soil.

The Red Devils trained in the Los Angeles area on Wednesday with the memory still fresh of their 4-1 thrashing of the Americans in Seattle on Monday. After surviving a test from Senegal with a thrilling comeback and then thoroughly dominating the US in its first two knockout games, Belgium faces its toughest challenge yet against unbeaten Spain in the quarterfinals on Friday. But this tumultuous World Cup run has sparked something in this Belgian team, goalkeeper Thibaut Courtois believes.

“We gained a lot of confidence, because we knew it was going to be a hard game against America,” Courtois said at the LA Galaxy’s suburban stadium. “They’re obviously the home team with a full stadium (that’s) with them, so it’s nice to perform in a good way defensive, offensively, and just play our game.”

Belgium went into the US matchup with a world of indignant motivation after star American forward Folarin Balogun’s one-game red-card suspension was curiously lifted by FIFA. The Red Devils took it out on an outclassed American team and then celebrated gleefully, both on the pitch and in the dressing room. In the most viral moment, many players did the simplistic dance associated with US President Donald Trump and performed by numerous athletes across the sports world in recent months, including American star Christian Pulisic.

Belgium left back Diego Moreira smiled slightly when asked about the meaning of doing the dance after Trump called FIFA President Gianni Infantino to ask for a review of Balogun’s red card. “There are different ways to celebrate different goals,” Moreira said through an interpreter. “You can do different dances, and that’s what we’ve done. We just celebrated the win after the game.” Courtois said he wasn’t in the dressing room because he was at doping control, so he couldn’t comment on the dance. The Red Devils say they’ve put that cathartic evening behind them after landing for their second game of the tournament to be played at SoFi Stadium in the Los Angeles area. (AP)

Henderson returns to England camp after surgery



ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Kansas City

England midfielder Jordan Henderson rejoined The Three Lions at their World Cup training base after undergoing surgery on his left wrist following a freak injury that he sustained while celebrating their Round of 16 triumph over Mexico last weekend. The 36-year-old Henderson posted a photo on social media of his left arm wrapped after the procedure at the Kansas City Orthopaedic Institute, which is about a 10-minute drive from their team hotel in the suburb of Prairie Village, Kansas. “Surgery done!” Henderson said. “Now let’s get ready for the big one Saturday.” Henderson, who has been ruled out for the remainder of the World Cup, had been an unused substitute for Sunday’s match against Mexico at Azteca Stadium in Mexico City. The Three Lions had just survived a 3-2 thriller to advance to a quarterfinal against Norway when Henderson hurt his wrist while climbing over an advertising billboard.

Henderson was taken from the field on a stretcher and remained in Mexico City while the rest of England’s players returned to their base camp in Kansas City, Missouri.



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**E-AUCTION
SALE NOTICE**
(Under SARFAESI Act 2002)

APPENDIX- IV-A [SEE PROVISO TO RULE 8(6) & 9(1)] SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower(s) and guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the secured creditor, the **Physical / Symbolic Possession** of which have been taken by the Authorized officer of **Central Bank of India**, secured creditors, will be sold on **29.07.2026 “As is where is”, “As is what is” and “whatever there is”** basis for recovery of dues to the Central Bank of India from below mention Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and earnest money deposit (EMD) is displayed against the details of respective properties. For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in: www.centralbank.bank.in or (<https://BAANKNET.com>)

DESCRIPTION OF PROPERTIES TO BE AUCTIONED ON 29.07.2026 (15 DAYS NOTICE)							
S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer/ B.M.	Name of the Account	Description of Property & Owner Name	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (Rs. in Lakhs)	Date & Type of Possession	Reserve Price EMD Bid Increase
1.	Old Rajapuri New Delhi	Ms. Nishat Fatima MOB: 8800013552	MR. MOHAN KUMAR GHOSHAL & MRS. SONALI GHOSHAL	Residential Property Bearing No.23, Third Floor, with Roof / Terrace Rights, built on land area measuring 60 Sq.Yds. or 50.16 Sq.Mtr. with Super Area 540 Sq.Ft. out of Khasra No.64/4, situated in the area of Village Hastsal Now the Residential Colony is known as Mohan Garden Block-K-1 Extension Near Kamal School & ICICI Bank, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059.	Rs.11,41,846.38 on 01.05.2025 + Interest + Other Charges	08.04.2025 (Physical)	₹ 16,20,000.00 ₹ 1,62,000.00 ₹ 15,000.00
2.	Dwarka (3583) New Delhi	Mr. Ashish Kumar MOBILE: 8800013553	MRS. MANJU YADAV & MR. SANTOSH YADAV	Free Hold Residential Property Bearing No.24, Flat No.306, 2nd Floor without Roof Rights, Area of Village KiloKari, Colony known as Sidharth Nagar, New Delhi-110014. Area 37.62 Sq.Mtr. or 404.94 Sq.Ft. Owned by - Mrs. Manju Yadav W/o Mr. Santosh Yadav	Rs.12,18,524.73 as on 12.09.2025 + Interest + Other Charges	26.08.2025 (Physical)	₹ 16,60,000.00 ₹ 1,66,000.00 ₹ 15,000.00

E-AUCTION DATE: 29.07.2026, TIME: 12:00 NOON TO 4:00 P.M WITH AUTO EXTENSION OF 10 MINUTES
Last Date & Time of Submission of EMD and Documents (Online) On or Before: **29.07.2026 Upto 3:30 PM.** Bidder will register on website: (<https://BAANKNET.com>) and upload KYC documents and after verification of KYC documents by the service provider, EMD to be deposited in Global EMD Wallet through NEFT/RTGS/Transfer (after generation of challan from (<https://BAANKNET.com>)).
The auction will be conducted through the Bank’s approved service provider “<https://BAANKNET.com>” E-auction will be held on “**As is where is”, “As is what is” and “whatever there is”** basis. (All other charges/dues to the property will be borne by the purchaser).
For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in www.centralbank.bank.in . Secured Creditor or Auction Platform (<https://BAANKNET.com>) | **BAANKNET** Helpline: (+91) 8291220220, E-mail: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com

NOTICE FOR SUB STATUTORY 15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) OF SARFAESI ACT 2002
The borrowers/guarantors/ mortgagors are hereby notified to pay the sum as mentioned above along with upto date interest and ancillary expenses before the date of e-auction, failing which the property will be auctioned/sold and balance dues, if any, will be recovered with interest and cost.

DATE: 09.07.2026
PLACE: DELHI

Authorised Officer, CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA,
Regional Office (Gurugram) Chandni Chowk, Delhi



सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ इंडिया
Central Bank of India

1911 से आपके लिए “केन्द्रित” “CENTRAL” TO YOU SINCE 1911

Regional Office Delhi (South)
**3rd Floor, Sorabji Bhawan, 4/54, D.B.
Gupta Road, Karolbagh, New Delhi-110005**

**E-AUCTION
SALE NOTICE**
(Under SARFAESI Act 2002)

APPENDIX- IV-A [SEE PROVISO TO RULE 8(6) & 9(1)] SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower(s) and guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Central Bank of India (secured creditor), the constructive/ physical Possession of which have been taken by the authorized officer of Central Bank of India (Secured creditors), will be sold on “**As is where is”, “As is what is” and “whatever there is”** basis on date 30.07.2026 for recovery of dues to the **Central Bank of India** from below mention Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and Earnest money deposit (EMD) is displayed against the details of respective properties.

E-AUCTION SCHEDULED TO BE HELD ON 30.07.2026 (15 DAY'S NOTICE)							
S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer/ Branch Head	Name of the Account	Description of Property & Owner Name	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (in Rupees)	Date & Type of Possession	In Rupees Reserve Price EMD Bid Increase
1.	Anand Parbat New Delhi	Mr. Mukesh Rathore MOBILE: 9211521403	Mr. Pramod Gupta & Mrs. Chander Wati	Property Bearing No.RZ-6K/11/563 (Old No.RZ-6K/11) Out of Khasra No.650, Entire Third Floor with Terrace Rights, Indira Park, Palam Colony, Nasirpur, New Delhi-110045. Area Measuring 75 Sq.Yds. Owner - Mr. Pramod Gupta	Rs.46,86,662.00 on 05.07.2022 + interest thereafter	06.04.2024 (Physical)	₹ 22,50,000.00 ₹ 2,25,000.00 ₹ 20,000.00
2.	Gulmohar Park New Delhi	Ms. Archana Sharma MOBILE: 8448296394	Vipin Kumar Gaur	First Floor Back Side Left Side Portion without Roof Rights, part of Property No RZ-902, Gali No- 23, measuring Area 45.84 Sq Mtr, out of Khasra No 445, Situated at Tuglakabad Extension, New Delhi- 110019, Owner- Mr. Vipin Kumar Gaur S/o Mr. Murari Lal	Rs. 32,83,616.60 on 14.05.2025 + Interest thereafter	26.12.2025 (Physical)	₹ 17,10,000.00 ₹ 1,71,000.00 ₹ 20,000.00
3.	Janpath New Delhi	Mr. Ravi Kumar MOBILE: 9999917105	Mr. Rakesh Kumar & Mrs. Anita Devi	LIG Flat No. G-3 (Without Roof Rights), Ground Floor, Plot No. 222, Shalimar Garden Extension 1, Vill.- Pasonda, Ghaziabad, UP-201005, Owner- Mr. Rakesh Kumar & Mrs. Anita Devi	Rs.17,09,512.00 on 06.01.2017 + interest thereafter	07.12.2021 (Physical)	₹ 14,40,000.00 ₹ 1,44,000.00 ₹ 15,000.00
4.	Karol Bagh New Delhi	Mr. Vinay Kumar MOBILE: 9999917126	Mr. Ranjeet Singh	DDA built up Residential Flat No.- F.F.- 20 Fourth Floor (LIG) in Pocket- 3, Block- F-8, Sector- G-8, Narela, Delhi- 110040, Area- 472 Sq Ft, Owner- Mr. Ranjeet Singh S/o Mr. Amrik Singh	Rs. 14,20,145.46 on 30.05.2023 + interest thereafter	30.07.2025 (Physical)	₹ 10,73,000.00 ₹ 1,07,300.00 ₹ 10,000.00
5.	Lady Harding Medical College	Ms. Kumari Ritu MOBILE: 9319992541	Mr. Imran Khan and Mrs. Rehana	Free hold Residential Flat No.- F.F.- 1 First Floor (HIG) without Roof Rights on Plot No B-1/16, DLF Ankur Vihar, Loni, Ghaziabad, Area- 900 Sq Ft, Owner- Mr. Imran Khan S/o Mr. Mohammed Sharif and Mrs. Rehana W/o Mr. Imran Khan	Rs.10,01,634.29 on 14.06.2024 + interest thereafter	29.05.2025 (Physical)	₹ 15,30,000.00 ₹ 1,53,000.00 ₹ 15,000.00
6.	Paharganj New Delhi	Mr. Rajiv Kumar MOBILE: 8847236384	Mr. Rakesh Kumar Sahu	Residential LIG Flat No SF- 3 (Second Floor), back Side with Roof Rights, situated at Plot No M.M.- 43, DLF Ankur Vihar, Village- Loni, District- Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201102, Super covered Area 400 Sq Feet, Owner- Mr. Rakesh Kumar Sahu S/o Mr. Laxman Prasad Sahu	Rs. 10,36,988.55 on 04.06.2024 + interest thereafter	19.12.2025 (Physical)	₹ 8,23,500.00 ₹ 82,350.00 ₹ 10,000.00

E-AUCTION DATE: 30.07.2026, TIME: 12:00 NOON TO 04:00 PM WITH AUTO EXTENSION OF 10 MINUTES
Last Date & Time of Submission of EMD and Documents (Online) On or Before: **30.07.2026 Upto 03:30 PM.**
Bidder will register on website: <https://BAANKNET.com> and upload KYC documents and after verification of KYC documents by the service provider, EMD to be deposited in **BAANKNET** EMD wallet through NEFT/RTGS/Transfer / Generation of challan from (<https://BAANKNET.com>).
The auction will be conducted through common landing platform **BAANKNET.com Portal** (<https://BAANKNET.com>). E-auction will be held “**As is where is”, “As is what is” and “whatever there is”** basis. **Property shall be sold only above the Reserve Price. (All other charges/ dues to the property will be borne by the purchaser).** For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in www.centralbank.bank.in Secured Creditor or auction platform (<https://BAANKNET.com>). Helpline: (+91) 8291220220, E-mail: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com

STATUTORY 15 DAY'S SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) OF THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002
Borrowers/Guarantors/ Mortgagors are hereby notified to pay the sum as mentioned above along with upto date interest and ancillary expenses before the date of e-auction, failing which the property will be auctioned/sold and balance dues, if any, will be recovered with interest and cost.

DATE: 09.07.2026
PLACE: NEW DELHI

Authorised Officer,
CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA, RO Delhi (South), New Delhi



AXIS BANK LTD.

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR - AUCTION OF PLEDGED ASSETS BEING GOLD ORNAMENTS
The Borrowers, in specific and the public in general are here by notified that public auction of the gold ornaments pledge in the below accounts is proposed to be conducted by the Axis Bank at the below mentioned Branch.
That the below mentioned Borrowers has availed the credit facility from the **Axis Bank Limited** against the pledge of gold ornaments (“Gold Loan Facility”) in favour of the Bank towards the security. The Demand notices were issued to the Borrowers/Guarantors calling up the Borrowers/Guarantors to pay their outstanding amount towards the Gold loan facility availed. As the Borrowers/Guarantors have failed to repay the outstanding loan amount, the bank is constrained to invoke the pledge and proposed to conduct an auction sale of pledged gold ornaments more particularly described in schedule of property hereunder on **10.08.2026 at 11:00 AM on “As In Where Is”, “As Is What Is”, “Whatever There Is” and “No Recourse Basis”**. Auction will be held at

DETAILS OF BORROWERS AND OUTSTANDING AMOUNT					
Customer Name	Loan A/c No.	Amount Outstanding (₹)	Date of Recall Notice	Gross Weight	Net Weight
B.O.: BADARPUR DELHI DL					
ALKA	XXXXXXXXXX2866	₹ 3,08,998.00	15-06-2026	34.330	31.830
VISHVENDRA .	XXXXXXXXXX4171	₹ 1,19,032.00	23-06-2026	12.990	11.990
B.O.: JYOTI NAGAR DEL DL					
BHAWANA DEVI	XXXXXXXXXX5104	₹ 15,03,901.20	19-12-2025	221.700	214.600
B.O.: KALKAJI, NEW DELHI [DL]					
CHANDAN KUMAR MAL	XXXXXXXXXX1110	₹ 2,64,126.19	02-04-2026	38.800	36.900
B.O.: KAPASHERA OD DL					
PRAMOD SINGH	XXXXXXXXXX3377	₹ 3,78,984.23	02-04-2026	54.400	48.900
B.O.: KISHANGANJ OD DL					
PUSHKAR GUPTA	XXXXXXXXXX8381	₹ 1,73,261.00	04-06-2026	21.090	20.490
ROHIT SAIN	XXXXXXXXXX3587	₹ 93,394.00	04-06-2026	9.850	9.600
VISHAL	XXXXXXXXXX4312	₹ 23,16,254.87	04-06-2026	240.700	219.300
B.O.: LAJPAT NAGAR, NEW DELHI [DL]					
MAYANK KOHLI	XXXXXXXXXX7068	₹ 8,23,670.00	12-02-2026	137.900	124.800
SARTHAK PRAKASH	XXXXXXXXXX7308	₹ 12,67,896.95	04-06-2026	181.000	138.000
B.O.: LAJPATNAGAR II, NEW DELHI [DL]					
MANU BARTWAL	XXXXXXXXXX0661	₹ 8,16,543.00	07-05-2026	125.000	117.300
B.O.: LAJWANTI GARDEN, JANAKPURI, NEW					
KUSUM	XXXXXXXXXX4777	₹ 11,80,722.03	04-05-2026	143.900	135.300
B.O.: LOKVIHAR, DELHI [DL]					
ANIL KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX5411	₹ 14,40,396.70	18-05-2026	165.600	159.000
B.O.: MALVIYA NAGAR, NEW DELHI [DL]					
AGAMYA JHA	XXXXXXXXXX9995	₹ 16,70,763.00	19-03-2026	207.100	197.500
B.O.: PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI [DL]					
NEETISH KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX0181	₹ 2,31,799.00	15-06-2026	25.300	23.500
B.O.: PUSHPVIHAR, DELHI [DL]					
AKIL HUSSAIN	XXXXXXXXXX0752	₹ 6,47,860.00	18-05-2026	106.600	90.800
KALU RAM	XXXXXXXXXX4969	₹ 1,95,841.95	04-06-2026	23.800	22.300
B.O.: R K MISSION, NEW DELHI [DL]					
AAMIR ABDUL RASHID	XXXXXXXXXX8231	₹ 2,25,850.26	04-06-2026	83.570	81.050
MEHBUBA BEGUM	XXXXXXXXXX6907	₹ 4,13,036.16	04-06-2026	44.420	41.470
NIRBHAY KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX9486	₹ 78,669.00	07-05-2026	19.800	15.100
B.O.: SECTOR 20 DWARKA DL					
VINEETA RAINA	XXXXXXXXXX3377	₹ 3,55,280.61	02-04-2026	38.700	36.700
B.O.: SHAHDARA, DELHI [DL]					
MADAN LAL KHANNA	XXXXXXXXXX9048	₹ 7,52,476.00	04-06-2026	121.600	118.900
RANJANA KAMAL SHARMA	XXXXXXXXXX1374	₹ 5,55,914.90	18-04-2026	58.300	56.800
B.O.: SWASTHYA VIHAR, NEW DELHI [DL]					
RASHID QURAISHI	XXXXXXXXXX3577	₹ 9,35,362.00	15-06-2026	116.500	112.000
B.O.: VIKASPURI, NEW DELHI [DL]					
PUNEET SHARMA	XXXXXXXXXX7448	₹ 11,18,598.65	04-06-2026	169.800	148.300
SIDDHARTH AGARWAL	XXXXXXXXXX7163	₹ 2,43,169.14	04-06-2026	75.200	71.400
B.O.: VISHWAS NAGAR DEL DL					
SARLA GUPTA	XXXXXXXXXX6413	₹ 3,05,321.00	15-06-2026	78.500	48.100
B.O.: DLF, GURGAON [HR]					
AKANKSHA	XXXXXXXXXX1868	₹ 19,98,535.29	04-06-2026	201.800	195.000
AMIT	XXXXXXXXXX0309	₹ 26,78,401.73	04-05-2026	511.800	477.900
B.O.: FARIDABAD [HR]					
VANSH BHATIA	XXXXXXXXXX1038	₹ 28,77,372.00	04-06-2026	292.500	287.100
VANSH BHATIA	XXXXXXXXXX5451	₹ 23,34,700.11	02-05-2026	240.400	238.400
B.O.: MANESAR [HR]					
AMIT KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX0968	₹ 81,328.30	09-02-2026	31.300	28.500
SHIVAM RAGHAV	XXXXXXXXXX8896	₹ 1,38,576.61	15-06-2026	26.300	24.600
SHIVAM RAGHAV	XXXXXXXXXX7422	₹ 1,20,870.00	15-06-2026	24.500	23.000
SUNITA DEVI	XXXXXXXXXX1053	₹ 17,22,636.99	18-04-2026	203.970	178.470
B.O.: NEW RAILWAY ROAD, GURGAON [HR]					
VIVEK SINGH	XXXXXXXXXX5630	₹ 53,736.91	02-04-2026	7.300	6.700
B.O.: PALAM VIHAR, GURGAON [HR]					
ANIL KUMAR PODDAR	XXXXXXXXXX3306	₹ 92,147.00	07-05-2026	30.600	28.400
B.O.: PARADISE MALL S GUR HR					
LAKSHMAN YADAV	XXXXXXXXXX6702	₹ 1,18,661.00	15-06-2026	13.700	12.700
MANISHA .	XXXXXXXXXX6353	₹ 12,15,105.85	07-05-2026	153.300	150.500
RAM KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX0135	₹ 3,31,963.00	04-06-2026	63.300	61.000
B.O.: SECTOR 10A, GURGAON [HR]					
HARSH SINGH	XXXXXXXXXX1937	₹ 23,69,376.70	04-06-2026	299.300	276.300
SUBHADRA	XXXXXXXXXX5061	₹ 5,28,502.00	04-06-2026	82.800	80.400
B.O.: SECTOR 14, GURGAON [HR]					
NANCY MEENA	XXXXXXXXXX4671	₹ 6,21,836.00	07-05-2026	132.600	123.600
VISHAL KATARIA	XXXXXXXXXX1151	₹ 2,09,219.00	15-06-2026	25.300	24.300
B.O.: SECTOR 16, FARIDABAD [HR]					
DEEPAK	XXXXXXXXXX1876	₹ 1,71,246.00	04-06-2026	31.300	29.400
B.O.: SECTOR 31-32A, GURGAON [HR]					
DHANRAJ SONWAL	XXXXXXXXXX0273	₹ 89,563.00	15-06-2026	10.000	9.300
B.O.: SECTOR-17, GURG GUR HR					
ISHA KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX3424	₹ 2,16,829.00	04-06-2026	28.000	25.000
B.O.: GHAZIABAD [UP]					
ASHISH KUMAR CHANDRABANSI	XXXXXXXXXX5045	₹ 1,28,268.00	15-06-2026	22.900	22.100
ASHISH KUMAR CHANDRABANSI	XXXXXXXXXX4151	₹ 72,428.44	04-06-2026	22.900	22.100
NADEEM	XXXXXXXXXX7673	₹ 3,21,360.85	18-04-2026	36.500	34.600
B.O.: GREATER NOIDA [UP]					
ARUN SHARMA	XXXXXXXXXX6779	₹ 16,91,497.00	07-05-2026	173.600	161.100
C SWETHA SREE	XXXXXXXXXX9217	₹ 3,39,614.70	04-06-2026	52.100	50.200
INDRAJ BHATI	XXXXXXXXXX1733	₹ 12,73,058.00	18-05-2026	176.000	167.800
MOHAMMAD DANISH	XXXXXXXXXX0271	₹ 1,49,740.00	07-05-2026	27.800	26.400
NTISH KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX3812	₹ 60,946.00	06-06-2026	15.300	14.500
REKHA SHRIVASTAVA	XXXXXXXXXX5797	₹ 9,05,584.00	19-03-2026	111.300	103



British wild card Arthur Fery reaches Wimbledon semifinals

KEN MAGUIRE ■ London

If he keeps playing like this, Arthur Fery might just become Wimbledon royalty. Fery grew up five minutes from the All England Club and now the 114th-ranked player is a semifinalist at grass-court Grand Slam. The 23-year-old British player, who needed a wild-card invitation to enter the tournament, beat ninth-seeded Flavio Cobolli 6-4, 7-6 (4), 6-0 on Centre Court in front of roaring home fans and a Royal Box contingent that included Britain's Queen Camilla on Wednesday. His run has been dubbed a

"Ferytale" and has included a viewing by Kate, the Princess of Wales, earlier in the tournament.

"It gets better and better every match," Fery said in an on-court interview. "I just can't believe it."

The only other wild card to have reached the men's singles semifinals at the All England Club was Goran Ivanisevic in his run to the Wimbledon title in 2001. Fery earned a standing ovation after

winning the first set. The deafening roar that followed Fery taking the tiebreaker to seal the second set was heard over at Wimbledon's other main stadium - No. 1 Court, where Alexander Zverev was in the process of beating Taylor Fritz in straight sets.

Fery sealed his memorable victory with an ace and fell onto his back to soak in the applause.

"That last game, I felt emotions that I hadn't experienced before in my life," he said.

A short time later, Zverev wrapped up his 6-4, 6-4, 6-2 win to set up a semifinal against Fery on Friday.

Moments before the start of their quarter-final match, Fery and Cobolli were surprised to meet Camilla in the hallway moments before they walked onto court. "She came to say hello, she introduced herself to both me and Flavio," Fery said.

(AP)



Ukraine's Marta Kostyuk extends Wimbledon run

MATTIAS KAREN ■ London

As Marta Kostyuk played on Centre Court at Wimbledon, her compatriots in Ukraine were dealing with another deadly attack by Russia on Kyiv.

It's been the same for much of Kostyuk's run to the semifinals. On Monday, after Russian missiles struck residential buildings close to where Kostyuk's parents live, she had to block that out to play her fourth-round match at the Grand Slam tournament. Last week, Russia hammered the Ukrainian capital with an 11-hour drone and missile attack that killed at least 21 civilians.

For Kostyuk, every day is about finding a way to focus on tennis while not shutting her eyes to what is going on at home. "It's not easy to disconnect entirely," Kostyuk said after beating Jasmine Paolini 6-3, 6-2 to reach the last four at Wimbledon for first time.

"It was really tough for me last week when the

first big attack happened," the 24-year-old Kostyuk continued. "Then on Monday they ruined like four streets of residential buildings. It was like five kilometers away from where my parents live. Again, another difficult night and a lot of dead people, innocent people, kids. It's not easy. I try to be aware of everything that's going on. Of course, I try for these things not to influence me too much."

The 12th-seeded Kostyuk is in her second straight Grand Slam semifinal after losing to Russian teenager Mirra Andreeva in the last four at the French Open. The two did not shake hands before that match, which has become the standard procedure for meetings between Russian and Ukrainian players since the war broke out in 2022.

Russian players have competed as neutrals on the men's and women's tennis tours since then. But the International Olympic Committee on Tuesday provisionally lifted its ban on Russia and recommended that individual sports drop the neutral status for athletes.

(AP)

Palani, Usmani, Rudie elected as ICC Associate Member Directors



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Edinburgh

France's Gurumurthy Palani, Mubashshir Usmani of United Arab Emirates and Namibia's Rudie van Vuuren have been elected as Associate Member Directors on the International Cricket Council (ICC) board for a two-year period.

The election was held during the ICC Annual Conference here on Wednesday.

The three elected Directors will represent the Associate Members on the ICC Board. Palani and Van Vuuren will

join the ICC Board for the first time, while Usmani has been re-elected after serving as an Associate Director over the past two years.

The election was contested by five candidates, with the incumbent Directors Usmani, Imran Khwaja and Mahinda Vallipuram joined by Palani and Van Vuuren.

A total of 43 Associate Members were eligible to vote in the election. USA Cricket and Cricket Canada were ineligible to participate as they remain suspended from ICC Membership.

Esports World Cup opens in Paris



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Paris

The first international edition of the world's largest esports gaming event — the Esports World Cup — began at the Paris Expo Porte de Versailles here on Thursday.

Running through August 23, the EWC will see more than 2,000 elite players, 200 leading esports Clubs from over 100 countries, competing across 25 tournaments in 24 of the world's most popular games for a share of a record-breaking USD 75 million (₹ 716 crore) prize pool.

The event follows the largest Road to EWC qualification program



in history, with more than 1.5 million players competing across 330 tournaments, publisher leagues and premier international circuits to earn their place on the world's biggest esports stage.

Sporting icons Cristiano Ronaldo and Magnus Carlsen return as

Esports World Cup Global Ambassadors, two figures whose careers represent the highest standards of competitive excellence across football and chess.

At the heart of the Esports World Cup is the Club Championship. It crowns the world's best Club across multiple games, rewarding not only star power, but consistency, depth, resilience and excellence across the full event.

Of the record-breaking USD75 million (Rs 716 crore) prize pool, USD 30 million (Rs 286 crore) will be awarded through the Club Championship standings.

Taylor Fritz loses to Zverev at Wimbledon



ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ London

Taylor Fritz was three games into his Wimbledon quarter-final against Alexander Zverev when his knee tendinitis started flaring up, and the American knew right away he was in trouble.

"I was just like panicking. What am I going to do?" the sixth-seeded Fritz said. "I just didn't expect it at all."

In the end, there was nothing he could do.

Zverev's serve and the pain in Fritz's knee were too much to overcome as the last American man left in the singles tournament lost 6-4, 6-4, 6-2 on No. 1 Court on Wednesday.

Fritz, who reached the 2024 US Open final after beating Zverev in the quarterfinals, has struggled with knee tendinitis in the past. But he had no indication previously at

Wimbledon that it might flare up again, aside from a bit of pain toward the end of his fourth-round win over Alexander Bublik.

"I expected, after a light day yesterday, to feel fine today," he said. "Felt like my warm-up was great. Then, yeah, I have no answers as to why three games in it was like that."

Fritz took a medical timeout during the second set to have his right knee worked on by a physio, but it wasn't enough to prevent Zverev from ending a seven-match losing streak against the American.

"He's beaten me for two years straight," Zverev, the French Open champion, said. "I played a fantastic match." Fritz, also, was quick to point out that the result may have been the same regardless of his knee issue.

After disappointing WC outing, India look to turn the tide at Lord's Test



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ London

India will be hoping for a change in tide after an underwhelming T20 World Cup campaign when they face hosts England in the first-ever women's Test at Lord's beginning in London on Friday.

A pre-mature exit from the T20 showpiece gave India more time to prepare for the red-ball game which takes place at the "Home of Cricket", 142 years after the first men's Test was staged at the fabled ground.

The Indian team trained at the picturesque Wormsley Cricket Ground for its second red-ball game this year, having played a Test in Australia in March.

Head coach Amol Muzumdar said



the prospect of taking the field for the first ever Test at Lord's excited the players even before the start of the preceding T20 World Cup.

"It just boggles my mind that it is just the first Test match here at Lords. Having said that, I am really fortunate and would like to extend my wishes to everyone who is involved in this. It is a great occasion and we are looking forward to it," said Muzumdar.

"It is a dream to play a Test match for any Indian cricketer, leave alone playing at Lords. I am sure

everyone who would wear those whites tomorrow would be proud of them being there at Lord's to play the Test match," the veteran of 171 first class games added.

Smriti Mandhana and Shafali Varma had opened in India's previous Test Down Under and the same is expected against England. Priya Punia has been drafted into the squad as a replacement for the injured Pratika Rawal who had batted at three in the 10-wicket loss to Australia.

Test matches in women's cricket take place far and few in between but India have a favourable record against England in the traditional format. India have won last three out of four games against the hosts and are yet lose a Test in England (two wins, seven draws).

Prabhsimran Singh credits Yuvraj, Ponting for success

BHARAT SHARMA ■ New Delhi

Prabhsimran Singh was in the middle of a gym session when he got to know about his selection in the India squad for the three T20Is in Zimbabwe later this month. The 25-year-old from Patiala could not express in words how much the national call up meant to him.

Recalling the moment, he said he cut short his gym session and rushed home to share his unbridled joy with his family.

The prolific Punjab Kings opener was hoping to get that special piece of news having scored 500-plus runs in the last two IPL seasons. His recent outing for India A in Sri Lanka also fuelled that hope.

Prabhsimran was part of India's Asian Games in 2023 but did not get to play. If he gets to play in Harare, the soft-spoken batter



knows he will have to make it count considering the intense competition in the shortest format. He has been picked as the second wicket-keeper batter in the side after Ishan Kishan with Sanju Samson surprisingly left out of the squad.

"You do feel good when something you are working towards all your life happens.

Sprinter Gout withdraws from world junior championships

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Brisbane

Gout Gout says he'll have to withdraw from the world junior championships after straining his hamstring in training, a decision that takes one of the rising stars of track and field out of next month's meet. "Unfortunately I suffered an injury to my left hamstring last night at training in Brisbane," the 18-year-old Australian sprinter posted on Instagram on Thursday. "I received this morning the MRI report, unfortunately the news is not good and I will not be able to compete in Eugene."

Gout said his focus now was on rehabilitation for the hamstring tear and he planned to "come back in 2027 better and stronger and faster." "I have no other possibility but to accept this situation. I understand this is part of athletics."

Gout has already spent time training with Olympic gold medalist Noah Lyles and has set an international record faster than Usain Bolt could produce at the Under-20 level. He was a strong favorite for gold at the Aug. 5-9 world juniors in Eugene, Oregon. He was due to compete in the 200 metres — he already holds the under-20 world record in that event — and was part of Australia's 4x400 relay team. Gout launched onto the international athletics scene while still a student at high school.

He set the quickest 200 time ever by a 16-year-old when he broke Australia's long-standing open record with a time of 20.06 in 2024. In April, Gout won the Australian title in 19.67 seconds, taking 0.02 off Erriyon Knighton's world under-20 mark of 19.69 set at Eugene in 2022.

Playing Nepal, Bhutan won't help: Sridharan urges India to face Asia's best in volleyball

SUMAN RAY ■ New Delhi

India are failing to win medals at continental tournaments or qualify for the World Championships and Olympics despite having immense potential because of poor planning and a lack of opportunities to compete against Asia's top volleyball nations, according to Dronacharya Award-winning coach G E Sridharan.

The 72-year-old argued that India continue to play mostly lower-ranked teams, limiting the players' growth and international competitiveness.

"If you play against the likes of Nepal, Bhutan and Sri Lanka all the time, what do you expect?" Sridharan told PTI on the sidelines of the launch of the Volleyball Champions League. "Why don't we try to play friendlies and matches



against the top volleyball-playing nations in Asia? China, Korea, Iran, Japan and Qatar are not only the best in Asia but also among the top 20 teams in the world."

The Arjuna Awardee, who was a member of India's bronze medal-winning team at the 1986 Asian Games, said that success at the continen-

tal level was built on consistently competing against elite opponents.

"Why did we win the bronze medal at those Asian Games and never again? Because before that, we played around 20 matches against China, Japan and Iran. We lost many times to China, and then one day we beat them. That was the gain. But we failed to build on those gains," he recalled. Sridharan believes India possess all the attributes needed to succeed but have struggled to maximise their potential. "We have very good knowledge. We have very good height. We have very good potential."

We have very good agility and speed. We have everything. What we need is to know how to sell our product. I have seen the best performance of my team.